



AUTHENTIK

CANADA

TRAVEL GUIDE

Western Canada

TOP 5 ROAD TRIPS IN WESTERN CANADA P.09

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How to protect yourself from mosquitoes

Souvenirs to bring back

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Driving an automatic transmission

Traveling with a motorhome



AUTHENTIK

C A N A D A

-

Travel Guide written by Canadians.

Authentik Canada is a Canadian travel agency specializing in the organization of road trips for families and couples.

www.AuthentikCanada.com

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© kitzcorner



© Destination BC

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ORGANIZE YOUR TRIP





● Favourable ● Average ● Unfavourable

MONTH	AVERAGE MIN. TEMP. (°C)	AVERAGE MAX. TEMP. (°C)	MONTHLY PRECIPITATION (MM)	MONTHLY PRECIPITATION (MM)
JANUARY	-16	-7	88	●
FEBRUARY	-15	-6	68	●
MARCH	-8	0	75	●
APRIL	-1	8	57	●
MAY	6	17	78	●
JUNE	12	23	93	●
JULY	15	25	101	●
AUGUST	13	24	101	●
SEPTEMBER	9	19	90	●
OCTOBER	4	12	85	●
NOVEMBER	-3	3	80	●
DECEMBER	-12	-5	80	●





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Plan your Canadian road trip directly with a Canadian.



Family



Motorhome



Wedding
trip

AUTHENTIKCANADA.COM

TOP 5 ROAD TRIPS IN WESTERN CANADA

#1- Western conquest 15 jours



Summary of the itinerary

Day 1 : Arrival in Vancouver
 Day 2 : Vancouver
 Day 3 : Vancouver / Victoria (117 km / 3:20)
 Day 4 : Victoria
 Day 5 : Victoria / Pacific Rim (296 km / 4:07)
 Day 6 : Pacific Rim
 Day 7 : Pacific Rim / Whistler (340 km / 6:06)
 Day 8 : Whistler / Wells Gray Park (453 km / 5:11)
 Day 9 : Wells Gray Park
 Day 10 : Wells Gray Park / Jasper (319 km / 3:19)
 Day 11 : Jasper
 Day 12 : Jasper / Banff (292 km / 3:39)
 Day 13 : Banff
 Day 14 : Banff / Calgary (131 km / 1:30)
 Day 15 : Calgary airport

Price from

\$ 1,943 / adulte

* Indicative Prices

#2- Legendary splendour 21 jours



Summary of the itinerary

Day 1 : Arrival in Vancouver
 Day 2 : Vancouver / Okanagan (393 km / 3:59)
 Day 3 : Okanagan
 Day 4 : Okanagan / Revelstoke (195 km / 2:28)
 Day 5 : Revelstoke / Lac Louise (229 km / 2:28)
 Day 6 : Lac Louise / Banff (60 km / 0h38)
 Day 7 : Banff
 Day 8 : Banff / Jasper (290 km / 3:39)
 Day 9 : Jasper
 Day 10 : Jasper
 Day 11 : Jasper / Wells Gray Park (319 km / 3:21)
 Day 12 : Wells Gray Park
 Day 13 : Wells Gray Park / Whistler (423 km / 5:15)
 Day 14 : Whistler
 Day 15 : Whistler / Pacific Rim (349 km / 6:15)
 Day 16 : Pacific Rim
 Day 17 : Pacific Rim
 Day 18 : Pacific Rim / Victoria (117 km / 3:20)
 Day 19 : Victoria
 Day 20 : Victoria / Vancouver (117 km / 3:20)
 Day 21 : Vancouver airport

Price from

\$ 2,642 / adulte

* Indicative Prices

#3- West with the family

15 jours



Summary of the itinerary

Day 1 : Arrival in Vancouver
 Day 2 : Vancouver
 Day 3 : Vancouver / Whistler (120 km / 1:37)
 Day 4 : Whistler / Ashcroft (205 km / 2:53)
 Day 5 : Ashcroft / Wells Gray Park (218 km / 2:17)
 Day 6 : Wells Gray Park
 Day 7 : Wells Gray Park / Jasper (319 km / 3:19)
 Day 8 : Jasper
 Day 9 : Jasper
 Day 10 : Jasper / Banff (292 km / 3:39)
 Day 11 : Banff
 Day 12 : Banff
 Day 13 : Banff / Calgary (134 km / 1:25)
 Day 14 : Excursion to Drumheller (3:30 round-trip)
 Day 15 : Calgary airport

Price from
\$1,797 / adulte

* Indicative Prices



#4- Lake route

8 jours



Summary of the itinerary

Day 1 : Arrival in Calgary
 Day 2 : Calgary / Waterton (271 km / 3:48)
 Day 3 : Waterton
 Day 4 : Waterton / Banff (372 km / 3:55)
 Day 5 : Banff / Jasper (292 km / 3:41)
 Day 6 : Jasper
 Day 7 : Jasper / Lake Louise (235 km / 3:02)
 Day 8 : Lake Louise / Calgary (183 km / 2:00)

Price from
\$1,034 / adulte

* Indicative Prices



© iStock-1176742931, Yulin Luo

ATHABASCA FALLS, JASPER

#5- The West by RV

15 jours



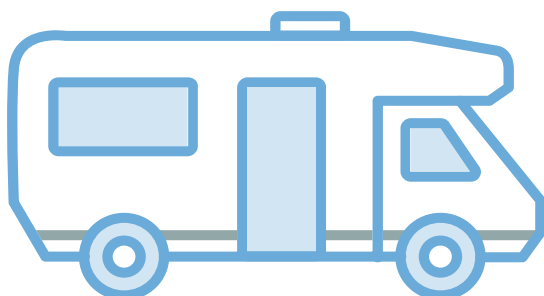
Summary of the itinerary

Jour 1 : Calgary
 Jour 2 : Calgary / Banff (128 km / 01h29)
 Jour 3 : Banff
 Jour 4 : Banff
 Jour 5 : Banff / Jasper (286 km / 03h29)
 Jour 6 : Jasper
 Jour 7 : Jasper
 Jour 8 : Jasper / Parc Wells Gray (355 km / 03h52)
 Jour 9 : Parc Wells Gray
 Jour 10 : Parc Wells Gray / Whistler (458 km / 05h48)
 Jour 11 : Whistler
 Jour 12 : Whistler / Victoria (255 km / 04h45)
 Jour 13 : Victoria
 Jour 14 : Victoria / Vancouver (112 km / 02h52)
 Jour 15 : Vancouver

Price from

\$ 691/adulte

** Indicative Prices*



BOOK YOUR ROAD TRIP IN 3 EASY STEPS

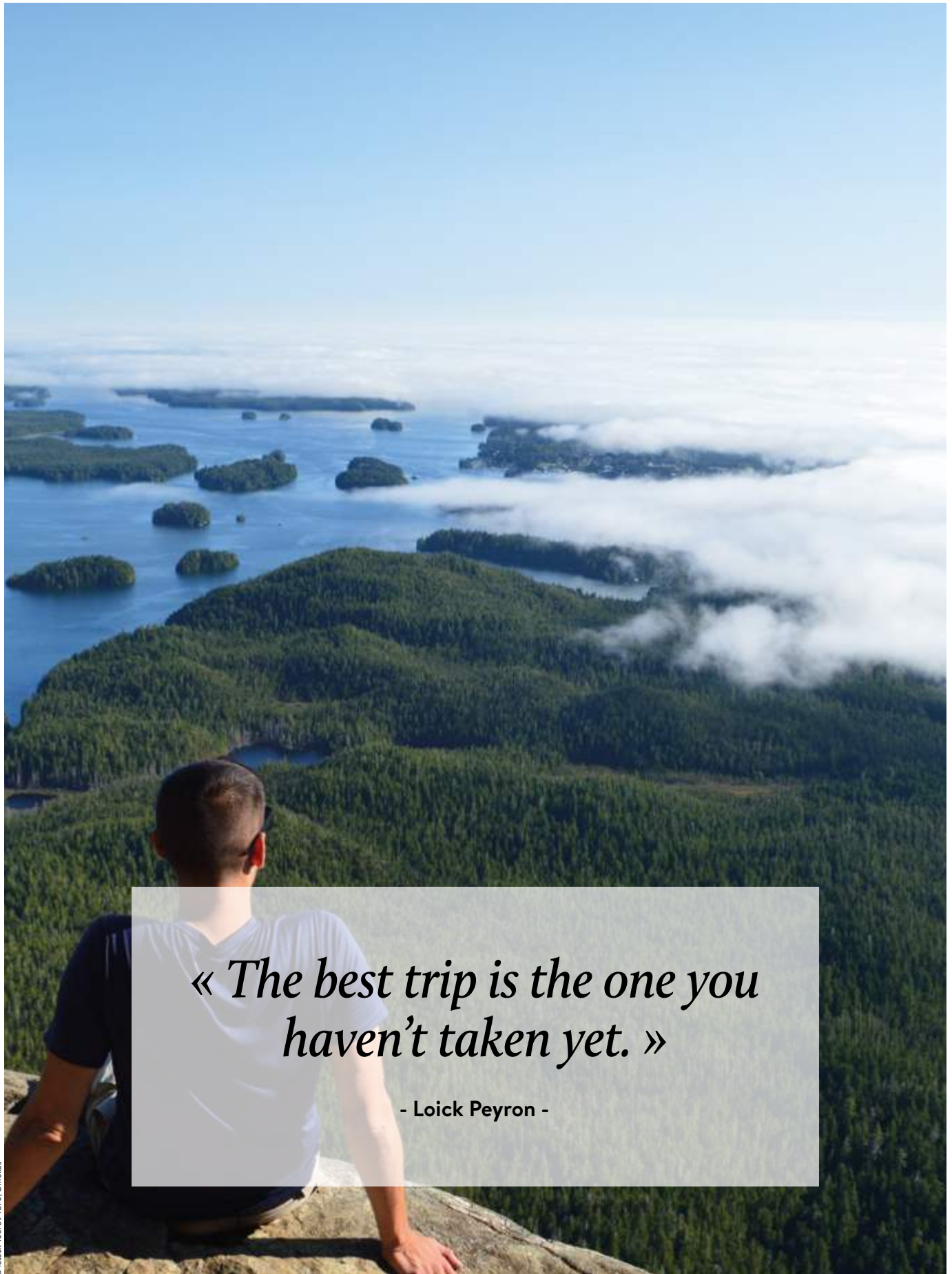
- #1- Go to www.authentikcanada.com and select your road trip.
- #2- Modify your trip online, as you wish.
- #3- Click on the «Book» button.



© iStock-52718663, ranplett



© iStock-146903167, Wakingdream



*« The best trip is the one you
haven't taken yet. »*

- Loick Peyron -

TRAVEL GUIDE

What to do? Where to eat?



© AdobeStock, sara_winter

This personalized travel guide is intended as a practical tool to optimize your visit to each destination and help you make the most of your trip.

Each destination information sheet contains the following sections:

WHAT TO DO

This section presents the destination's must-see attractions and/or activities according to Authentik. These are ranked according to the following system:

- ★ Notworthy
- ★★ Worth the detour
- ★★★ Must-see

However, please bear in mind that this is by no means an exclusive list of things to do in the area. Our goal is simply to point out the highlights of each destination to make things easier for you. We encourage you to complement this information with local tourist guides and by stopping off at tourist information centres (identified by a large blue question mark) at the entrance to the different cities and regions and in national park visitor centres.

WHERE TO EAT

In this section we have listed our favourite places to eat for each destination. Each restaurant is classified according to the following system:

- \$ Inexpensive
- \$\$ Moderate
- \$\$\$ Upscale
- \$\$\$\$ Fine dining

FESTIVALS

Where applicable, we have indicated the most important local festivals, with a brief description and this year's dates.

MAP

Some destinations include a map to help you easily locate must-see attractions and restaurants.

ICÔNES

In the sections, **What to do** and **Where to Eat**, you will find icons to help you quickly find our **family activities**, suggested **hike trails** and **microbreweries**.



Family



Hiking



Microbrewerie

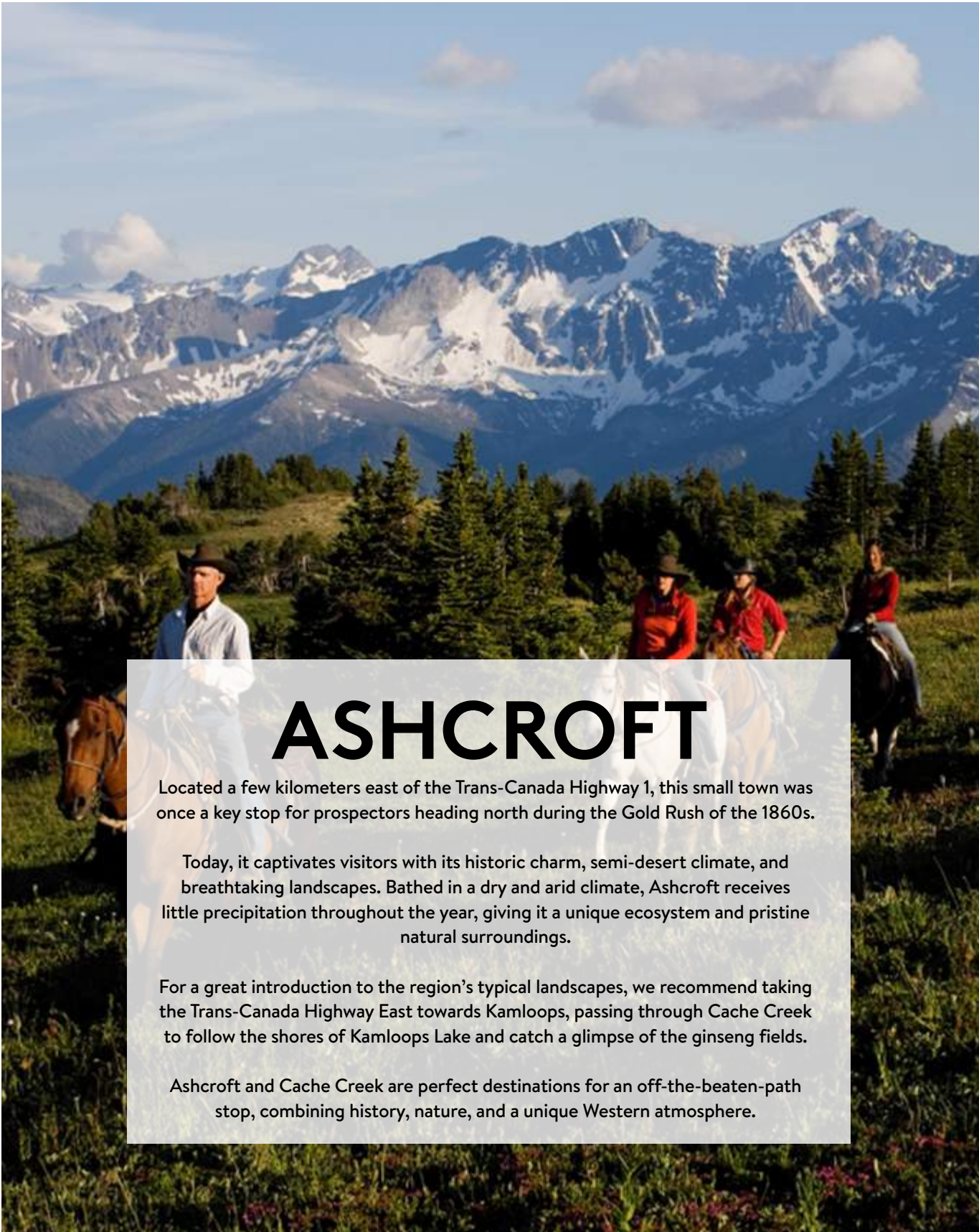
OUR DESTINATIONS



A serene landscape photograph of a calm lake in a mountainous region. The water is still, reflecting the surrounding evergreen trees and the misty, forested mountains in the background. A semi-transparent white rectangular box is centered in the lower half of the image, containing a quote in French. The overall atmosphere is peaceful and ethereal.

« *Rester c'est exister, mais
voyager c'est vivre.* »

- Gustave Nadaud -



ASHCROFT

Located a few kilometers east of the Trans-Canada Highway 1, this small town was once a key stop for prospectors heading north during the Gold Rush of the 1860s.

Today, it captivates visitors with its historic charm, semi-desert climate, and breathtaking landscapes. Bathed in a dry and arid climate, Ashcroft receives little precipitation throughout the year, giving it a unique ecosystem and pristine natural surroundings.

For a great introduction to the region's typical landscapes, we recommend taking the Trans-Canada Highway East towards Kamloops, passing through Cache Creek to follow the shores of Kamloops Lake and catch a glimpse of the ginseng fields.

Ashcroft and Cache Creek are perfect destinations for an off-the-beaten-path stop, combining history, nature, and a unique Western atmosphere.

WHAT TO DO

ASHCROFT MUSEUM ★

Dive into the town's fascinating history through captivating exhibits on the Gold Rush, First Nations, and the railway.

NEARBY

Located just 10 minutes from Ashcroft, Cache Creek is a must-stop for outdoor enthusiasts and history lovers.

HISTORIC HAT CREEK RANCH ★

An immersive historic site offering a glimpse into the life of settlers and First Nations, featuring restored buildings and wagon rides.

ELEPHANT HILL PARK ★

This park features hiking trails with breathtaking views of the Thompson River Valley.



ASHCROFT CARIBOO MOUNTAINS

© DollarPhotoClub, Amelie

SCENIC ROUTE 99

Whether coming from or heading to Whistler, take this spectacular route that winds through mountain landscapes, deep canyons, and arid valleys before reaching Ashcroft. A true immersion into the diverse landscapes of British Columbia!

WHERE TO EAT

ASHCROFT BAKERY & COFFEE SHOP (\$)

This traditional old-school bakery serves specialty coffees, teas, bread, cookies, sandwiches, salads, small pizzas and soups, as well as a daily menu for lunch. A wide selection of fresh-baked breads and pastries including cinnamon buns (which are gigantic, by the way!), pies and cakes. Warm and welcoming atmosphere.

HORSTINGS FARM MARKET (\$)

Horsting's houses a bakery, a cafe and a farmer's market with farm-fresh produce, flowers and plants, all in a charming setting. Sit on the patio and enjoy a custom sandwich,

entirely designed by you with your choice of bread, protein, condiments, cheese and vegetables. Don't feel like a sandwich? Have soup, a muffin, a slice of homemade pie, a cookie or just an ice cream cone. There is also a boutique selling gifts and garden items. Easily accessible with a large parking lot. A real nugget on the Gold Rush trail!

WWW.HORSTINGSFARM.COM



COWBOY COUNTRY

© iStockPhoto, RobertPlatz

BANFF



Banff is the name of a legendary national park, and the name of a charming alpine town in the heart of the majestic Rockies at an altitude of 1,380 metres. Look around you: with its backdrop of mountains, glaciers, forests, rivers and alpine meadows, you will quickly understand why Banff is considered a «must-see» destination to add to any Canadian Rockies road trip.

THE TOWN OF BANFF

WHAT TO DO

THE TOWN OF BANFF ★★

The town's main thoroughfare, Banff Avenue, is teeming with **boutiques and restaurants**. With the impressive Cascade Mountain looming in the background, you will feel like you have stepped into a picture postcard.

HIGHWAY 1A (BANFF TO LAKE LOUISE) ★★

Along the way to Lake Louise you have a good chance of seeing wildlife beside the road, such as black bears, elk and grizzly bears. For the best chance of sightings, **try to travel early in the morning or at the end of the day**, when the animals come closer to the road to feed.

JOHNSTON CANYON ★★

Distance (round-trip): 2.2 km

Time (round-trip): 1 hour

Level: Easy

Elevation gain: 30 m

Johnston Canyon, one of the most popular day hikes in Banff National Park, is 30 minutes from the Town of Banff. Its easily accessible location close to Highway 1A, as well as the beauty of Johnston Creek and its waterfalls, makes it a choice destination for visitors and hiking enthusiasts. You will be able to appreciate the power of the water as it rushes and plunges through the canyon. This 2.2-km round-trip hike to the lower falls is considered easy (elevation gain of 30 metres) and takes about 1 hour (round trip).

BANFF NATIONAL PARK ★★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centres:

- The Banff Visitor Centre (224 Banff Avenue, Banff).
- The Banff Visitor Information Kiosk (327 Railway Avenue, Banff).

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/ab/banff



© Banff Lake Louise Tourism, Paul Zizka



© iStock-91072398, Wildore

CAVE AND BASIN NATIONAL HISTORIC SITE ★

Cave and Basin is the birthplace of Canada's National Park system, created in the early 1900s after three railway workers stumbled upon a cave full of «liquid gold» in 1883. Pay a visit to this fascinating site with more than 13,000 years of history, where you will have

the chance to walk through a magnificent underground cave and admire its natural beauty. Experience nature, culture and history and learn about the origins of the region's hot springs. You can even dip your hands in the steamy mineral waters. The site offers free discovery tours led by naturalist guides. You can also take a guided lantern tour after dark

(Saturday nights from June to September).

[PC.GC.CA/FR/LHN-NHS/AB/CAVEANDBASIN](https://pc.gc.ca/fr/LHN-NHS/AB/CAVEANDBASIN)

GONDOLA TO SULPHUR MOUNTAIN ★

The Banff Gondola will whisk you up to the summit of Sulphur Mountain, an elevation of 2,281 metres, in just 8 minutes,

where you will experience jaw-dropping mountain **views ★★**. Take in the 360° panoramas from the observation deck or take a stroll along the Ridgetop Boardwalk where the views get better with every step. To avoid the crowds in high season, it is best to take the Gondola before 11 am or after 5 pm.

[BANFFJASPERCOLLECTION.COM/ATTRACTIONS/BANFF-GONDOLA](https://banffjaspercollection.com/attractions/banff-gondola)



CAVE AND BASIN NATIONAL HISTORIC SITE



BOW VALLEY AND SULPHUR MOUNTAIN

HIKING ON MONT SULPHUR★

Distance (round-trip): 11 km

Time (round-trip): 4 hours

Level: Difficult

Elevation gain: 655 m

Hiking enthusiasts may prefer to take the **5.5-kilometre trail**

(one way) with an elevation gain of 655 metres (a 4 hour round trip). The trail starts from Upper Hot Springs, 1 Mountain Avenue, Banff.



HIKING ON SULPHUR MOUNTAIN

© iStock-1033478082, Elijah-Lovkoff

UPPER HOT SPRINGS★

Soak in the steamy hot mineral waters where travelers have come to “take the waters” for more than a century. Upper Hot Springs is a public pool filled with natural hot springs water. Located just outside of

Banff on the slopes of Sulphur Mountain, the springs offer spectacular views of the Bow Valley, from an elevation of 1,585 metres. Early in the morning is the best time for a truly relaxing experience! Warning, parking is limited! [HOTSPRINGS.CA/BANFF](https://hotsprings.ca/banff)



UPPER HOT SPRINGS

© iStock-169987518, wwing

FESTIVALS

Banff Yoga Festival

Dates : late May

Three-day wellness festival with more than 90 yoga workshops for every level and the best yoga instructors in the Bow Valley. Happiness guaranteed! banffyogafestival.com

Craft Beer Festival

Dates : early December

Alberta craft beer festival showcasing more than 40 breweries from across the province. Held at the Cave and Basin Historic Site. banfflakelouise.com/banff-craft-beer-festival



MORAINE LAKE

© Banff Lake Louise Tourism

GETTING AROUND BANFF

For the sake of the environment and to avoid parking problems, take advantage of Banff's public transit options:

1. **Roam Public Transit** services the Town of Banff and popular Banff Attractions (roamtransit.com). The hybrid Roam buses cover several routes including:
 - **Roam Route 1**, providing service to Upper Hot Springs and Sulphur Mountain (Banff Gondola) from Banff Avenue
 - **Roam Route 2**, providing service between Tunnel (Village I and Village II), downtown Banff and the Banff Springs Hotel
 - **Roam Route 4**, providing service between the Banff Train Station and Cave and Basin Historic Site
2. A **Parks Canada shuttle service** operates daily from mid-May to early October between the Town of Banff and Lake Louise (Samson Mall). **Personal vehicle access is prohibited to Moraine Lake. Shuttle service only.** You must reserve : reservation.pc.gc.ca

For more information about these different services, visit the website: pc.gc.ca/banff-transport



VIEW ON THE TOWN OF BANFF

WHERE TO EAT

1 WILD FLOUR BANFF'S ARTISAN BAKERY CAFÉ (\$-\$\$)

This bustling bakery is a favourite gathering spot for locals and visitors alike. Open for breakfast and lunch, it offers excellent value for money. Customers come for the artisan bread, freshly-baked pastries and organic, local, healthy, and nourishing food. For breakfast, try the breakfast frittata sandwich or the housemade granola with a great cup of coffee. At lunch, a tantalizing array of fresh soups, salads

and sandwiches will make your mouth water.

WILDFLOURBAKERY.CA

2 THE BEAR STREET TAVERN (\$\$-\$\$\$)

The Bear Street Tavern may not offer the best service, but it certainly has the best pizza in town. Also serves soups, salads and sandwiches: there's something for everyone!

BEARSTREETTAVERN.CA

3 THE JUNIPER BISTRO (\$\$\$)

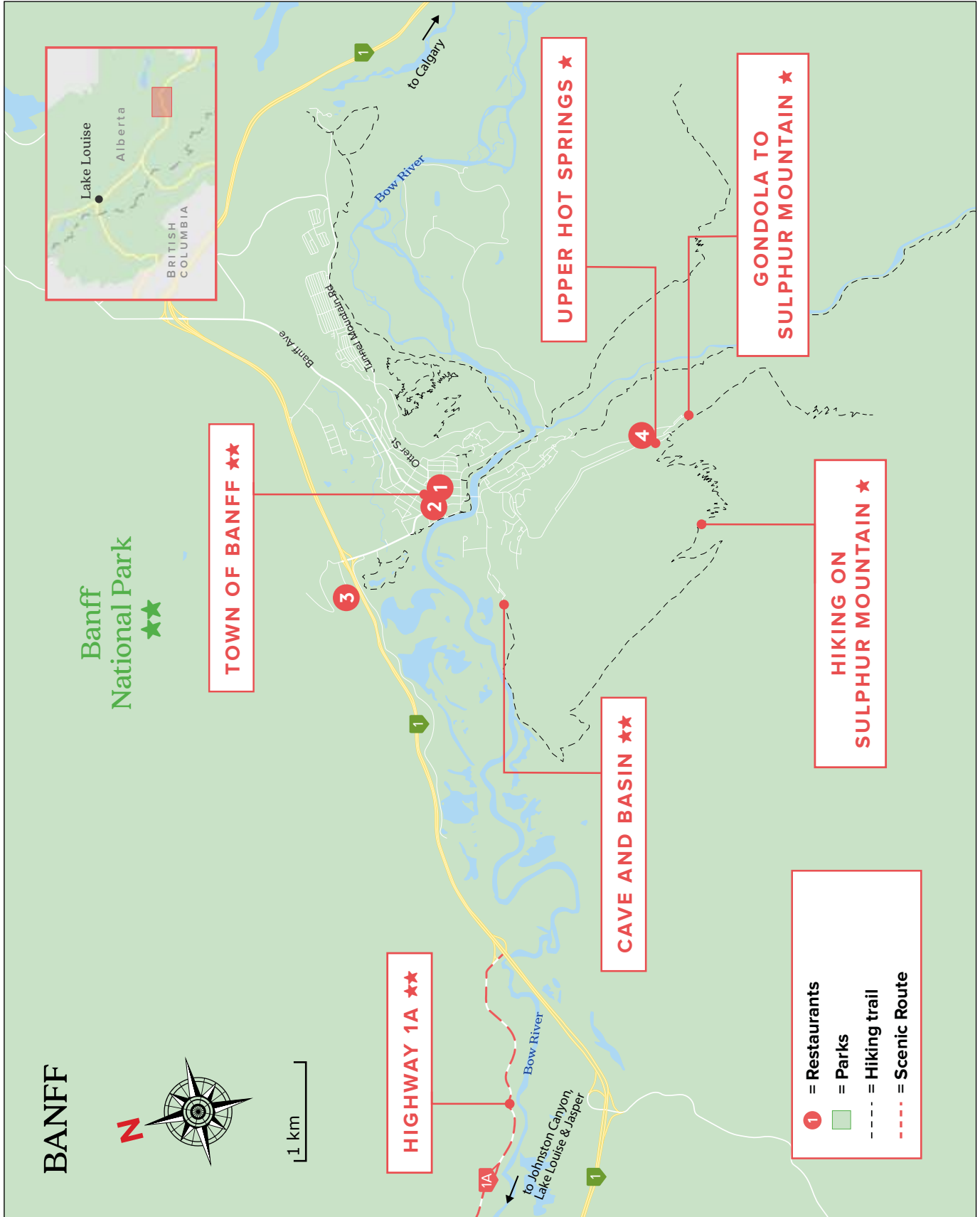
The Juniper Hotel restaurant has one of the best views in Banff. Ask for a table near a window or on the patio for the best possible vistas. The menu offers handcrafted cuisine prepared with fresh local ingredients and features smoked duck breast, beef, lamb and fish dishes. Vegetarian and gluten-free options at every meal. Ranked one of the Top 100 Best Restaurants in Canada by Open Table.

THEJUNIPER.COM/DINE/

4 EDEN (\$\$\$\$)

Located within Rimrock Resort Hotel, Eden is one of only five 5-diamond restaurants in Canada. Enjoy one of Banff's finest dining experiences featuring delicately crafted French cuisine influenced by fresh local ingredients. Expect to spend 3 hours over dinner. Reservations required.

RIMROCKRESORT.COM/DINE-DRINK/EDEN/



CALGARY



The spirit of the Old West lives on in Calgary, where the **cowboy hat** is just as fashionable in the boardroom as it is on the ranch. If you visit Calgary in early July, you will experience the excitement of the **x**, the largest rodeo event in Canada. Then pick up a cheap rental car in Calgary and set off to explore the Canadian Rockies just a few miles away.

CALGARY TOWER

WHAT TO DO

CALGARY TOWER★

Soaring above the downtown core, the Calgary Tower **observation deck★★** offers a spectacular 360° view of the bustling city, the majestic Rocky Mountains, the foothills, and the prairies. Be sure to walk across the **glass floor** at the top of the tower for a birds-eye view of the city streets below: thrills guaranteed! The tower also boasts two restaurants offering

CALGARYTOWER.COM

GLENBOW MUSEUM★★

An art and history museum located right in downtown Calgary, the Glenbow Museum houses a wide variety of world-renowned exhibitions and the largest art collection in Western Canada, in addition to permanent exhibitions that tell the story of Southern Alberta

and the West to thousands of visitors each year. Audioguides available. **Main building closed for renovations until 2026.**
 GLENBOW.ORG

up a few souvenirs of your Western Canada adventure. The pedestrian section of 8 Avenue SW is between 1st St SE and 4th St SW.

8TH AVENUE (STEPHEN AVENUE WALK)★

This historic pedestrian mall in Downtown Calgary is the perfect place to go for a stroll, do some shopping or pick



CALGARY TOWER

© iStock-157427384, dan, prat



STEPHEN AVENUE WALK

© Authentik Canada, Simon Lemay



BOW RIVER FROM UNDER PEACE BRIDGE

© Shutterstock_506498050, Timothy Yue



AERIAL VIEW OF CALGARY DURING WINTER



DRUMHELLER, BADLANDS

PEACE BRIDGE

The **Peace Bridge** provides a way for **cyclists** and **pedestrians** to cross the Bow River. The attractive, original bridge was designed by Spanish architect **Santiago Calatrava** in 2012. The bridge is reportedly used by **6,000 people** a day to commute to work and back without using their cars. Don't hesitate to use it yourself, and enjoy a **beautiful view of the river and downtown Calgary**. It is to the west of Prince's Island Park and can be reached by Memorial Drive NW. Several parking options are available.

NEARBY

ROYAL TYRRELL MUSEUM ★★



The Royal Tyrrell Museum is Canada's only museum dedicated exclusively to the science of palaeontology. Located in Drumheller, in the heart of the Canadian badlands,

about 2 hours from Calgary, the museum houses one of the world's largest displays of dinosaurs. Visitors of all ages will be amazed by the gigantic tyrannosaurus skeletons.
TYRRELLMUSEUM.COM



PEACE BRIDGE OF CALGARY

© AdobeStock

FESTIVALS

Calgary Stampede

Dates : mid-July

The largest annual event in Canada features an internationally renowned rodeo competition, a fair, an agricultural exhibition, chuckwagon races, concerts, a First Nations "Indian Village", pancake breakfasts across the city, and much more.

CALGARYSTAMPEDE.COM

Calgary Folk Music Festival

Dates : end of July

Calgary's most popular music festival. Featuring some 70 artists from around the world, Folk Fest celebrates a variety of

musical genres including world music, country, alternative, blues, funk, bluegrass, traditional and more. A great activity to enjoy with friends or family.

CALGARYFOLKFEST.COM/FESTIVAL

Calgary Reggae Fest

Dates : June

Reggae fans can move to the rhythm of local and international reggae artists. An event that transcends racial, cultural and musical boundaries, Reggaefest offers something for everyone with a Kids Zone and food and craft stands.

REGGAEFEST.CA



© Huffpost

CALGARY STAMPEDE



CALGARY BY NIGHT

© DollaPhotoClub, Jeff

WHERE TO EAT

1 UNA PIZZA + WINE (\$\$)

UNA Pizza serves some of the best thin-crust pizza in town, for dining in or takeaway. Also has an extensive wine list.

Reservations not accepted so try to get there early, as it is a very popular spot.

UNAPIZZERIA.COM

2 NATIVE TONGUES TAQUERIA (\$\$)

This delicious little taco restaurant serves cuisine rooted in the traditional street and market foods of Mexico. Their crispy fried tortillas are topped with a variety of delicious garnishes to suit all tastes: meat, vegetables, refried beans, fish, and even grilled octopus! Try one of their specialty cocktails! On weekends, you can even

enjoy a traditional Mexican breakfast from 11:30 am. *No reservation allowed.*

NATIVETONGUES.CA

3 NOTABLE (\$\$-\$\$\$)

If you would like to slow down and savour a delicious dining experience, pay a visit to this modern restaurant with its emphasis on slow food and its cozy, gourmet casual atmosphere. The menu offers fresh, original bistro cuisine. Favourite dishes include the rotisserie chicken.

NOTABLETHERESTAURANT.CA

4 CHARCUT ROAST HOUSE (\$\$\$)

Everything here, from the sausages to the breads, is made from scratch using fresh,

seasonal ingredients from local producers. CHARCUT's style of food is best described as urban-rustic with Italian and Country French accents. True to its name, the restaurant is the ultimate destination for meat lovers. The menu features a variety of house-made charcuterie and grilled and charcoal-roasted meats as well as fish and vegetable dishes. With a glass of wine in hand and a carnivore's appetite, you will never want to leave downtown Calgary.

CHARCUT.COM

5 RIVER CAFÉ (\$\$\$\$)

Built more than twenty years ago, the River Café is located in the middle of Prince's Island Park, in a remarkable setting on

the Bow River near downtown Calgary. River Café was one of the pioneers of the "farm to table" philosophy, working with small local growers and producers to source the finest Alberta ingredients, and identifying the provenance of the ingredients on the menu. The restaurant serves seasonal Canadian cuisine and is dedicated to the art of preparing everything from scratch, from making their breads and desserts in-house to butchering, curing and smoking their own meats. Enjoy an exceptional dining experience in an authentic setting, with a panoramic view of the park!

RIVER-CAFE.COM



CANMORE



Located at the gateway to the Kananaskis Country, Canmore provides privileged access to one of Alberta's most spectacular regions. This charming town, surrounded by majestic peaks and dominated by the iconic Three Sisters—true guardians of the area—offers a unique setting that captivates outdoor enthusiasts and history lovers alike.

Less touristy than the famous Banff National Park, this region immerses visitors in Canada's untamed wilderness, with a more peaceful and authentic atmosphere.

With its blend of nature, history, and adventure, Canmore is the perfect destination to unwind and explore.



CHIPMUNK NEAR KANANASKIS LAKE SUPERIOR

WHAT TO DO

CANMORE VILLAGE ★★

Highlights include a peaceful stroll along the Policeman's Creek Boardwalk, an elevated path winding through picturesque wetlands, and a visit to the Historic Railway Bridge, a testament to the town's railway heritage, offering stunning views of the Bow River.

With its galleries, artisan shops, and cozy cafés, the town exudes a welcoming and relaxing atmosphere, perfect for unwinding after a day outdoors. Don't miss Big Head, a sculpture by artist Al Henderson that has become one of Canmore's iconic landmarks.

GRASSI LAKES ★★

Length (Round Trip) : 3.4 km
Duration : (Round Trip) : 1-3h
Level : Easy
Elevation : 158 m

These two small turquoise lakes are accessible via a hiking trail suitable for various skill levels. The trail offers impressive views and fascinating rock formations along the way.

CANOEING ON THE BOW RIVER ★★

Paddle along the peaceful waters of the Bow River while enjoying spectacular views of the iconic Three Sisters—an experience as serene as it is unforgettable.

HELICOPTER TOUR ★★★

Take to the skies and soar over the majestic Rockies and Spray Valley on an awe-inspiring helicopter tour, offering a unique perspective of breathtaking landscapes.

PICNIC AT QUARRY LAKE ★

This spot is perfect for picnics, summer swimming, or simply admiring the surrounding mountains. We highly recommend visiting at sunset for an unforgettable experience.

CANMORE NORDIC CENTRE ★

Originally created for the 1988

Winter Olympics, this destination boasts 65 km of cross-country ski trails in winter and over 100 km of hiking and biking trails in summer, suitable for all levels. It also features an 18-hole disc golf course and equipment rentals to make the most of your visit.

CANMORE MUSEUM & GEOSCIENCE CENTRE ★

Dive into Canmore's fascinating history and explore its geological treasures at the Canmore Museum & Geoscience Centre—a must-visit for culture and natural science enthusiasts.



BOW RIVER TO CANMORE

© Shutterstock-1216789681-low-river



CANMORE VILLAGE

© Shutterstock-797465829-canmore

NEARBY

The Kananaskis Country is a sought-after destination known for its natural beauty and tranquility. This vast wilderness, encompassing several provincial parks, is renowned for its countless hiking trails, each offering breathtaking landscapes and an immersive nature experience. Whether you're an experienced hiker or seeking family-friendly adventures, the Kananaskis Country has something for everyone.

With its diverse landscapes and numerous attractions, the Kananaskis Country perfectly complements the unique experience offered by Canmore. It's a must-add to your itinerary!

BOW VALLEY PROVINCIAL PARK ★

Nestled along the iconic Bow River, Bow Valley Provincial Park is a true gem of the Kananaskis Valley. Surrounded by mountains, this park is a haven for

outdoor enthusiasts. For an easy stroll, try the Bow Valley Trail. For a more challenging adventure, tackle the Yamnuska Trail, which rewards hikers with stunning views of the Rockies.

TENT RIDGE HORSESHOE HIKE ★★★

Length (Round Trip) : 10.9 km
Duration : (Round Trip) : 4-6 h
Level : Difficult
Elevation : 852 m

A must-do in the Kananaskis Valley, this hike offers spectacular views for seasoned hikers. To avoid the more technical sections, start in reverse from the parking lot, reach the summit, and return the same way.

After the hike, relax with afternoon tea at the Mount Engadine Lodge, nestled near Spray Lakes for a well-deserved break.

Note: The access road is gravel and may not be covered by rental car insurance.

KANANASKIS VILLAGE ★

This charming village is the perfect base for exploring the region. It features accommodations, restaurants, and family-friendly activities, all surrounded by breathtaking mountain views.

PETER LOUGHEED PROVINCIAL PARK ★★★

At the heart of Kananaskis Country, Peter Lougheed Provincial Park is a paradise for outdoor lovers. Its shimmering lakes, dense forests, and towering mountains make it ideal for hiking, biking, or simply enjoying nature.

Explore trails around the Upper and Lower Kananaskis Lakes, offering stunning views and picnic

spots by the water. Don't miss Sarrail Ridge, renowned for its panoramic vistas.

POCATERRA RIDGE HIKE ★★★

Length (Round Trip) : 11.4 km
Duration : (Round Trip) : 4-7 h
Level : Difficult
Elevation : 708 m

This trail, reserved for experienced hikers, features alpine ridges and stunning landscapes. It's especially breathtaking in autumn, when the larches turn golden.

Access to the Kananaskis Country requires a Kananaskis Conservation Pass, which can be purchased online or in person at the Kananaskis Visitor Centre or the Travel Alberta Canmore Visitor Information Centre.



KANANASKIS LAKES

FESTIVALS

CANMORE

CANMORE WINTER CARNIVAL

Dates : Late February to early March

This festival celebrates winter with activities like ice sculptures, dog sled races, and family events. The festive and warm atmosphere highlights Canmore's winter charm and attracts both locals and visitors alike.

CANMORE FOLK MUSIC FESTIVAL

Dates : Early August

Alberta's oldest folk music festival hosts local and international artists in an enchanting setting. Perfect for music lovers, it also offers activities for families, creating a friendly and relaxing atmosphere.

KANANASKIS

KANANASKIS MOUNTAIN FESTIVAL

Dates : June

This festival celebrates outdoor adventure with guided hikes, survival workshops, and nature talks. It provides an excellent opportunity to discover the Kananaskis region while learning from local experts.

WINTER IN THE WILD FESTIVAL

Dates : February

This winter festival highlights snow activities such as snowshoeing, skiing, and guided hikes in a spectacular setting. It's an ideal opportunity to enjoy winter with family or friends in the magnificent Kananaskis region.



ROAD TO CANMORE AND KANANASKIS

WHERE TO EAT

CANMORE

1 CRAZYWEED KITCHEN (\$\$)

This casual restaurant offers inventive fusion cuisine with Asian, Mediterranean, and local influences. You'll find creative dishes like curry bowls, gourmet pizzas, or fresh salads, all in a friendly atmosphere. It's an excellent option for a quality meal without spending too much.

2 THE WOOD RESTAURANT AND LOUNGE (\$\$)

A must-visit in Canmore, this restaurant offers classic Canadian dishes like burgers,

ribs, and local fish. Its spacious terrace is ideal for enjoying views of the Rockies while savoring a good meal. With its attractive value for money, it's a popular choice for families and groups of friends.

3 THE SENSORY & WIT BAR (\$\$\$\$)

For a refined gastronomic experience, this restaurant is a destination of choice. With breathtaking mountain views and carefully prepared dishes, each plate is a work of art. Their tasting menu features local products enhanced by modern techniques, perfect for a memorable evening.

KANANASKIS

1 FORTE RESTAURANT (\$\$)

Located in the Kananaskis Mountain Lodge, Forte offers comforting cuisine showcasing local ingredients. The menu includes artisanal wood-fired pizzas, pasta, and simple yet flavorful dishes, perfect after a day of exploration. With its casual ambiance and generous portions, it's an excellent choice for a friendly meal with family or friends.

2 BLACKTAIL BAR (\$\$\$)

This elegant restaurant, also located at the Kananaskis Mountain Lodge, offers a

more sophisticated culinary experience. Their menu highlights modern Canadian dishes like West Coast salmon, grilled meats, and artisanal cocktails. The warm atmosphere, with views of the mountains, makes it an ideal destination for a chic but relaxed dinner.

GOLD BRIDGE

SEAPLANE TOUR

Gold Bridge and the Bridge River Valley region reflect the history of British Columbia with its railways, deserted towns, flooded valleys, old mines and trails.

The Gold Bridge region has been home to miners and their families since gold was discovered in the Bridge River in 1859. The gold rush began in the 1930s at the Bralorne-Pioneer Mine near Gold Bridge. It was the foremost gold producer in British Columbia, producing the equivalent of over \$145 million in gold.

The mine closed in 1970, but you can take a trip into the past with a walk through its ruins and the nearby ghost towns. The region offers spectacular scenery featuring rugged mountains, canyons, mountain streams and deep blue lakes.





GOLDEN

The small town of Golden is a must for visitors to the region, with six of the most stunning national parks that Canada has to offer right in its own backyard: Banff, Glacier, Jasper, Kootenay, Mount Revelstoke and Yoho. You may see some real cowboys in Golden... After all, it was adventure and the lure of gold that brought the first explorers to the area.

TAKAKKAW FALLS

NEARBY

YOHO NATIONAL PARK ★★

This national park offers much more than a forest and towering rock faces.

Take the time to visit **Takakkaw Falls ★★**, plunging a dramatic 250 meters over a rock face. A narrow winding road leads to the falls, with several tight hairpin turns, accessible only by car, small RV or bicycle from mid-June to mid-October. As the parking lot fills up quickly, it is better to go at the beginning or end of the day.

You will also want to stop off at **Emerald Lake ★★** to breathe in the fresh mountain air and marvel at the incredible colour

of this glacial lake. You can also take a short hike along the edge of the lake, and why not stop for a meal at one of the restaurants of magnificent Emerald Lake Lodge? Warning, the parking lot is small. Once again, it is best to arrive early or at the end of the day to avoid the crowds.

KICKING HORSE RIVER ★

L'activité à faire sur la rivière Kicking Horse, c'est sans contredit le **rafting sportif** en eaux vives. De nombreuses compagnies proposent des expéditions, que vous soyez expérimentés ou non. Vous apprécierez certainement le cadre naturel dans lequel cette activité se déroule.

YOHO NATIONAL PARK ★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centre: The **Yoho National Park Visitor Centre** (located on the Trans-Canada Highway in the community of Field).

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/bc/yoho



© AdobeStock, underwaternstas



CANOEING ON EMERALD LAKE

© Destination-BC, Dave Heath



© Destination-BC, Dave Health

RELAXATION EMERALD LAKE

WHERE TO EAT

1 BACCHUS BOOKS & CAFE (\$)

Bacchus Books and Café offers an eclectic selection of new and used literature. Amidst the books upstairs is a tiny but delicious cafe with excellent coffee, fresh baking and daily specials. A great spot for breakfast or a simple healthy lunch.

TOURISMGOLDEN.COM/ACTIVITIES/SHOPPING/BACCHUS-BOOKS-AND-CAFE

2 EAGLE'S EYE RESTAURANT / KICKING HORSE RESORT (\$\$-\$\$\$)

Visit Canada's highest restaurant at 7,700 feet above sea level for an exquisite mountaintop dining experience. With its panoramic views and world class menu, it will be a meal to remember.

Take the Golden Eagle Express gondola up the mountain. Reservations required.

KICKINGHORSERESORT.COM/PURCHASE/EAGLES-EYE-RESTAURANT

3 CEDAR HOUSE (\$\$\$-\$\$\$\$)

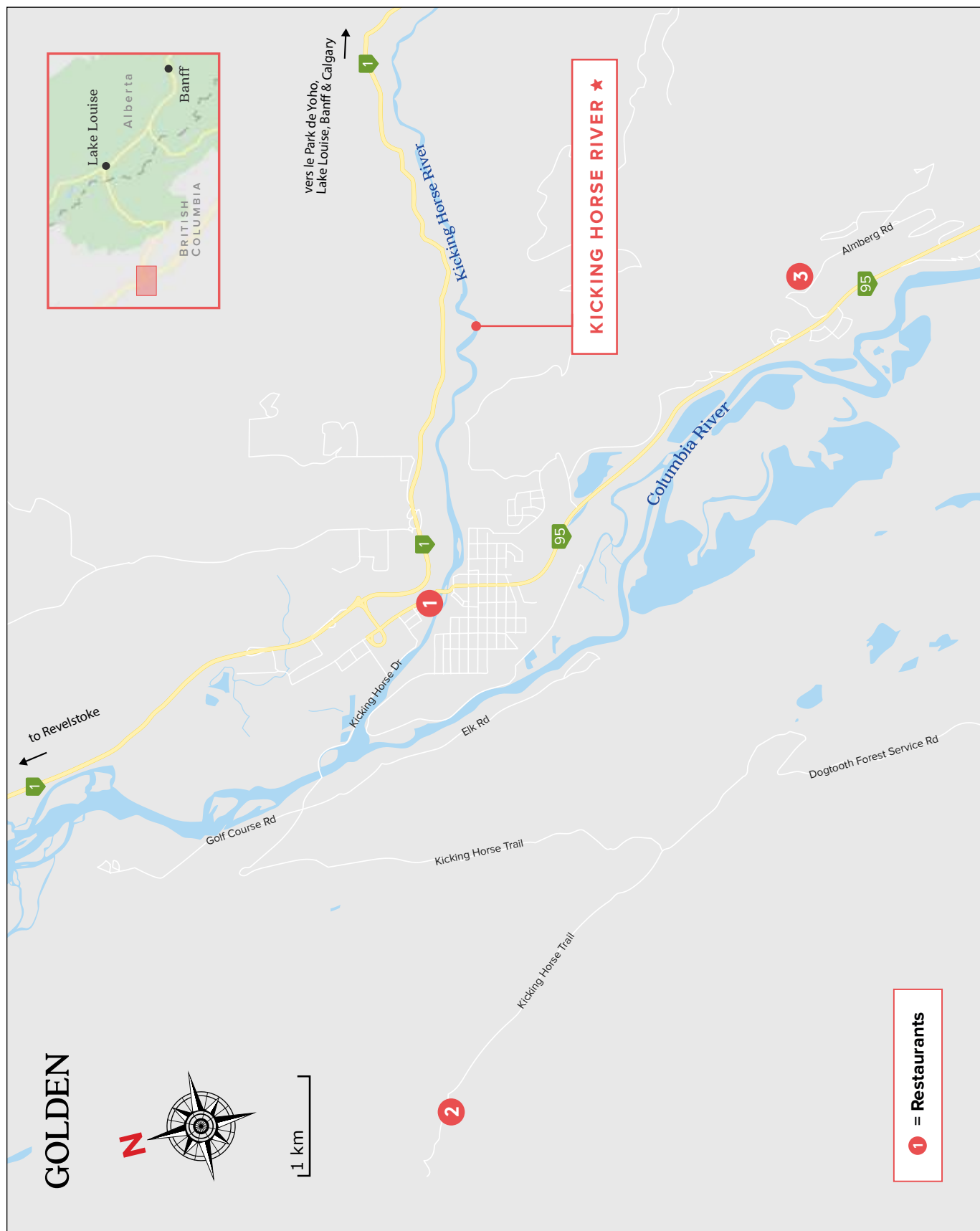
Cedar House Restaurant offers the finest dining in Golden. Indulge your taste buds in cuisine that celebrates sustainably sourced fish, natural meats, organic produce and some of BC's finest wines. The quality and freshness of the food, along with the warm and inviting decor, make for a memorable dining experience. Dinner reservations are recommended.

CEDARHOUSECHALETS.COM/RESTAURANT



© AdobeStock, Refa Trusta

KICKING HORSE RIVER



HARRISON HOT SPRINGS



The charming spa town of Harrison Hot Springs is located at the southern tip of Harrison Lake, just 90 minutes from Vancouver!

A true haven of relaxation, it is renowned for its therapeutic hot springs and surrounded by stunning landscapes and outdoor activities waiting to be explored.

Nearby, the village of Hope, with its authentic charm, and the Sasquatch Provincial Park, a paradise for nature lovers, make this region of British Columbia an ideal getaway.

Harrison Hot Springs is the perfect stop for travelers looking to unwind and recharge.

HARRISON HOT SPRINGS

WHAT TO DO

HOT SPRINGS★★

A must-do experience! The tradition of thermal spa treatments dates back centuries and was gradually introduced to Western Canada in the early 20th century, as railways began expanding.

The Harrison Hot Springs Public Pool offers an accessible alternative to the private pools of the famous Harrison Hot Springs Resort. Rich in minerals, the soothing waters reach temperatures of up to 40°C, making it the perfect spot to relax after a day of adventure.

HARRISON LAKE★

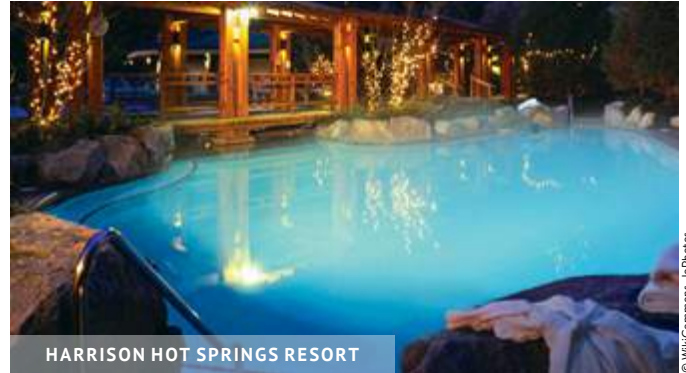
A true playground for water sports enthusiasts, Harrison Lake offers endless opportunities for adventure, from kayaking and paddleboarding to jet skiing.

Or simply unwind on the lake's scenic beaches, soaking in the breathtaking mountain views.

SASQUATCH PROVINCIAL PARK★

Named after the legendary Sasquatch, this wild paradise in British Columbia features dense forests, pristine lakes, and rugged mountains. Home to diverse wildlife—including beavers, mountain goats, salmon, and freshwater sturgeon—the park offers an authentic outdoor escape.

Perfect for nature lovers, it boasts hiking trails, swimming spots, and canoeing on the stunning Hicks Lake. Open year-round, with full services available April to October.



HARRISON HOT SPRINGS RESORT

© WikiCommons, JoPhotos



AERIAL VIEW OF HARRISON HOT SPRINGS

© Shutterstock, 1162977705, Discover Life Media



HARRISON LAKE

© Destination BC, Tom Ryan

NEARBY

HOPE AND ITS ART GALLERIES★

Hope is renowned for its intricate wood carvings, depicting animals, mythical figures, and characters. Strolling through town, you can admire over 80 sculptures. The town is

also known for its art galleries, making it a worthwhile stop for culture and creativity.

OTHELLO TUNNELS★

Located in Hope, these historic railway tunnels and bridges,

carved into the canyon walls in the early 1900s, stand as a remarkable feat of Canadian Pacific Railway engineering.

Today, they form an easy, scenic walking and biking trail along the Kettle Valley Railway, offering

spectacular views of the canyon.

Free entry, open April to October (closed in winter for safety reasons).



WELCOME TO HOPE

WHERE TO EAT

MUDDY WATER CAFE AND ESPRESSO BAR (\$\$)

With its sun-drenched patio, welcoming atmosphere and delicious, uncomplicated food,

this is the perfect place for a light meal. Also serves breakfast.

MORGAN'S BISTRO (\$\$\$)

Morgan's chef combines west coast ingredients and French technique, with delicious results! You are sure to appreciate the

creative meat dishes, warm atmosphere and lovely patio overlooking the lake.



© Shutterstock_1469379620, Kyle Hildop

HARRISON HOT SPRINGS

INSIDE PASSAGE



The Inside Passage is a cruising route that extends from Washington State to southeastern Alaska. The British Columbia portion makes up the longest section of this route. Not only will an Inside Passage cruise give you a break from driving, it will give you a chance to see many islands that would not otherwise be accessible.

INSIDE PASSAGE CRUISE

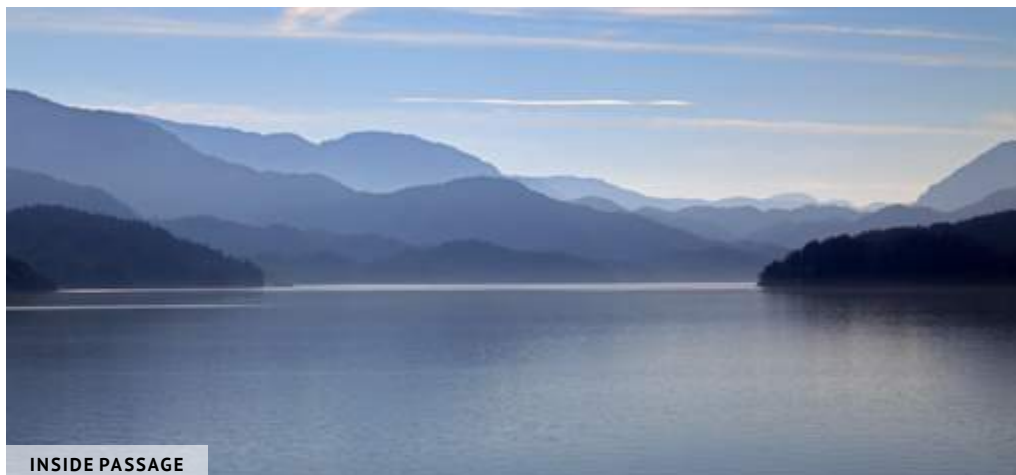
QUOI FAIRE ?

PORT HARDY TO PRINCE RUPERT CRUISE ★★★

This almost **16-hour scenic cruise** provides a wide variety of stunning coastal views and passes more than a dozen islands. You won't want to miss **Haïda Gwaii archipelago ★★★**, often compared to the Galápagos Islands because of its unique flora and fauna!

You may also see marine wildlife including dolphins, whales and sea lions. You will need to book your cruise ahead of time with your travel specialist. Essential services are provided on board, as well as a restaurant, a gift shop and a play area for the younger passengers.

In summer, the ferry leaves Port Hardy early in the morning and reaches Prince Rupert just before midnight. One stop along the way provides an opportunity to take some photos on terra firma.



INSIDE PASSAGE

© AdobeStock, Andreas Edelmann



ENCOUNTER WITH AN ORCA

© AdobeStock, ubhejane



A SEAL AND ITS BABY

© AdobeStock, Jim Vondrouš



ICEBERG

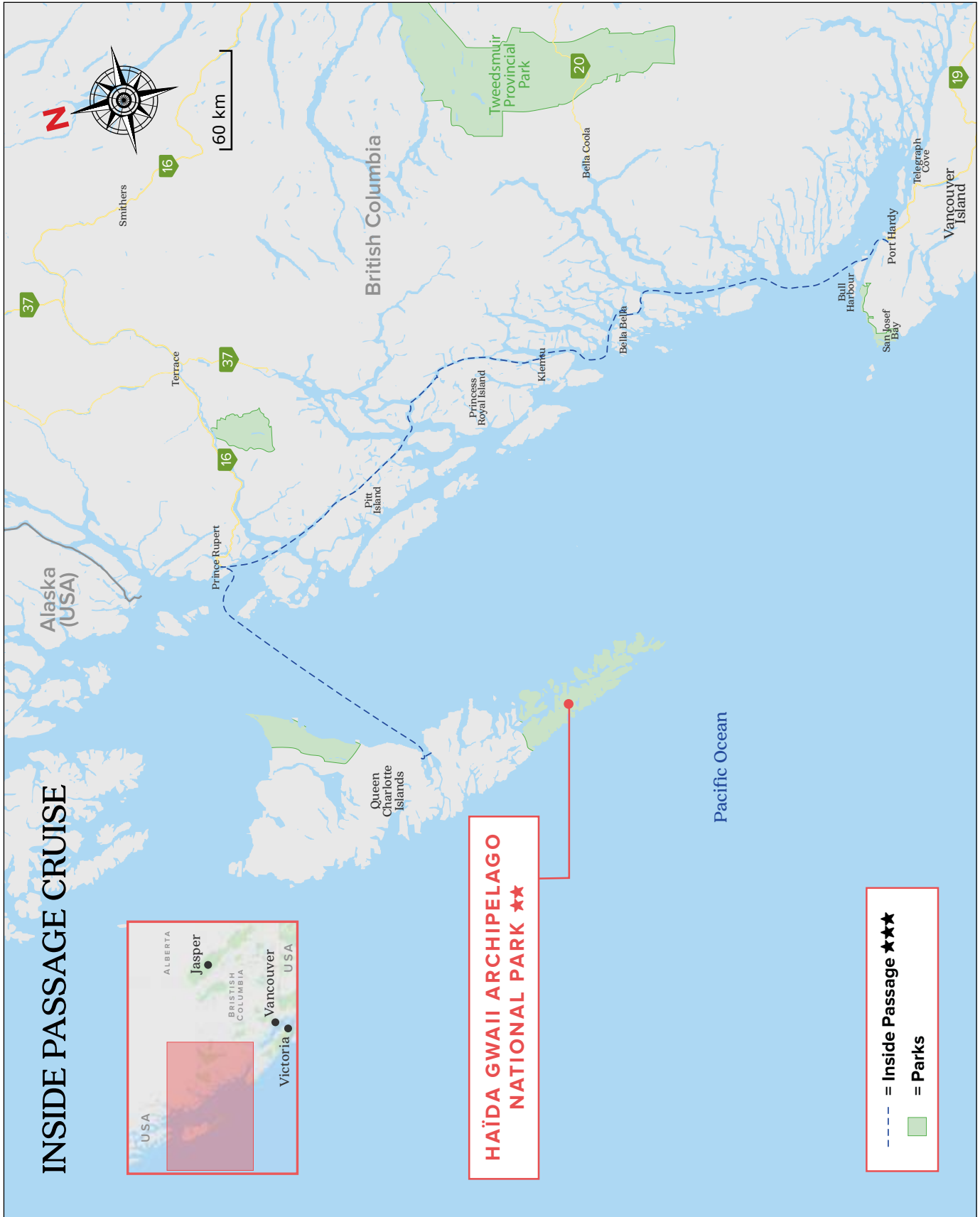
© AdobeStock, Christof



BOAT BLUFF LIGHTHOUSE



SUNSET ON THE INSIDE PASSADE



JASPER



Jasper National Park is the largest park in the Canadian Rockies and boasts more than 1,200 kilometres of hiking trails. Created in 1907, it is also one of the oldest parks in Canada. With its large population of wildlife including elk, bighorn sheep, deer and grizzly bears, Jasper National Park is one of the last large Rocky Mountain ecosystems where wildlife can be seen. Jasper and the Canadian Rockies are perfect for a Canada RV holiday, where you will be at one with nature.

LAKE MALIGNE, JASPER NATIONAL PARK

WHAT TO DO

JASPER SKYTRAM ★★★

Accessible to everyone, this gondola ride offers some of the most stunning panoramas in the Rocky Mountains. For a truly **spectacular experience** ★★★, plan to be there at **sunset**. At the top, be sure to walk the **hiking trail** to the summit of Whistler's Mountain. You will find that you are short of breath because of the high altitude (more than 2,225 metres). WWW.JASPERSKYTRAM.COM

MALIGNE LAKE CRUISE ★★★

This 90-minute cruise will take you to **Spirit Island** ★★★, the most photographed island in the world. Enjoy the azure-blue

waters and majestic scenery of this large glacial lake. The best light is in late afternoon. Tickets can be purchased in advance right in Jasper or on the website. It is recommended to take the cruise after 2 pm. to avoid the crowds and to improve your chances of spotting wildlife on the return drive. When you buy your tickets, you will have the choice between the **regular 90-minute cruise** and the **2-hour Premium cruise**. Take the time to compare the two to choose the right option for you. The regular cruise generally runs every day from early June to early October. Check their website for specific hours.

WWW.BANFFJASPERCOLLECTION.COM/ATTRACTIONS/MALIGNE-LAKE-CRUISE

JASPER NATIONAL PARK ★★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centres:

- The **Jasper Information Centre National Historic Site** (500 Connaught Drive, Jasper).
- The **Parks Canada Information desk at the Icefields Centre** (103 km south of Jasper on Highway 93).

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/ab/jasper



JASPER SKYTRAM

© Jasper Skytram



MALIGNE LAKE CRUISE

© iStock-1029194366, MJ Prototype



HIKING ON WHISTLER'S MOUNTAIN

© Authentik Canada, Simon Lemay

MOUNT EDITH CAVELL ★★

The narrow 12-km road to Mount Edith Cavell winds through the Athabasca Valley along the Athabasca river. To get to the trailheads, go 7 km south of Jasper on Highway 93 and turn right onto Highway 93A. Travel 5.4 km and turn right onto the Cavell Road, which leads to the mountain.

*** Warning, this route is unsuitable for large motorhomes (over 25 feet/7 metres).**

ANGEL GLACIER ★★
Distance (round-trip): 1.7 km
Time (round-trip): 1 hour
Level: Intermediate
Elevation gain: 87 m

A short 1.7 km (1 hour) moderate hike at the foot of the mountain offers views of the magnificent **Angel Glacier ★** and Cavell Meadows.

CAVELL MEADOWS ★★
Distance (round-trip): 8 km
Time (round-trip): 3-5 hours
Level: Difficult
Elevation gain: 370 m

You can also take the Cavell Meadows ★★ trail, which is more demanding but offers stunning views.

MALIGNE VALLEY ★★
Between Jasper and Maligne Lake, you have a good chance of **seeing wildlife** (especially black bear and bighorn sheep) close to the road. The best times for wildlife sightings are early morning and in the evening, as that is when the animals come close to the road to feed. If you have time, go for a hike in **Maligne Canyon ★★** to admire the many waterfalls that helped carve the canyon out of the surrounding limestone rock.



MALIGNE CANYON

© iStock-519643039, alarico



ANGEL GLACIER, VIEW FROM CAVELL MEADOWS

© shutterstock 73377474, lila0608

NEARBY

ICEFIELDS PARKWAY ★★★

The panoramic **Icefields Parkway** ★★★ between **Lake Louise and Jasper** offers access to a vast wilderness of pristine mountain lakes, ancient glaciers and broad sweeping valleys. You will want to stop at some of the many points of interest along the way, including:

- **Sunwapta Falls** ★
- **Athabasca Glacier** ★★★ and **Columbia Icefield**
- **Peyto Lake** ★★★ (an easy 30-minute hike leads to an exceptional viewpoint)
- **Bow Lake** ★★
- **Athabasca Falls** ★★

OTHER EXCURSIONS NEAR JASPER

LAKE ANNETTE:

Lake Annette, located 7 km from Jasper, is the perfect spot for families or groups to **stop for a swim**. Enjoy a picnic on the edge of the clear glacier-fed lake in a magical setting with a **spectacular view of the Rockies**. And if you want to stretch your legs, you can even take a **short hike around the lake**. The interpretive 2.4 km paved loop is wheelchair accessible.

OLD FORT POINT LOOP:

This magnificent hiking trail is a steep 3.8 km (1-2 hrs./130 m elevation gain) loop leading to **stunning views of the valley, the Canadian Rockies and the town of Jasper**. 2 km from Jasper.

Visit the **Jasper Information Centre** (500 Connaught Drive, Jasper) for more information and free brochures.



ATHABASCA FALLS

© DollarPhotoClub, PictureGuy32



PEYTO LAKE

© Shutterstock, 227713219-Yongyut Kumrui

FEU DE FORÊT

En juillet 2024, un feu de forêt majeur a ravagé environ 32 000 hectares du parc national de Jasper, soit environ 2.94% du territoire totale, transformant une partie du paysage

Bien que dévastateur, ce phénomène naturel joue un rôle essentiel dans la régénération des écosystèmes. La forêt mettra des années à se renouveler, offrant aux visiteurs un témoignage unique de la résilience de la nature.

FESTIVAL

Jasper Folk Music Festival

Dates : mid-September

This family festival in the heart of the Rockies is a late summer celebration featuring excellent local music in a magical setting. In addition to shows and jam sessions, there is something for everyone with yoga, meditation, children's activities, good food and a beer garden.

www.jasperfolkmusicfestival.ca

WHERE TO EAT

1 PATRICIA STREET DELI (\$)

As most visitors to Jasper spend at least a few days hiking or exploring the surrounding wilderness, it seemed like a good idea to recommend this emporium of sandwiches-to-go. A favourite with locals and tourists alike.

2 DOWNSTREAM RESTAURANT & LOUNGE (\$\$-\$\$\$)

This modern restaurant and lounge captures Jasper's mountain town spirit and casual feel. The fresh innovative bistro cuisine and quality service draw a great many visitors and loyal guests. Great food and a good wine list.

3 EVIL DAVE'S GRILL (\$\$-\$\$\$)

A popular casual restaurant serving creative, globally inspired fare along with specialty cocktails & wine. Dinner reservations are recommended, especially in high season. The eclectic "evil"-themed menu is sure to make you smile.

WWW.EVILDAVESGRILL.COM



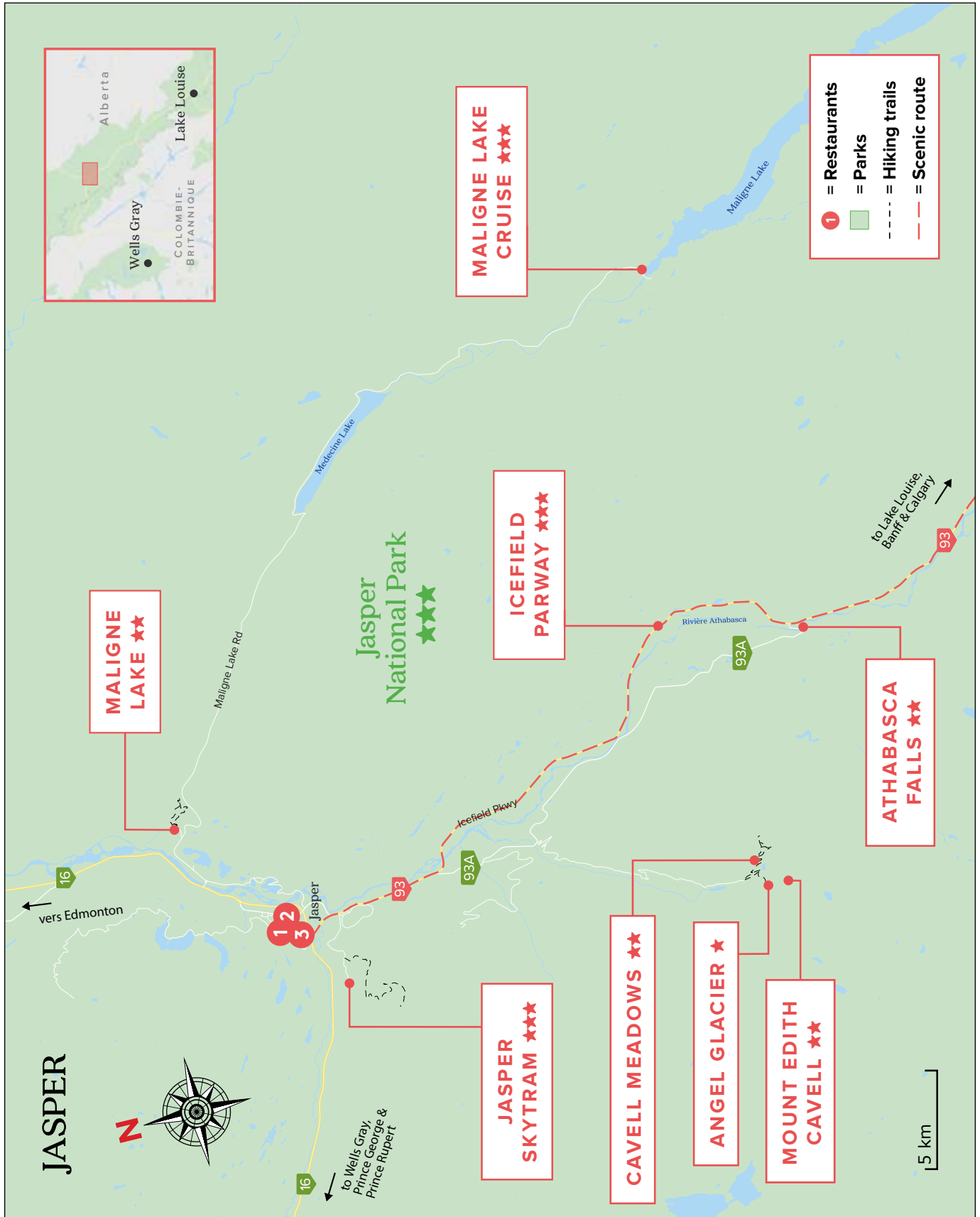
SPIRIT ISLAND ON MALIGNE LAKE

© DollarPhotoClub, Dandelumunro



BIGHORN SHEEP

© iStockPhoto, iWildLife



LAKE LOUISE



Lake Louise is known as the "Jewel of Canada", and for good reason. With its shimmering turquoise green water and surrounding snow-capped mountains, Lake Louise is a spectacular postcard-perfect destination that you won't want to miss.

CANOES ON LAKE LOUISE

WHAT TO DO

LAKE LOUISE ★★★

The iconic lake is located just behind the **Fairmont Château Lake Louise**, one of the most prestigious buildings in the region. A paved trail runs along the water's edge for about 2 kilometres, with beautiful views of the lake, mountains, glacier, and the Château.

PLAIN OF SIX GLACIERS ★★★

Distance (round-trip): 10.6 km

Time (round-trip): 4-5 hours

Level: Intermediate

Elevation gain: 365 metres

To truly experience the magnificence of your surroundings, hike to the Plain of Six Glaciers. This moderately challenging and spectacular high mountain trail is 5.3 kilometres long (each way), with an elevation gain of 365 metres. The round-trip will take about 4-5 hours. You can stop for tea at an altitude of 2100 metres.

BANFF NATIONAL PARK / LAKE LOUISE SECTOR ★★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centre: The Lake Louise Visitor Centre (201 Village St., Lake Louise).

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/ab/banff



PLAIN OF SIX GLACIERS

© iStock-95854650, Photawa



FAIRMONT CHÂTEAU LAKE LOUISE

© AdobeStock, ImagineGolf



LAKE LOUISE WITH THE FAMILY

© Authentik Canada, Simon Lemay

MORAINE LAKE ★★★

This immense turquoise lake is in the lovely Valley of the Ten Peaks, about 14 kilometres from the village of Lake Louise. The best time to visit is in July, when the reflected sunlight gives the water its stunning blue colour. Many people consider Moraine Lake to be the most beautiful spot in the Rockies. **The road to Moraine Lake is now closed to personal vehicles.** Read below for more details.



© shutterstock_705747895, Nick Fox

CANOE ON MORaine LAKE



© WikiCommon Media, Mike Boehmer

MORaine LAKE

MAKE THE MOST OF YOUR VISIT!

Lake Louise and Moraine Lake are extremely popular destinations and can be difficult to access in high season. Here is some important information to help you plan ahead:

- In summer and fall, the parking lots at Lake Louise fill up early in the day. **Arrive at Lake Louise before 9 am or after 7 pm.**
- Moraine Lake is open from **late May to early October**. The road to Moraine Lake is **only accessible via the shuttle service**. Personal vehicles access is now prohibited.
- **Free shuttle service** is available between the Lake Louise Park and Ride and the lake itself, daily from **mid-May to mid-October**. Shuttles leave the parking lot for Lake Louise **every 20 minutes**, and the **last shuttle leaves the lake at 7:30 pm**. If you are going to pick up an RV rental in Calgary, it is strongly recommended that you use this shuttle service.
- **Free and mandatory shuttle service** is also available between the Lake Louise Park and Ride and **Moraine Lake**, daily from **early June to mid-October**. Shuttles leave the parking lot **every 20 minutes**, and the last shuttle leaves the lake at **7:30 pm**. **Reservation is required and possible 48 hours in advance only** (can be done online).
- If you plan to go hiking at one of the lakes, take an early shuttle to avoid the crowds.

For further information about transportation in the Lake Louise area, go to the Lake Louise Visitor Centre or call 403-522-3833.

NEARBY

YOHO NATIONAL PARK ★★

This national park offers much more than a forest and towering rock faces. Take the time to visit **Takakkaw Falls ★★**, plunging a dramatic

254 meters over a rock face. Accessible mid-June until mid-October to small vehicles and bicycles only due to **steep, tight switchbacks**. The parking lot fills early, so it is better to arrive at the beginning or

end of the day. You will also want to stop off at **Emerald Lake ★★** to breathe in the fresh mountain air and marvel at the incredible colour of this glacial lake. You can also take a short hike along the edge of

the lake. Or why not enjoy a meal at one of the restaurants of the superb Emerald Lake Lodge? Warning, parking is limited. Once again, arrive early or at the end of the day to avoid the crowds.

YOHO NATIONAL PARK ★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centre: The **Yoho National Park Visitor Centre**, located on the Trans-Canada Highway.

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/bc/yoho



TAKAKKAW FALLS

© iStockPhoto, Robas



AERIAL VIEW OF LAKE LOUISE

WHERE TO EAT

1 PLAIN OF SIX GLACIERS TEA HOUSE (\$)

The Plain of Six Glaciers hiking trail follows the shore of Lake Louise before climbing up to a charming tea house at an elevation of 2,100 metres. Enjoy a cup of tea or lemonade and some delicious fresh-baked goods while admiring the view. Note that the tea house only accepts cash, and the only way to get there is on foot (a 4-hour round trip hike).

P6TEAHOUSE.COM

2 LAKE LOUISE STATION (\$\$-\$\$\$)

Dine in the oldest building in Lake Louise, the historic Lake Louise railway station. Try a bison burger, or go with the recommendations of your wait staff. The grounds offer a lovely view of the Bow River.

LAKELOUISESTATION.COM

3 POST HOTEL & SPA (\$\$\$\$)

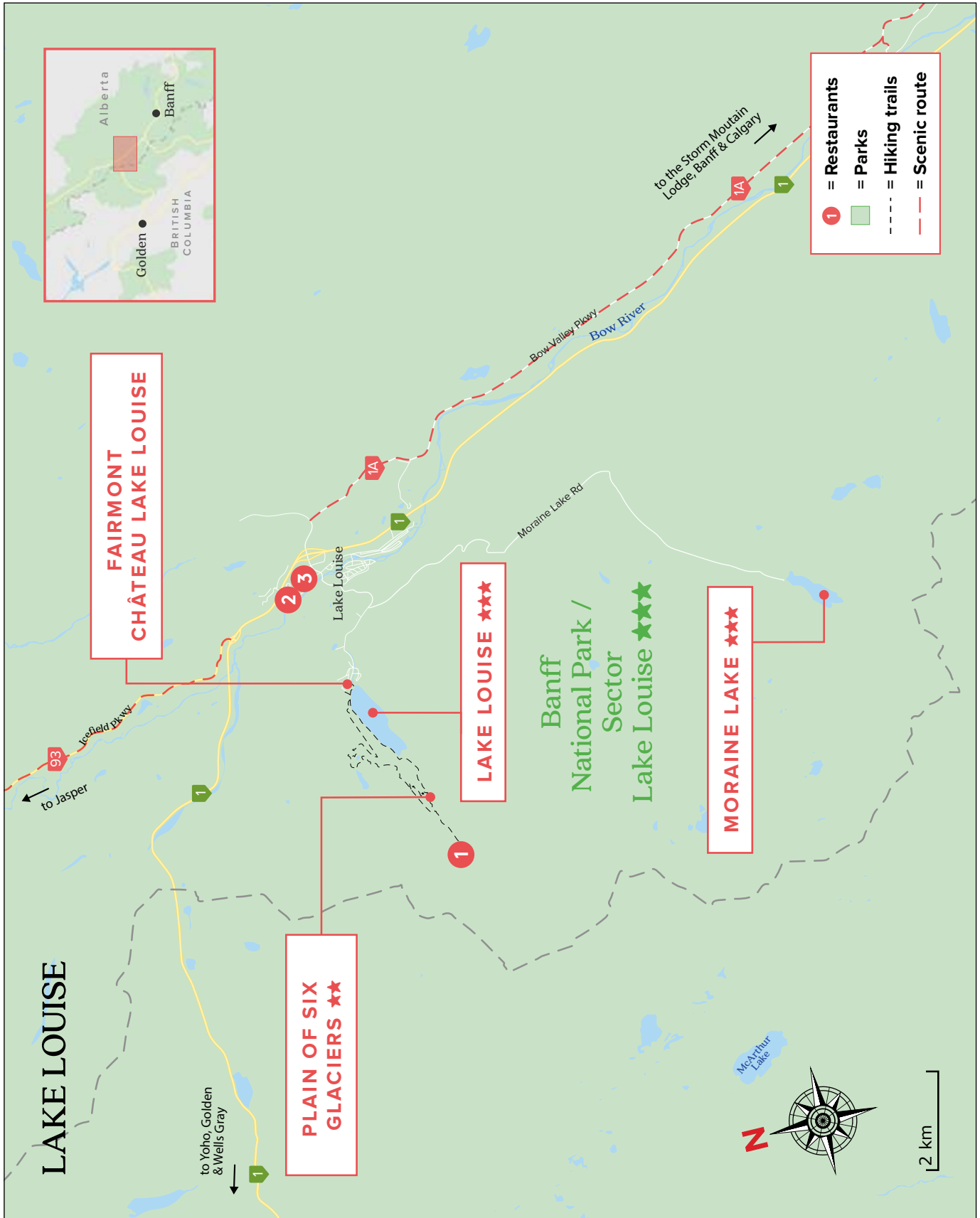
Post Hotel & Spa is a Relais & Châteaux establishment offering European-inspired fine Canadian cuisine. For a truly inspired epicurean experience, opt for the six-course gourmet menu. Advance dinner reservations are required. *Dress code to respect: no sportswear, T-shirts or shorts.*

POSTHOTEL.COM/CAUISINE/DINING

4 STORM MOUNTAIN LODGE (\$\$\$)

Halfway between Banff and Lake Louise, Storm Mountain Lodge is a popular place for a romantic meal, be it breakfast, lunch or dinner. Experience fine dining in the rustic yet chic decor of this charming log lodge. Signature dishes feature beef and wild fish. *Reservations mandatory.*

STORMMOUNTAINLODGE.COM





NORTHERN VANCOUVER ISLAND



Come immerse yourself in the natural beauty of northern Vancouver Island! The region abounds in opportunities for **fishing** and **whale watching**. Don't miss **Cape Scott Provincial Park**, a magnificent area of rugged coastal wilderness which offers hiking trails of every level. Keep an eye out for wildlife, including bears, wolves, eagles and even cougars. You will also learn more about the region's rich First Nations culture. A must-see!

PORT HARDY, BRITISH COLUMBIA

WHAT TO DO

PORT HARDY ★

Port Hardy ★ is a quaint fishing and logging town in a setting teeming with marine and terrestrial wildlife. Located near Port Hardy, **Fort Rupert** ★ is the site of an old Hudson's Bay Company fort that was first built and commissioned by William Henry McNeill in 1849.

QUATSE SALMON STEWARDSHIP CENTRE ★

Salmon play a central role in the ecosystem of the waters around Port Hardy. The Quatse Salmon Stewardship Centre serves as an **interpretive center, salmon hatchery, and educational facility** for the public and provides a fascinating glimpse into the world of west coast salmon. Visitors of all ages will gain insight into the issues linked to salmon conservation.

WWW.THESALMONCENTRE.ORG

QUATSE RIVER ★

The Quatse River Estuary is home to bald eagles. The best bird watching spot in Port Hardy is the viewing platform overlooking the marshy wetlands of the estuary, where bald eagles, other birds of prey and seabirds can be seen soaring overhead.



MARINA OF PORT HARDY

© Mapro, Julus10



QUATSE RIVER STEWARDSHIP CENTRE

© Destination BC, Yerahvidih



BALD EAGLE

© AdobeStock, Bill



SEA LIONS

© AdobeStock, birdlegal

TELEGRAPH COVE ★★★

Telegraph Cove ★★★ is a **tiny picturesque village** that seems frozen in time. A walk through the boardwalk village will leave you with the impression that you have stepped into a different place and time. It is also the departure point for **whale watching cruises** and kayak excursions. Jacques Cousteau called Telegraph Cove one of the best places in the world to view and enjoy Orcas (killer whales) in their natural environment! Given the **large number of orcas** that spend the summer months in the waters around Telegraph Cove, the chance of a sighting is extremely high.

© HelloBC, Bootleg



TELEGRAPH COVE MARINA

CAPE SCOTT PROVINCIAL PARK★★



Located 64 km west of Port Hardy, this **provincial park** is the perfect place for a **wilderness hike** through rainforests, bogs and beaches. Named after a lighthouse that has guided mariners since 1960, Cape Scott features more than **115 km of coastline**, including approximately **30 km of spectacular secluded beaches**.

The most impressive of these beaches is **Nels Bight★★**.

WWW.ENY.GOV.BC.CA/BCPARKS/EXPLORE/PARKPGS/CAPE_SCOTT

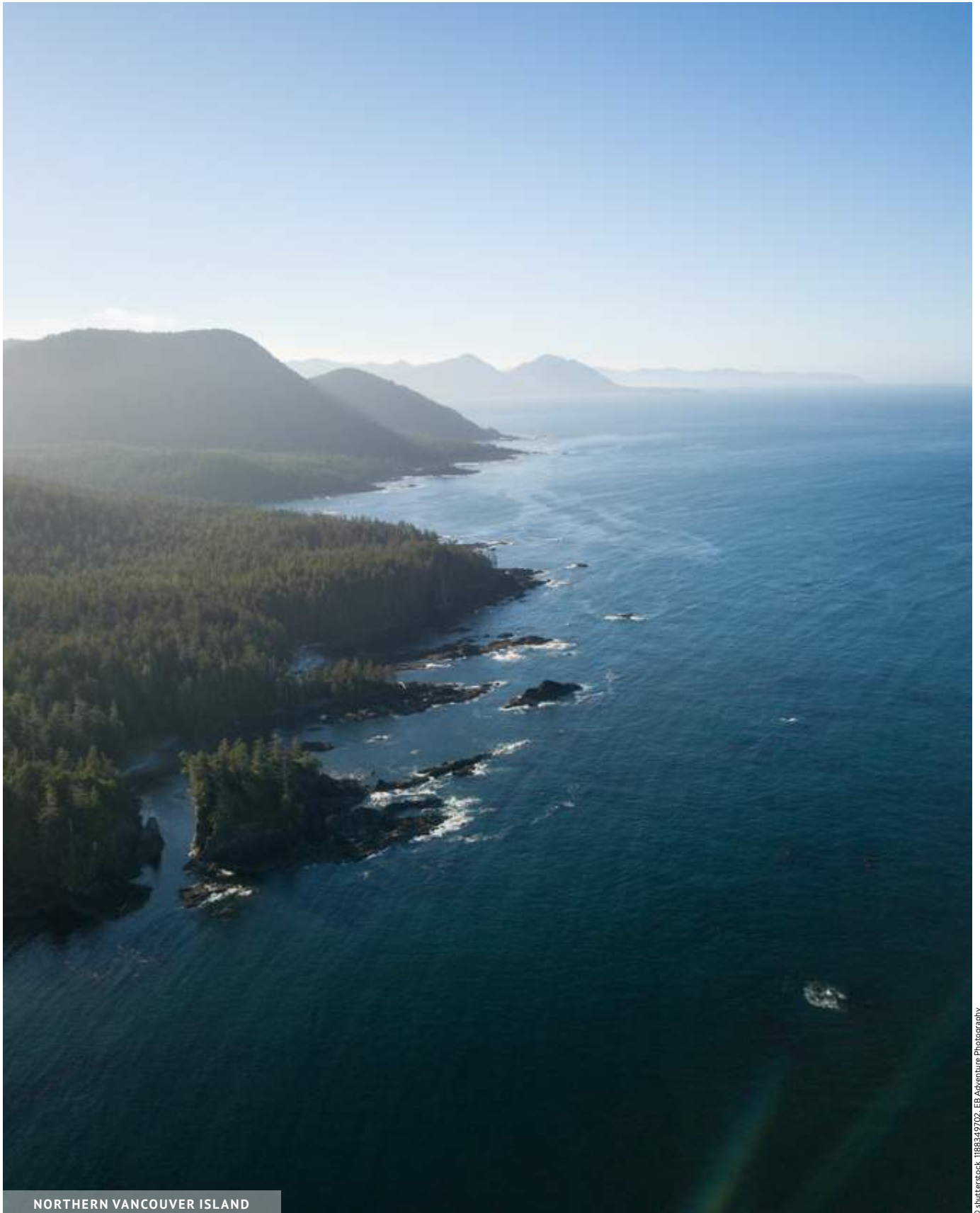
© Destination BC, JF Bergeron



TELEGRAPH COVE



SAN JOSEF BAY, CAPE SCOTT PROVINCIAL PARK



NORTHERN VANCOUVER ISLAND

© shutterstock, 1188349702, EB Adventure Photography



ORCA NEAR PORT HARDY

WHERE TO EAT

1 SPORTY BAR & GRILL (\$\$)

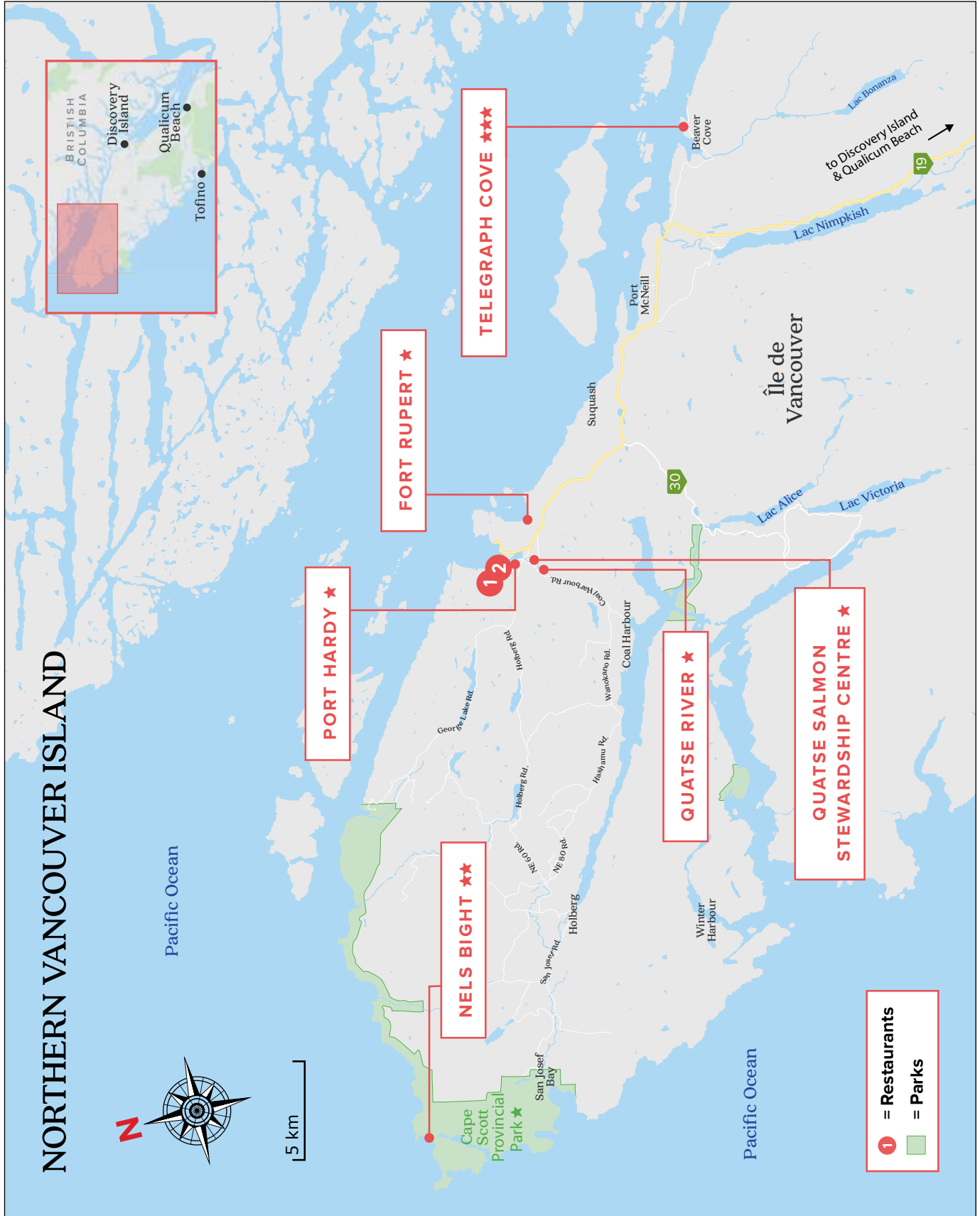
Sporty Bar & Grill is probably your best choice of restaurant in the area, but don't be fooled by appearances. Serves local food with a European flare (the owner/chef is from Austria), prepared from fresh ingredients, in a pub atmosphere. The menu features soups, salads, sandwiches and pizzas, as well as a wide variety of meat, fish and pasta dishes. Don't miss the seafood chowder and fish tacos. WWW.SPORTYBAR.CA

2 CAFE GUIDO (\$\$-\$\$\$)

Very popular with locals and visitors alike, this friendly café is the ideal spot for a good breakfast or lunch in a casual atmosphere. Gift shop featuring local crafts and bookstore under the same roof. WWW.CAFEGUIDO.COM



MARINA OF TELEGRAPH COVE



OKANAGAN VALLEY



Renowned for its vineyards and fruit orchards, the Okanagan Valley is a haven of peace and one of the warmest and sunniest regions in all of Canada. The Okanagan Valley stretches for some 200 kilometres and is home to the arid vineyard-covered hills overlooking Okanagan Lake. With its more than 200 vineyards, the Okanagan is a must-see destination for wine-lovers! The region's primary city is Kelowna, but there are also many other interesting places to visit: Osoyoos, with the warmest temperatures in Canada; Penticton, which means "a place to stay forever"; Oliver; Peachland; Keremeos... The Okanagan Valley has so much to offer visitors: swimming, water activities on the lake, fine dining, winery tours, hiking, and much more!

WINERY IN OKANAGAN VALLEY

WHAT TO DO

WATERFRONT PARK ★

Close to the Kelowna Marina you will find Waterfront Park, a round green space in the heart of the city offering a lovely, peaceful outdoor environment. Concerts and performances of all kinds are frequently held on the small outdoor stage. Take a long walk along the circular boardwalk along the water's edge or enjoy a picnic lunch while admiring the magnificent scenery of Okanagan Lake and the opposite shore.

SWIMMING IN OKANAGAN LAKE ★★

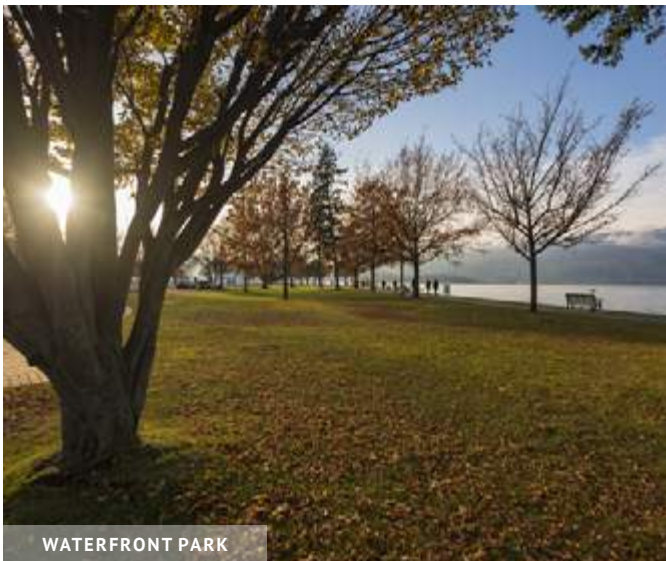


Hot Sands Beach, not far from Waterfront Park in downtown Kelowna, offers a long sandy beach, grassy fields, playground, waterpark, washroom and change room facilities and on-site rentals. With its white sand, clear water and hot sun, you will feel like you are in the Caribbean. It's a great place for a swim and fun for the whole family!



SWIMMING IN OKANAGAN LAKE

© iStock-1010211350, Lightguard



WATERFRONT PARK

© iStock-1192494338, onurkurtc



SUNSET ON KELOWNA

© DollarPhotoClub, Chris Gardiner



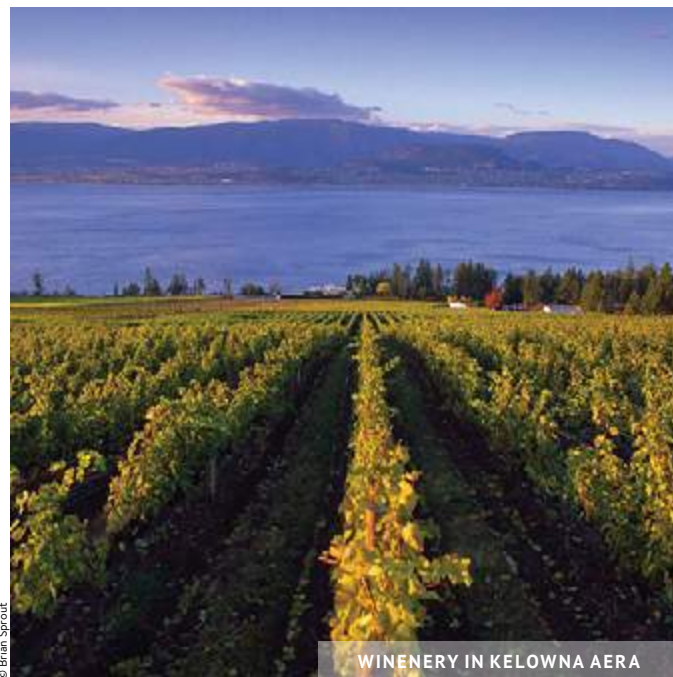
ROADTRIP IN THE VALLEY

© Wikimedia Commons, IDPhoto

WINERY TOUR ★★

The Okanagan Valley is home to more than 200 wineries, and has more wineries per square kilometer than anywhere else in Canada! **Mission Hill Family Estate** (1730 Mission Hill Road, West Kelowna), **Inniskillin Okanagan Vineyards** (7857 Tuclelnuit Drive, Oliver) and **Quail's Gate Winery** (3303 Boucherie Road, West Kelowna)

are three of the region's renowned wineries located close to Kelowna. Each estate offers different tour options for visitors. These may include a guided tour of the vineyard to learn about the grape varieties and the winery's history, a guided tour of the production area and the wine cellar, and a wine tasting with snacks.



WINENERY IN KELOWNA AERA

KNOX MOUNTAIN PARK ★★

Situated just north of Kelowna, Knox Mountain Park is the largest natural outdoor area in the city. The park offers many well-maintained trails and is a wonderful place for hiking and mountain biking. With its mild climate, the park is home to a variety of wildlife. If you

pay attention, you may even see a lynx or a rattlesnake! The summit offers a stunning view of Okanagan Lake. If you are lucky enough to be there at the end of the day, you will enjoy a magnificent sunset over the lake.

[KELOWNA.CA/PARKS-RECREATION/PARKS-BEACHES/PARKS-BEACHES-LISTING/KNOX-MOUNTAIN-PARK](https://kelowna.ca/parks-recreation/parks-beaches/parks-beaches-listing/knox-mountain-park)



MISSION HILL FAMILY ESTATE



VIEW ON OKANAGAN LAKE FROM KNOX MOUNTAIN PARK



KETTLE VALLEY RAIL TRAIL, MYRA CANYON

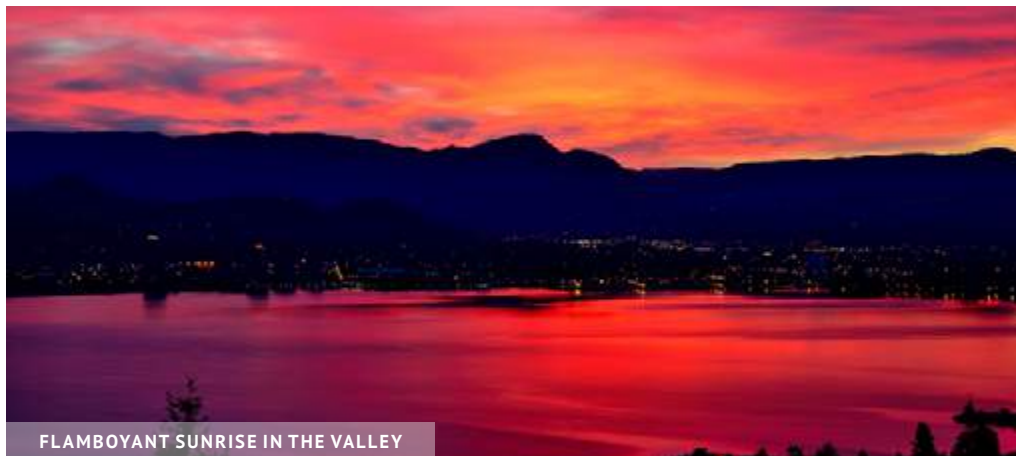
FESTIVAL

Okanagan Wine Festivals

Dates : summer, fall, winter and spring

Home to more than 120 wineries, the Okanagan Valley is the oldest and largest wine region in British Columbia. The Okanagan hosts four wine festivals, one each season of every year: there's always something to celebrate in wine country!

THEWINEFESTIVALS.COM



FLAMBOYANT SUNRISE IN THE VALLEY

© iStock/1185514504, John-Maxymuk



VINEYARD OVERLOOKING OKANAGAN LAKE

© Shutterstock, 489165885, Stan Jones



© BC Parks Photo

SEA KAYAKING AT SUNSET ON OKANAGAN LAKE



© BC Parks Photo

RESTING ON THE BEACH



© Wikimedia Commons

TOWN OF KELOWNA

WHERE TO EAT

1 BOHEMIAN CAFÉ & CATERING CO. (\$\$)

This little coffee place in downtown Kelowna started off in 1991 as a brother-sister duo. The restaurant has since grown but retained the same fundamental values: serve home cooked meals in the most welcoming atmosphere.

BOHEMIANCATER.COM

2 SUNNY'S – A MODERN DINER (\$\$\$)

founded by the dynamic duo Audrey Surrao and Chef Rod Butters, expanded their restaurant portfolio in Spring 2018 with the addition of Sunny's, a modern diner. The name "Sunny's" is a heartfelt tribute to the owners' beloved golden retriever, Sunny, whose photogenic nature and unforgettable presence inspired the restaurant's name. It also cleverly reflects the bright, sunny atmosphere of the Okanagan Valley, where the restaurant enjoys a prime location overlooking Lake Okanagan. Sunny's combines warmth, nostalgia, and the vibrant spirit of the region in a charming, modern setting.

SUNNYSMODERNDINER.COM

3 OAK + CRU (\$\$-\$\$\$)

This restaurant boasts a lakeside location in the heart of downtown Kelowna. OAK makes reference to the abundance of oak used throughout the restaurant's décor and in the wine aging process, while CRU is a French wine term meaning vintage and alluding to growth and the bounty of the Okanagan valley. In addition to a delicious meal with a beautiful view, you can also enjoy craft cocktails, good beers and excellent local wines.

OAKANDCRUMENUS.COM

4 OLD WINES RESTAURANT - QUAIL'S GATE WINERY (\$\$\$)

Old Vines Restaurant & Wine Bar has an exceptional vineyard-side location on the slopes of the Boucherie Mountain, a short drive across the river from downtown Kelowna. The menu features locally-sourced ingredients paired perfectly with Quail's Gate Estate's own wines. If you are lucky enough to be seated on the patio in summer, you will witness one of the most sublime sunsets in the region. Reservations are recommended for this very popular restaurant!

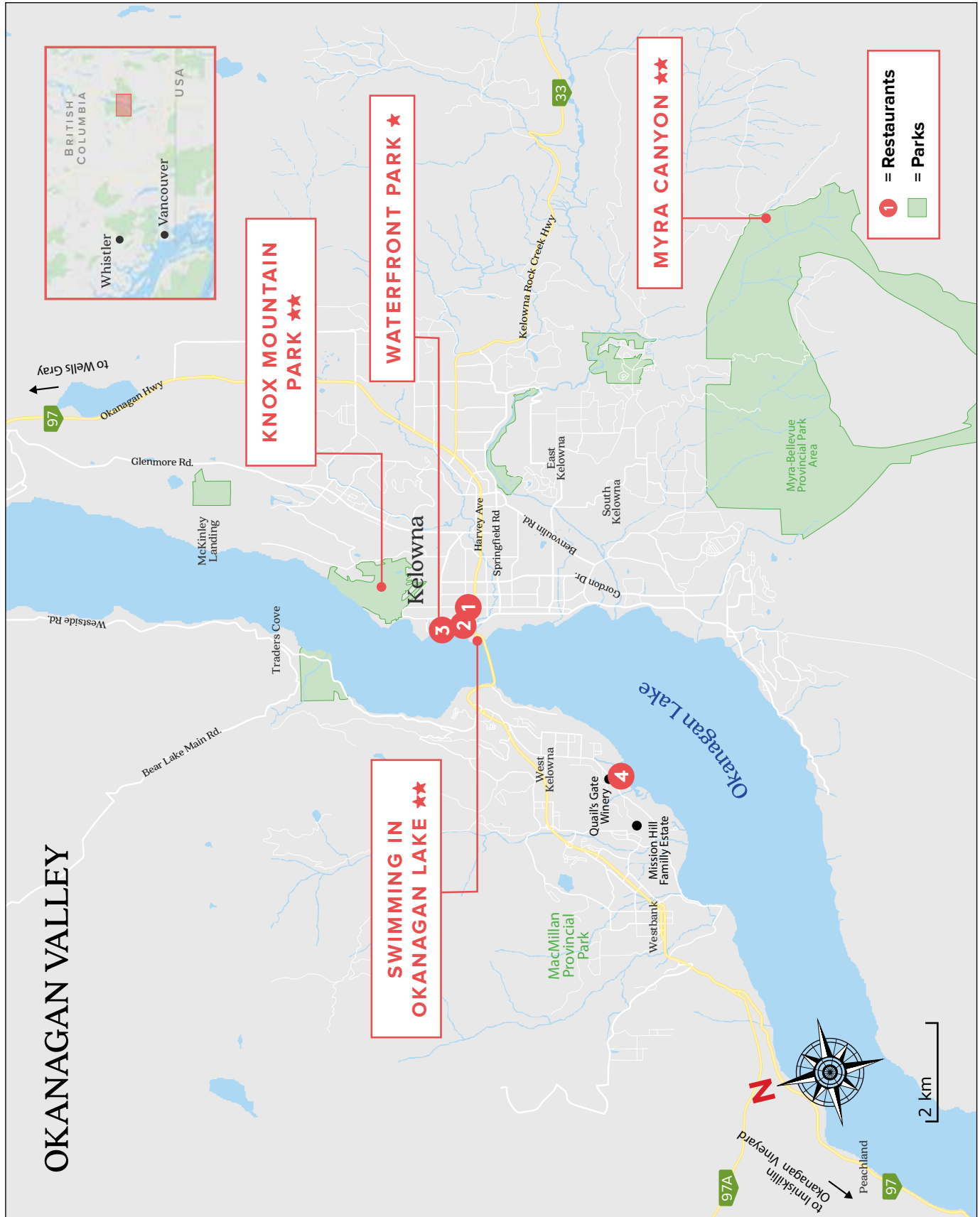
QUAILSGATE.COM/DINE

FRUIT, VEGETABLES AND OTHER MARKET PRODUCE

There are many farms in the Okanagan where you can stop to pick, sample or drink of nature's bounty, and the roadsides abound with farm stands to fill your picnic basket and get your daily dose of fresh vitamins!

Harvest seasons:

- Cherries: end June to mid-July
- Peaches: mid-July to mid-September
- Apples: mid-July to mid-September
- Plums: mid-July to mid-September
- Apricots: mid-July to mid-August
- Pears: mid-August to mid-October
- Grapes: early September to mid-October



PACIFIC RIM



The Pacific Rim region is on **Vancouver Island** ★★ and includes Ucluelet, Pacific Rim National Park Reserve and Tofino. As its name suggests, Pacific Rim is on the edge of the Pacific Ocean. Grey whales pass close to the shoreline in the spring during their annual migration north to their summer feeding grounds, making whale watching one of the region's main attractions.

SUNSET IN LONG BEACH

WHAT TO DO

LONG BEACH ★★

A variety of different trails, such as **Wickaninnish Trail** and **Schooner Trail**, lead down to the beach, all of which take under an hour to walk. Located between Ucluelet and Tofino, this **vast stretch of sand** is ideal for casual strolls and is a real surfers' paradise. Don't miss **sunset** ★★★ over the Pacific Ocean.

BIG TREE TRAIL ★★

Distance (round-trip): 2.4 km or 4.2 km (loop)

Time (round-trip): 1 hour or 2½ hours

Level: Easy

Big Tree Trail is located on Meares Island, accessible only by a 10-minute boat ride from Tofino: one of the most enjoyable ways to get there is by **sea kayak**. Big Tree Trail has some of the largest trees in British Columbia and leads to the **largest western red cedar tree** on the west coast. The trees of the old-growth forest are about 1,500 years old. It is an enchanting place to go for a stroll. We recommend Remote Passages Marine Excursions in Tofino (Wharf Street).

REMOTEPASSAGES.COM

TOFINO ★

Despite its reputation as "Canada's surfing capital", Tofino is first and foremost a charming village of fishermen and artists. You will enjoy strolling through its streets, visiting its First Nations boutiques and art galleries, or taking a break in a café or one of its many restaurants. The stunning and diverse natural environment is worth the detour to the other side of the island.

PACIFIC RIM NATIONAL PARK RESERVE ★★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centres:

- The **Pacific Rim Visitor Centre** (located at the intersection of Highway 4 and the Tofino-Ucluelet Highway).
- The **Kwitsis Visitor Centre** (located at the south end of Wickaninnish Beach).

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/bc/pacificrim



BIG TREE TRAIL

© Destination BC, J. Bergeron



AERIAL VIEW OF TOFINO

© shutterstock_796740559, Russ Henli

RADAR HILL ★

Distance (round-trip): 0.2 km
Time (round-trip): 15 minutes
Level: Easy

Located in the heart of Pacific Rim National Park Reserve, Radar Hill offers magnificent views of Tofino beach at sunset. Easily accessible by car. Don't miss it, time and visibility permitting!

UCLUELET ART GALLERIES ★

Ucluelet has many beautiful art galleries, several of which are located on the main street through town. These galleries are a great way to learn more about First Nations culture, which still has a significant presence in the region.

WILD PACIFIC TRAIL ★★

The Wild Pacific Trail in Ucluelet, on the west coast of Vancouver Island, is in fact a network combining three exceptional hiking trails: Lighthouse Loop, Brown's Beach to Artist Loop, and Ancient Cedars & Rocky Bluffs, with a total length of

about 9 km. Venture into BC's temperate rainforest, along the wild Pacific coast. The Wild Pacific Trail was brought to life through the efforts of a visionary affectionately known as "Oyster Jim Martin", and access has always been free. Secure donation boxes are provided on site for visitors wishing to make a donation to help build and maintain the trails. Discovery programs are shared on site and you can watch educational videos on the web site.

WILDPACIFICTRAIL.COM

LIGHTHOUSE LOOP ★★

Distance (round-trip): 2.6 km (loop)
Time (round-trip): 1 hour
Level: Easy

If you only have time to walk one section, it should be **Lighthouse Loop**, starting from **Amphitrite Lighthouse**. This **easy 2.6 km loop** (45-60 minutes to walk) features many viewpoints and benches offering dramatic views of the ocean and Barkley Sound. The sunsets over the water are spectacular!

FREE SHUTTLE TO TOFINO!

The Tofino Shuttle is a free service that makes getting around the village easy. Anyone can hop on and hop off at any stop along the way and surfboards are welcome on board as well. In service from late June to early September. Visit the website for more information.

www.tofino.ca/tofinofreeshuttle



VIEW FROM RADAR HILL



LIGHTHOUSE LOOP



WILD PACIFIC TRAIL

EN ROUTE TO TOFINO AND UCLUELET...

Here are a few **magnificent stops** along the way to Tofino and Ucluelet (or on the way back):

CATHEDRAL GROVE ★★

Cathedral Grove is a majestic stand of **giant Douglas fir trees** in MacMillan Provincial Park. On your way to your next destination, be sure to stop and take a stroll under the shadow of these towering pillars untouched by the modern world. Open daily from 7 am to 11 pm. The park is 25 km west of Qualicum Beach and 16km east of Port Alberni, on Highway 4.

www.env.gov.bc.ca/bcparks/explore/parkpgs/macmillan

HOLE IN THE WALL

This unusual short hike just outside Port Alberni is an interesting place to stop and stretch your legs! The short **25-minute round-trip** walk takes you through the forest to the famous **Hole in the Wall**, a massive man-made hole through a shale cliff along the banks of Rogers Creek, which was once a shortcut for the city's water pipeline. The pipeline was eventually removed, leaving a **hole with a picturesque waterfall**, a favourite spot with the locals. Park at Coombs County Candy Store (and stock up on candy while you're there!), then cross to the other side of Alberni Highway where you will find a gravel path just to the right of a low concrete wall. The beginning of the trail is unmarked, but wooden signs further on mark the way to the waterfall.

WALLY CREEK

On the way to Tofino, be sure to stop at Wally Creek, a beautiful rocky section of the Kennedy River, with waterfalls and water pools. About 50 km (45 minutes) after Port Alberni, you will see a car pull-out area and "love lock" fence on the right side of the road. There is generally space to park. This is a fabulous spot to stop and stretch your legs, have a picnic or even go swimming. Be very careful as the rocks can be quite slippery and the river current is strong.

WHAT ABOUT SOME SURFING?

With its 35 kilometres of open beaches, Tofino is the **surfing capital of Canada**, and the ultimate place to learn to surf. The town is home to more than a dozen surfing schools offering a variety of formulas, from classic group lessons to family, children's or private lessons, for every level. The ocean water is extremely cold, but with your "wetsuit" on, we promise you won't feel a thing!

Founded in 1998, the **Pacific Surf Company** was one of Tofino's first surf schools. They offer lessons year round, and all equipment is always included. The maximum student to instructor ratio is 5:1, so you can be sure of getting lots of personal attention and instruction.

pacificsurfschool.com

ROAD WORKS ON HIGHWAY 4

A major road improvement project is planned for the Kennedy Hill area of Highway 4 (adjacent to Kennedy Lake), over a distance of approximately 1.5 km. This may have a significant impact on your movements, depending on when you are driving through the area. In general, single-lane alternating traffic will be enforced during the day (which could cause delays of up to 30 minutes) and the road will be closed for certain periods overnight. Work is expected to be completed in Spring 2023.

For more information, visit:
news.gov.bc.ca/releases/2020TRAN0153-001828

FESTIVALS

Ukee Days

Dates : end of July

Ukee Days is a 3-day family-oriented festival celebrating west coast life. The peaceful fishing village of Ucluelet comes alive with activities including live concerts, logger sports, a parade and a salmon BBQ.
UKEEDAYS.WORDPRESS.COM

Pacific Rim Summer Festival

Dates : early July

Free Canada Day shows in Tofino and Ucluelet. A week of festivities with entertainment of all kinds, cultural and artistic events. Fun for the whole family!

PACIFICRIMARTS.CA/EVENT/SUMMER-FESTIVAL

Tofino Jazz Festival

Dates : end of June

In late June, at the end of the road in Tofino, you will find a small but charming jazz festival with an interesting program. (380, Campbell Street, Tofino)

TOFINOJAZZFESTIVAL.COM



SURFING CAPITAL OF CANADA

© Destination BC, J.F. Bergeron



THE POINTE RESTAURANT AT WICKANINNISH INN

WHERE TO EAT

1 JIGGER'S (\$-\$\$)

If you're in the mood for some simple fare prepared with love, head to Jigger's food truck for the best Fish & Chips in town! Also serves a variety of delicious burgers.

2 OMBRÉ (\$\$-\$\$\$)

Located in the heart of Tofino, Restaurant Ombré offers breathtaking ocean views and refined cuisine featuring fresh seafood and local ingredients. The seasonal menu, designed by a passionate chef, combines bold flavors with meticulous presentation. With a carefully selected wine list, Ombré is the

ideal place for a romantic dinner or an evening with friends. Don't miss this unforgettable culinary experience when you visit Tofino!

OMBRERESTAURANT.COM

3 RAVEN LADY UCLUELET (\$\$-\$\$\$)

High-end food truck serving a fine selection of Pacific oyster dishes. Stop here for lunch or dinner. You can sit at a table or order take-out. The place is very popular, so expect a bit of a wait.

RAVENLADY.CA

4 WOLF IN THE FOG (\$\$\$)

Here, the main inspiration

clearly is the sea: from the amazing view to the freshly sourced ingredients provided by the local fishermen, this is going to be a refreshing night. You'll be served creative dishes all made with local products.
WOLFINTHEFOG.COM

5 THE POINTE RESTAURANT AT WICKANINNISH INN (\$\$\$-\$\$\$\$)

One of Tofino's top restaurants, The Pointe offers the most spectacular views of the Pacific Ocean. The menu is varied and the focus is on locally-sourced, high-quality ingredients. The weekly tasting menu provides guests with

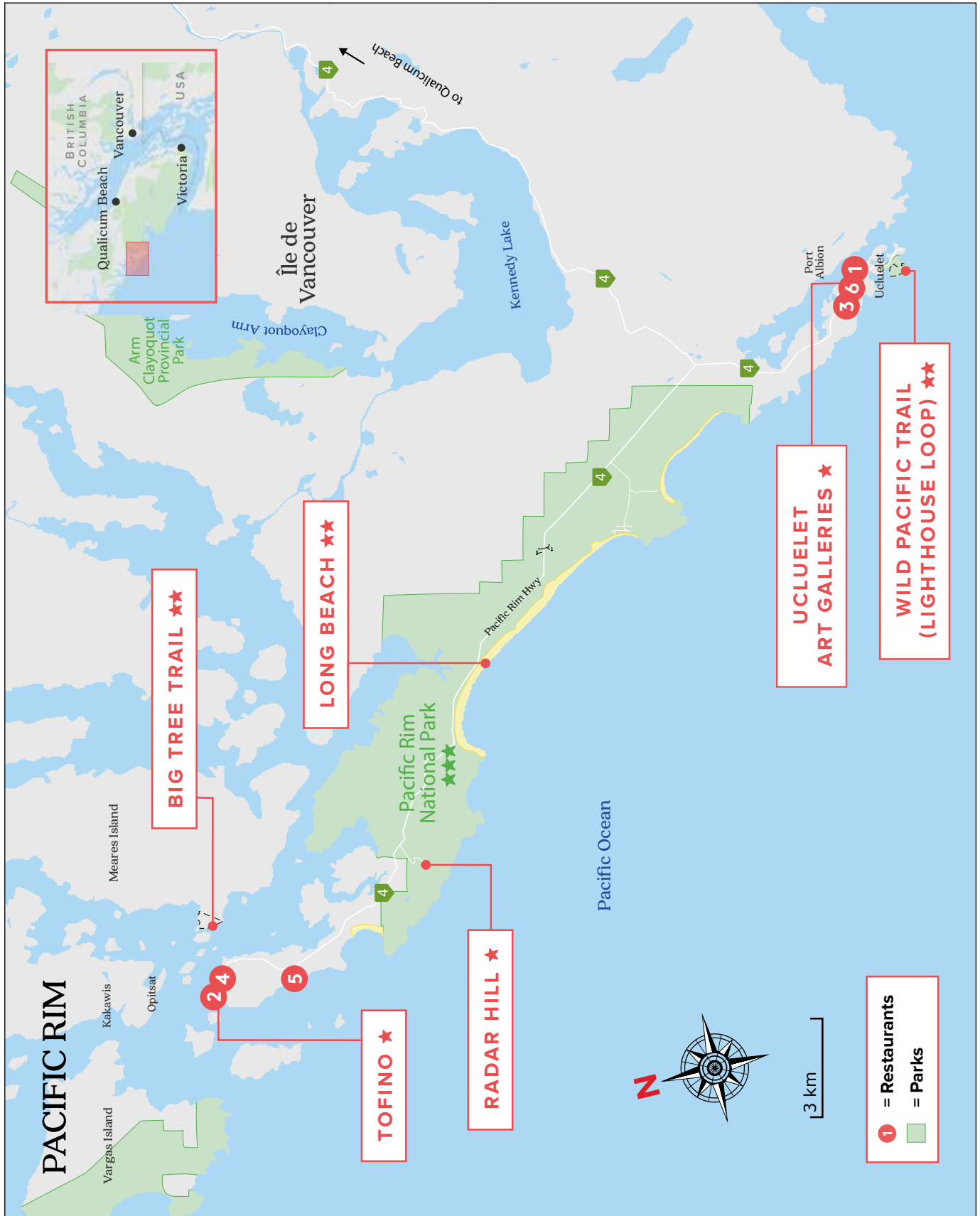
the chance to sample a variety of fresh seafood fished in the very waters overlooked by the restaurant. This option costs a little more than the regular à la carte menu.

THEPOINTERESTAURANT.CA

6 PLUVIO (\$\$\$-\$\$\$\$)

Pluvio is a unique experience celebrating the best local products of Ucluelet, Tofino and Vancouver Island. The chef offers creative and inspired cuisine. The small restaurant and open kitchen allow for personal and refined service.

PLUVIO.CA/RESTAURANT



PRINCE GEORGE

Nestled at the confluence of the Fraser and Nechako Rivers, Prince George is the largest urban center in northern British Columbia.

Known for its still-thriving forestry industry, it plays a key role as a strategic crossroads between the West Coast and the Rockies.

It serves as a convenient and enjoyable stopover for travelers journeying between Smithers and Jasper. While often seen as a transit city, Prince George offers hidden gems that make for a well-deserved break.

Upon arrival, don't miss the chance to greet Mr. PG, an impressive wooden-man statue standing at the city's entrance—a nod to its rich forestry heritage.

AERIAL VIEW OF PRINCE GEORGE

WHAT TO DO

LHEIDLI T'ENNEH MEMORIAL PARK (FORT GEORGE PARK)

Located in the heart of downtown, this large park is perfect for a picnic and a stroll along the water. It is also home to The Exploration Place Museum, which showcases the region's history and culture.

Families looking to stretch their legs after a long day on the road will appreciate a stop at Lheidli T'enneh Memorial Park (formerly known as Fort George Park), named in honor of the local First Nations.

NEARBY

FORT ST. JAMES NATIONAL HISTORIC SITE ★

Located about 1 hour and 45 minutes away, this exceptional site immerses visitors in the history of the fur trade in British Columbia. Explore restored buildings, traditional craft demonstrations, and the daily life of settlers and First Nations in the 19th century.

ANCIENT FOREST TRAIL (CHUN T'OH WHUDUJUT) ★★

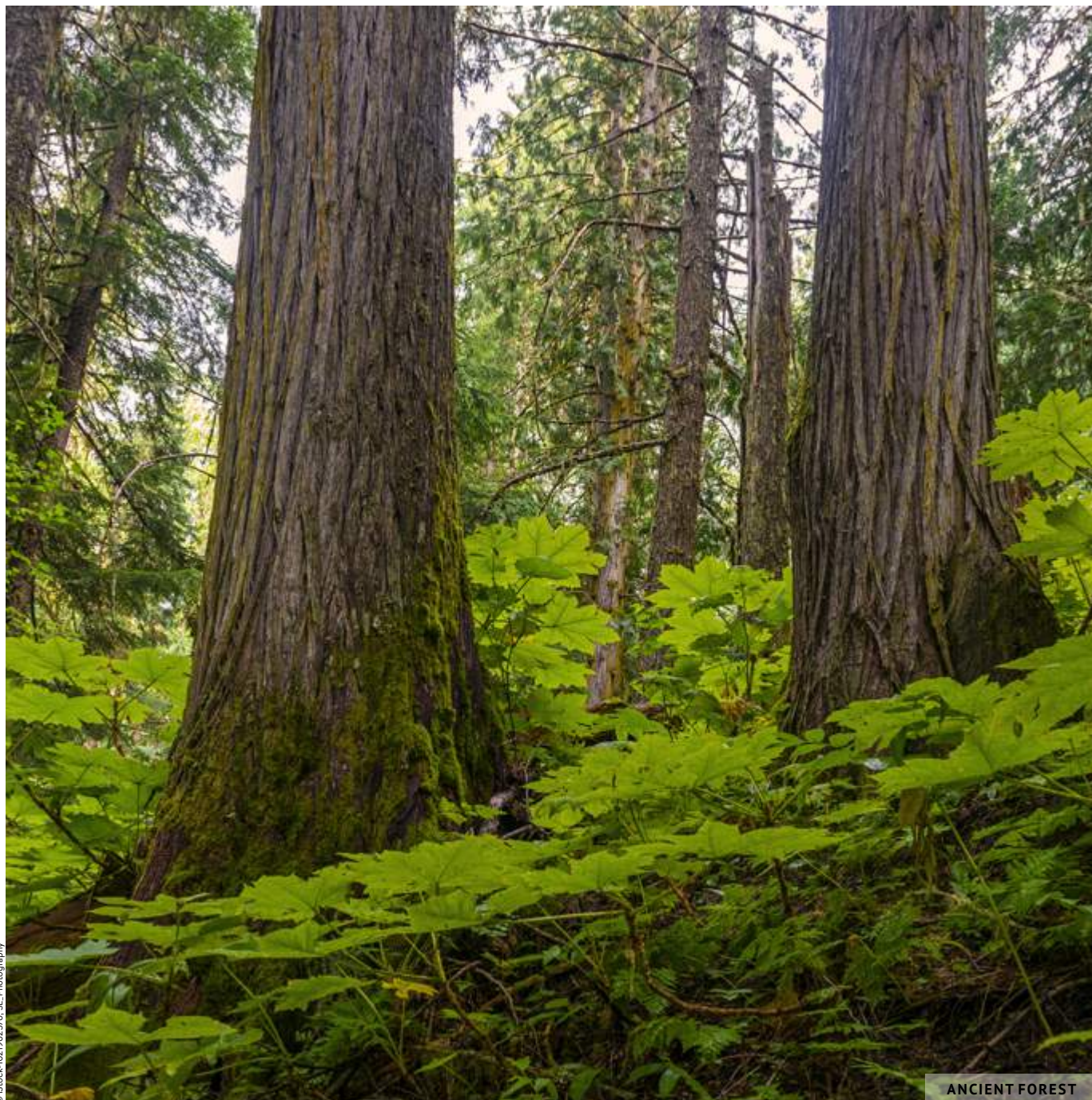
Just an hour's drive east of Prince George, this remarkable site is home to a rare inland temperate rainforest with towering, ancient cedar trees. A boardwalk trail provides easy access for exploration and appreciation of this unique ecosystem.



© Destination BC, Jeff Bouley



© New Brunswick Tourism



© iStock-1021962576, SL Photography

WHERE TO EAT

THE CANADIAN BREWHOUSE & GRILL (\$\$-\$\$\$)

The Canadian Brewhouse and Grill in Prince George offers a great selection of beers, delicious meals, and a friendly

atmosphere. It's become a popular spot for friends, family, and colleagues to gather. Thanks to the ongoing support of the community, it continues to thrive.

FESTIVAL

Prince George Exhibition

Dates : August
This major agriculture exhibition offers a host of activities including a rodeo, lumberjack competitions, live

entertainment by popular local artists, rides, and more.
WWW.BCNE.CA



BALD EAGLE NEAR PRINCE GEORGE

© iStock-471899175, SharonMoult

PRINCE RUPERT



Located on the northern coast of British Columbia, Prince Rupert is a port city known for its natural harbor, one of the deepest and ice-free in the world.

A popular stop for cruise ships en route to Alaska, it is also the ideal starting point for wildlife excursions, including whale watching, orcas, grizzlies, and other wonders of Canada's wild fauna.

Surrounded by the stunning landscapes of the Great Bear Rainforest and bordered by the Pacific Ocean, Prince Rupert captivates visitors with its warm atmosphere and untamed nature.

Its oceanic climate brings frequent rain showers, but also spectacular rainbows that illuminate the mountains and harbor waters. Here, after the rain always comes the sunshine – and most importantly, a unique light that enhances the breathtaking scenery of the northern coast.

PRINCE RUPERT, BRITISH COLUMBIA

WHAT TO DO

MUSEUM OF NORTHERN BRITISH COLUMBIA ★

The Museum of Northern British Columbia celebrates the cultural and natural heritage of British Columbia's Northwest Coast. It houses the largest collection of First Nations artifacts in the region.

The Museum Carving Shed, a working studio for First Nations artists, is open to the public. Visitors are always welcome to come and meet the artists.

PORT OF PRINCE RUPERT ★

One of the largest ports on the west coast. You will feel very

small next to the huge cruise ships and freighters that dock here every day!

Visit the Port Interpretive Centre in Atlin Terminal to learn about the port's history and operations.

COW BAY DISTRICT ★

This picturesque neighborhood with its colorful shops and charming cafés is the perfect spot for a relaxing waterfront stroll.

NEARBY

Khutzeymateen Grizzly Bear Sanctuary

Accessible only by boat or zodiac, this sanctuary is the best place in Canada to observe grizzlies in the wild. Accompanied by experienced guides, you can get close to these majestic animals while ensuring their peace and safety.

The Great Bear Rainforest

Embark on a guided boat tour to explore this dense and misty rainforest, home to coastal wolves, bald eagles, and, if you're lucky, the rare and legendary spirit bear.



END OF THE DAY PRINCE RUPERT

© Destination BC

WHERE TO EAT

THE WATERFRONT RESTAURANT (\$\$-\$\$\$)

As its name suggests, this restaurant, located within the Crest Hotel, offers a magnificent view of the Prince Rupert Harbour. The menu will also charm you with its unique blend of international styles and its excellent wine list.

WWW.CRESTHOTEL.BC.CA/DINING

DOLLY'S FISH MARKET (\$\$)

The perfect spot to enjoy wild salmon or a delicious fish & chips while taking in the harbor views.

FUKASAKU (\$\$)

A must-visit for sushi lovers, this restaurant highlights local and sustainable ingredients, serving fresh seafood sourced directly from the surrounding waters.

FESTIVAL

Annual Seafest

Dates : mid-June

This community festival is held every year on the second weekend in June. Packed with ocean-themed events and activities, food booths, and entertainment in Prince Rupert's downtown and on the waterfront, Seafest promises a weekend of fun for the whole family.

WWW.PRSPECIALEVENTS.COM/SEAFEST.HTML



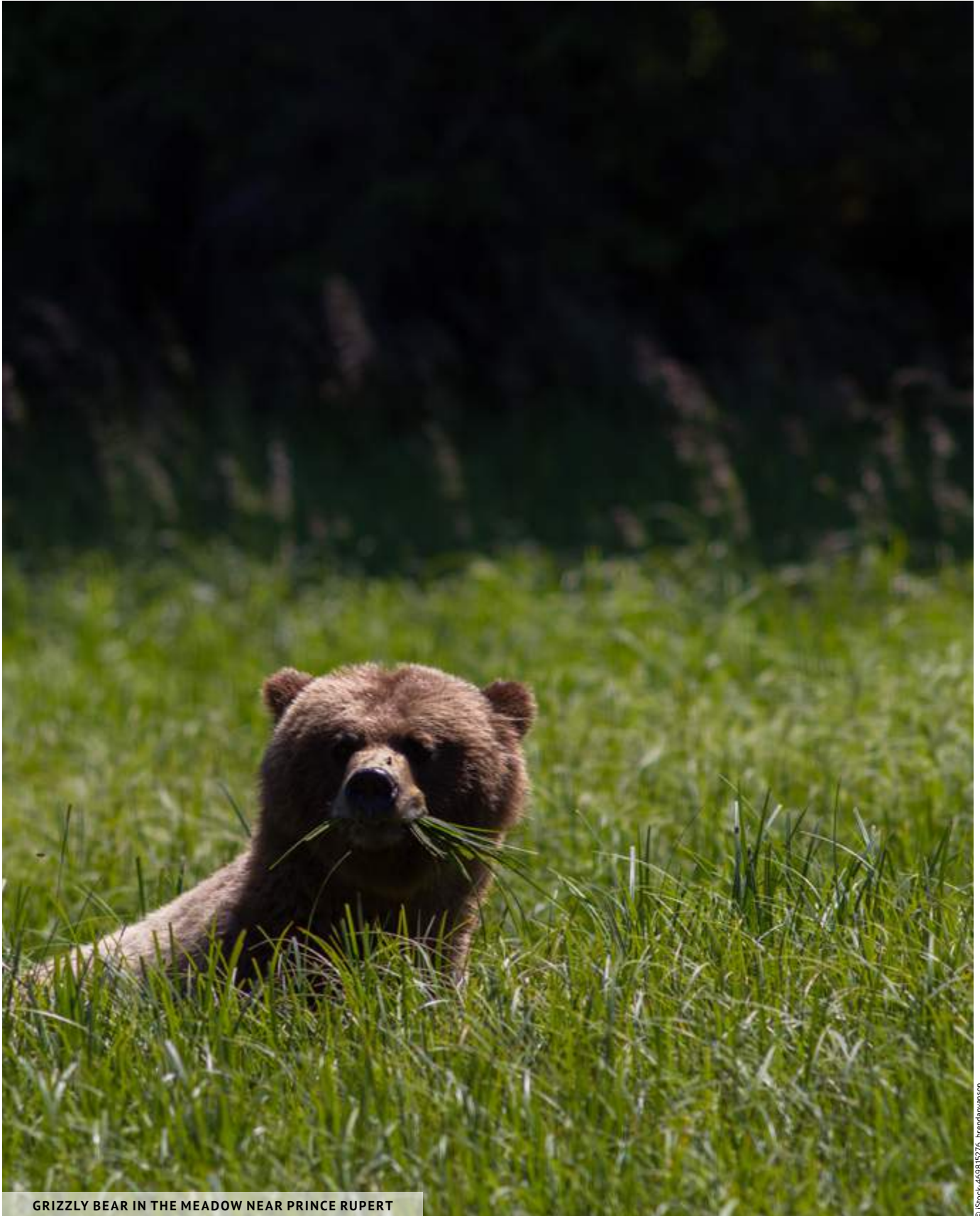
NATIVE TOTEM IN PRINCE RUPERT

© iStock-480344887 boboblaw



AERIAL VIEW

© Destination BC



GRIZZLY BEAR IN THE MEADOW NEAR PRINCE RUPERT

© iStock-469815276, brendanvanson

QUALICUM BEACH



Located on the northeast coast of Vancouver Island, at the foot of Mount Arrowsmith and along the Strait of Georgia, the Qualicum Beach and Parksville region is the perfect destination for a refreshing getaway.

Just a few minutes from the Nanaimo ferry terminal, it's the ideal stop after a crossing from Vancouver or before embarking on the return journey.

With its beachfront resort-style hotels, vast golden sandy beaches, and serene coastal landscapes, Qualicum Beach is an invitation to relaxation and well-being.

Whether you're looking to unwind after the drive from Whistler or before heading to Pacific Rim National Park, this region offers the perfect balance of comfort, nature, and authenticity.

SUNSET IN QUALICUM BEACH

WHAT TO DO

QUALICUM BEACH ★



With 19 kilometers of beach, it's no surprise that Qualicum Beach is the most visited spot in the region. Families come to build sandcastles and play in the water, while couples enjoy romantic sunset views.

QUALICUM BEACH HISTORICAL AND MUSEUM SOCIETY ★

The history of this tight-knit community is well documented in this historical museum. Here, you'll learn about the early settlers and how this charming corner of the island developed over time.



THE VILLAGE'S CLOCK

© iStock-585162344, Tamara V



RELAXATION ON THE BEACH

© shutterstock_1016394529, Scott Bascom



CATHEDRAL COVE, MAC MILLAN PROVINCIAL PARK



A WALK WITHIN THESE DOUGLAS GIANT

NEARBY

CATHEDRAL COVE ★★

This majestic forest, located in MacMillan Provincial Park, is a true natural sanctuary, home to towering Douglas firs that have stood for centuries. Just 25 km west of Qualicum Beach, along Highway 4, this must-see stop is ideal for a short walk among these forest giants

ENGLISHMAN RIVER FALLS PROVINCIAL PARK ★★

Just a few kilometers from Qualicum Beach, this park features two stunning waterfalls nestled within a lush forest. A 3-km trail leads you through the park, offering breathtaking views of the Englishman River plunging into a canyon, before reaching a crystal-clear pool, perfect for swimming when the water levels are low.

OLD COUNTRY MARKET ★

Famous for its goats grazing on the roof, the Old Country Market started as a small roadside fruit stand and has grown into a popular local market. It's a great stop for unique gifts, gourmet groceries, and fresh local produce—perfect



ENGLISHMAN RIVER FALLS PROVINCIAL PARK

for a delicious and artisanal break.

NYMPH FALLS NATURE PARK ★★

This park preserves a dense

forest of Douglas firs, hemlocks, and red cedars, crossed by a river with a beautiful waterfall. In summer, the waters are calm, clear, and refreshing, making it a popular swimming spot. By mid-

October, a trail allows visitors to watch salmon as they swim upstream to the falls.



© shutterstock_1428879692, poemist



© iStock-872911596, Amanda Goodrick



CAMPING ON THE BEACH

WHERE TO EAT

1 THE SHADY REST (\$\$)

A local favourite since 1924, the Shady Rest offers unpretentious cuisine, a casual relaxed atmosphere and breathtaking ocean views. The menu features soups, salads, sandwiches, pizzas, pasta and seafood, with vegetarian options and kid's menu. *Reservation recommended.*
3109, WEST ISLAND HIGHWAY,
QUALICUM BEACH
250-752-9111
WWW.SHADYREST.CA

2 BISTRO 694 (\$\$-\$\$\$)

Bistro 694 is an intimate, casual fine dining restaurant with a sophisticated, urban flair. The menu is based on the chef's favourite recipes from around the world, re-created with a Vancouver Island touch using locally-sourced ingredients.
694, MEMORIAL AVENUE,
QUALICUM BEACH
250-752-0301
WWW.BISTRO694.COM

QUALICUM BAY

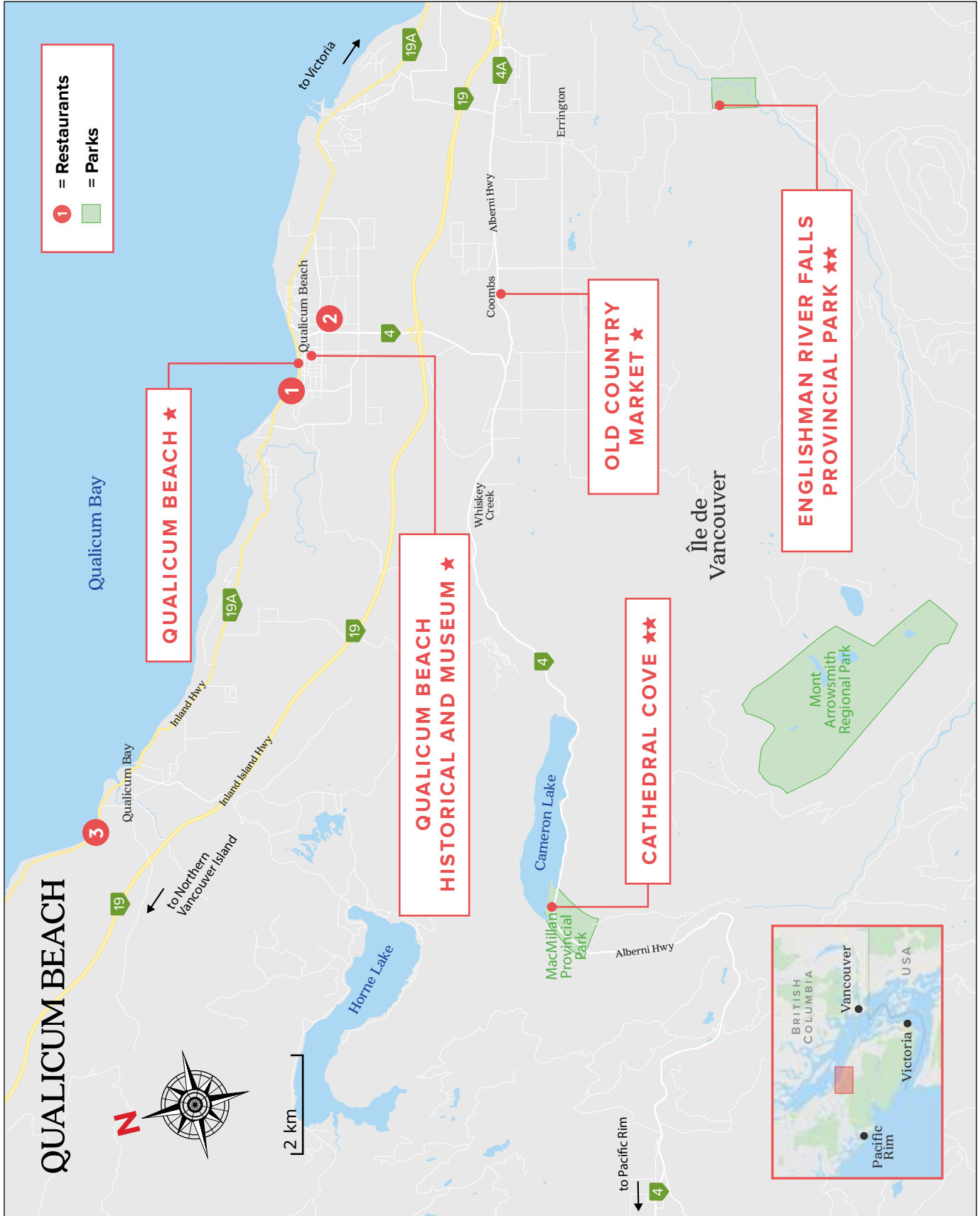
3 TIDAL TACO SHACK (\$)

This tiny shack by the water serves up the best tacos and burritos, which are more than worth the trip. Don't miss it!
6001, ISLAND HIGHWAY WEST,
QUALICUM BEACH
250-240-2855
WWW.TIDALTACOS.COM

FANNY BAY

FANNY BAY OYSTERS SEAFOOD SHOP (\$\$)

This seafood shop is said to offer the best selection of seafood products in all of British Columbia. It's the perfect place to find fresh clams, mussels, oysters and crab. Stop here for a delicious snack of seafood, candied salmon or house-made sushi.
1-6856, ISLAND HIGHWAY, FANNY BAY
250-335-1198
WWW.FANNYBAYOYSTERS.COM



QUADRA ISLAND



Quadra Island is part of an archipelago known as the Discovery Islands. Located near Vancouver Island and accessible by ferry from Campbell River, it is a real haven of nature and is rich in First Nations history and culture. If you have a few more days after a Vancouver Island itinerary, we recommend paying them a visit!

BALD EAGLE

WHAT TO DO

QUADRA ISLAND ★★

Quadra Island is a spectacular destination for water sports enthusiasts. You can rent a kayak on the island, or take a guided kayak tour on the clear coastal waters around the island. The marine waters around Quadra Island are home to a dazzling array of underwater life. Snorkeling is the perfect activity for viewing

this fascinating underwater ecosystem.

CHINESE MOUNTAINS ★★

Quadra Island is also home to several provincial parks, providing opportunities for hiking, rock climbing and even mountain biking. Chinese Mountains are a well-known Quadra Island landmark and

the destination for one of the Island's more popular hiking trails. The vista from the south peak is stunning, with views of Rebecca Spit, the vast dark Vancouver Island forest to the west and the mainland Coast Range Mountains to the east.

NUYUMBALEES CULTURAL CENTRE ★

Would you like to learn more

about the First Nations peoples of Quadra Island? This fascinating museum is home to a large collection of cultural and historical artifacts of the Kwak'waka, Laich-Kwil-Tach and K'omoks people. There is also an exhibit dedicated to local languages and dialects.

WWW.MUSEUMATCAPEMUDGE.COM



SUNSET ON THE PACIFIC OCEAN

© AdobeStock, James Wheeler



THE CANADIAN "RAINFOREST"

© AdobeStock, Calyna Andruszko



SEA KAYAKING WITH ORCAS

© AdobeStock, Fokusiert

WHERE TO EAT

1 CAFÉ AROMA (\$)

If you're looking for a place for breakfast or for a good cup of coffee, this is the place for you! Known for its quality coffee beans and warm, friendly service, this charming eatery has something to please everyone.

WWW.CAFEAROMAQUADRA.CA

2 YELLOW ROSE FOOD TRUCK (\$\$)

The Yellow Rose TX BBQ Company, owned by retired Major Anthony P. Minderman, has been serving authentic Texan flavors since February 2023. Minderman, inspired by his mother and father-in-law, perfected the art of BBQ through years of competition and personal exploration. With menu highlights like the Loaded Hashbrown Brisket Bowl, Minderman's food truck brings the true taste of Texas to Indiana.

WWW.CAPEMUDGERESORT.BC.CA

3 GOWLLAND HARBOUR RESORT DINING ROOM (\$\$\$)

Renowned for its meat dishes and its fusion cuisine, this restaurant is a must. You may choose to be seated close to the two-storey stone fireplace or at a harbour-view window. The Gowlland dining room was even recommended in National Geographic "Canada's 50 places of a Lifetime"! Reservations required.

WWW.GOWLLANDHARBOUR.COM



SEA LIONS

© AdobeStock, birdiegal



NATIVE TOTEM

© AdobeStock, winterbilder

FESTIVALS

Quadra Island Studio Tour

Dates : early June

Visit the far reaches of Quadra Island, where artists open their studios to present their latest creations. The Studio Tour is an excellent way to explore the island and to discover a wide range

of art techniques. The Community Centre is transformed into an art gallery for the occasion.

www.quadraislandarts.com

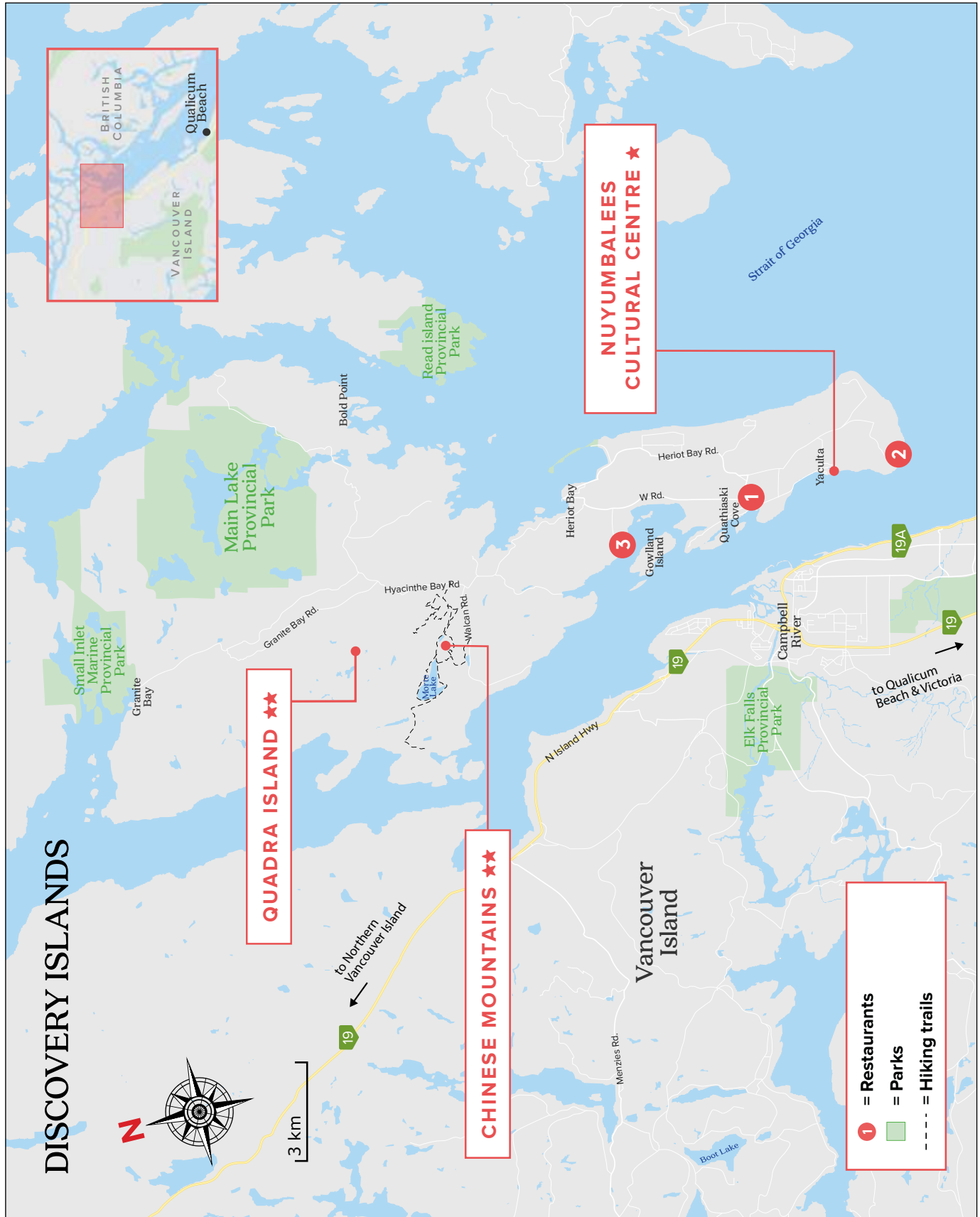
Quadrpalooza

Dates : early September

This annual weekend long family

event takes place at the Quadra Island Community Centre and showcases a huge selection of diverse Canadian artists on a multitude of different stages. Workshops, music, juggling, dancing and more.

www.quadrpalooza.com



REVELSTOKE



Best known for its ski hills, Revelstoke and its national park are well worth exploring in summer. The best time to visit the region is from June to September. Once the snow has disappeared, you can take the spectacular Meadows in the Sky Parkway ★★ to the summit of Mount Revelstoke.

VIEW ON REVELSTOKE

WHAT TO DO

REVELSTOKE DAM ★

The Revelstoke Dam, a hydroelectric dam spanning the Columbia River, is a popular local attraction. It is the second largest power generating facility in British Columbia. Tours of the dam are usually offered daily during the summer season. **The Revelstoke Dam Visitor Centre** is 5 km north of town.

BCHYDRO.COM/COMMUNITY/RECREATION_AREAS/VISITOR-CENTRES/REVELSTOKE-VISITOR-CENTRE.HTML

BEGBIE FALLS ★

These **fabulous falls** are just a few minutes south of Revelstoke, where **Begbie Creek empties into Upper Arrow Lake**. It is the perfect spot for a picnic or a walk in the humid forest, with a good pair of shoes and your camera in hand. The site and parking area are reached by a narrow gravel road that is **not recommended for RVs**. Follow Highway 23 South, turn left on Clough Road, and then right on Mount Begbie Road.

MT BEGBIE ROAD / REVELSTOKE



REVELSTOKE DAM

© Wikimedia Commons



MOUNT REVELSTOKE

© Revelstoke Tourism, BC Photo



BEGBIE FALLS

© iStock-819520626, Scott Ballingall

NEARBY

MOUNT REVELSTOKE NATIONAL PARK★★★

One of the major attractions in Mount Revelstoke National Park is the **Meadows in the Sky Parkway★★★**, a winding 26-kilometre paved mountain road with 16 switchbacks leading up to the summit of Mount Revelstoke.

The Meadows in the Sky Parkway takes you through forests of cedar and hemlock, spruce and fir to the renowned **subalpine wildflower meadows★★★** of Mount Revelstoke National Park. The best time to visit is in **early August when the blooms are at their peak**. The summit offers mountain-top hiking, strolling, picnicking and photography opportunities and is crowned by a historic fire tower.

The road is **accessible during the snow-free season (usually early July to late September)**. The last short section leading to the summit area is only accessible by **Summit Shuttle Bus** (see box below).

If you are travelling **with a long RV, some restrictions may apply**. Check with the staff at the welcome station to be sure that your vehicle is permitted.

GIANT CEDARS TRAIL★★

Distance (round-trip): 0.5 km

Time (round-trip): 15 minutes

Level: Easy

Elevation gain: 29 metres

The park also boasts the fabulous **Giant Cedars Boardwalk Trail★★**, a half-kilometre boardwalk that takes you into the heart of the park's old-growth forest, among cedar trees that may be more than half a millennium old. Accessible to everyone.

GLACIER NATIONAL PARK★★

Glacier National Park offers exceptional alpine scenery, a mild wet climate and a

wide variety of vegetation and wildlife. The Trans-Canada Highway (Highway 1) passes through the park, and it is interesting to stop

at the **Rogers Pass Discovery Centre★★** to learn about the triumphs and tragedies behind the building of Canada's first trans-continental railway.

GLACIER NATIONAL PARK★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centre: The Rogers Pass Discovery Centre.
www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/bc/glacier



MOUNT REVELSTOKE NATIONAL PARK

MOUNT REVELSTOKE NATIONAL PARK★★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Visitor Centre: The Meadows in the Sky Parkway welcome station.

Service de navette : Only during the Wildflower Festival. Visit their website for more details: <https://seerevelstoke.com/event-calendar/summit-shuttle/2022-08-04/>

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/bc/revelstoke

FESTIVALS

Revelstoke Summer Session

Dates : mid-June to mid-September

Great summer outdoor entertainment at Grizzly Plaza in downtown Revelstoke. Music of many different genres is played every night, all summer long!

REVELSTOKEARTSCOUNCIL.COM/EVENTS/SUMMER-STREET-FEST/

Luna Festival

Dates : late September

LUNA is three days and nights of art and music. If you're in town at this time, come see this celebration of art and energy in the streets of Revelstoke!

LUNAFEST.CA



TOWN OF REVELSTOKE

© Revelstoke Tourism, Craig

WHERE TO EAT

VILLAGE IDIOT BAR & GRILL (\$\$)

This unique, friendly restaurant is sure to bring a smile to your face. Its casual ski chalet decor, humorous menu and quality pub cuisine have made the Village Idiot a favourite for locals and visitors alike. The burgers and made-to-order pizza are the house specialties.

WWW.THEVILLAGEIDIOT.CA

WOOLSEY CREEK BISTRO (\$\$-\$\$\$)

Clients are drawn to Woolsey Creek Bistro for its imaginative, flavorful cuisine and welcoming, funky atmosphere. At the same time, Woolsey Creek Bistro offers a sustainable dining experience that strives to minimize its ecological footprint and encourage local BC farmers.

.WOOLSEYCREEKBISTRO.CA



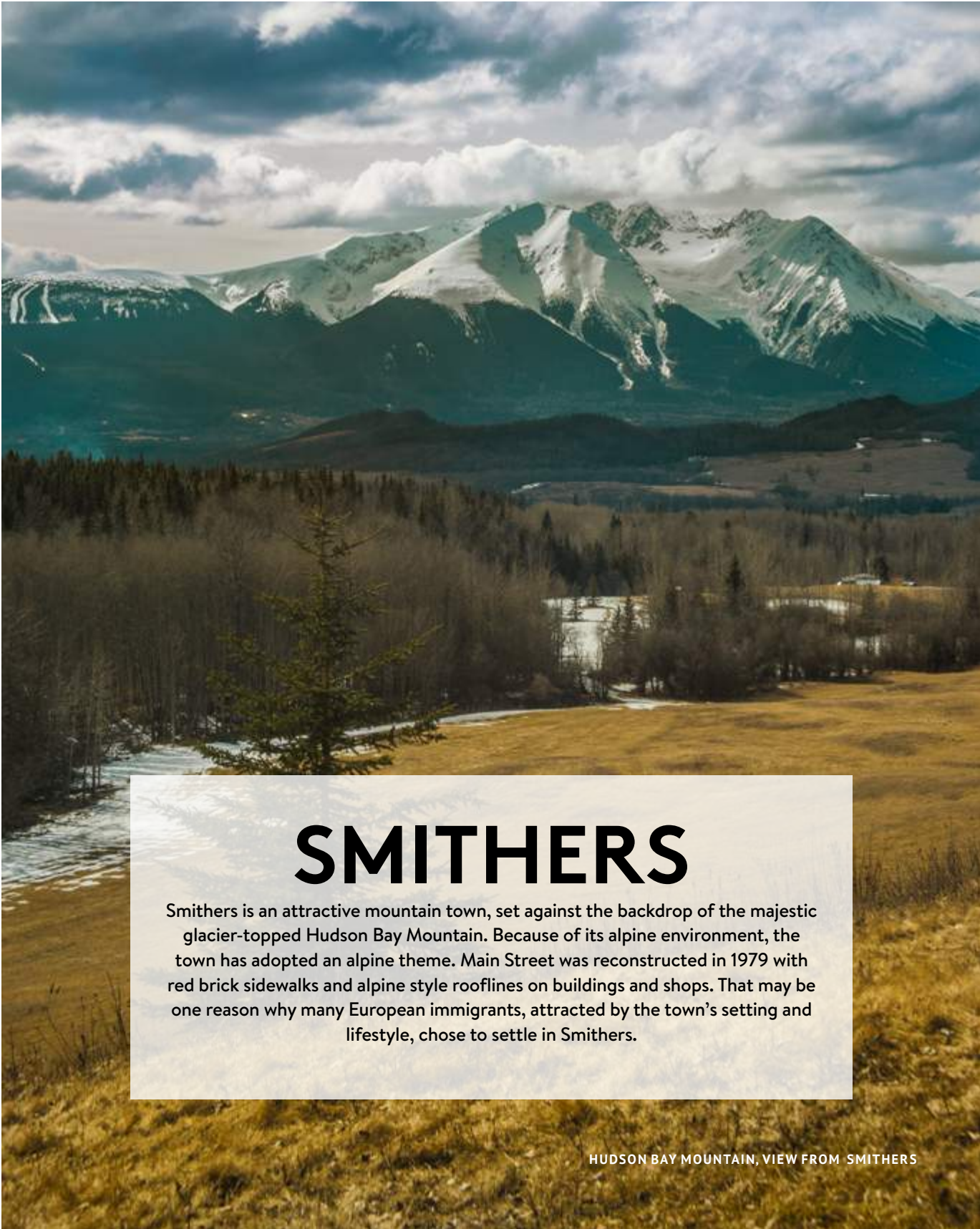
HIKING REVELSTOKE NATIONAL PARK

© iStock-525676885, ImagineGolf



GIANT CEDARS TRAIL

© iStock-512420939, doranjclark



SMITHERS

Smithers is an attractive mountain town, set against the backdrop of the majestic glacier-topped Hudson Bay Mountain. Because of its alpine environment, the town has adopted an alpine theme. Main Street was reconstructed in 1979 with red brick sidewalks and alpine style rooflines on buildings and shops. That may be one reason why many European immigrants, attracted by the town's setting and lifestyle, chose to settle in Smithers.

HUDSON BAY MOUNTAIN, VIEW FROM SMITHERS

Be sure to pay a visit to the **Smithers Art Gallery**. Another interesting attraction is **Driftwood Canyon Provincial Park**, home to one of the world's most significant fossil beds. The visitors centre offers a map to the park. The **Bulkley Valley Fair**, one of British Columbia's largest agricultural exhibitions, takes place in Smithers on the weekend before Labour Day.



SMITHERS, BRITISH COLUMBIA

© Destination BC, J.F. Bergeron

FESTIVAL

Bulkley Valley Exhibition

Dates : late August
 Bulkley Valley Exhibition is a weekend of family fun and entertainment in the heart of cowboy country. Activities include a parade, a rodeo, cattle auctions, farm animal races, live entertainment, rides, games and more.

WWW.BVFAIR.CA

Midsummer Music Festival

Dates : early July
 Every summer, people from all walks of life gather in Smithers, BC to share a universal love of music. The Midsummer Music Festival is a 3-day family-positive music and art festival featuring headliners, local and regional performers, and entertaining activities for children.

WWW.SMITHERSMUSICFEST.COM



NATIVE HISTORIC SITE

© Destination BC, J.F. Bergeron



MORICETOWN CANYON, SALMON POLE FISHING

© National Geographic

WHERE TO EAT

TRACKSIDE CANTINA (\$\$)

This little pub in Downtown Smithers will be just the thing you'll need after a long day on the road. Here you'll be served

great comfort food dishes in a warm and inviting atmosphere.

DADDIO'S FAMILY RESTAURANT (\$\$)

This friendly family restaurant serves Canadian and American comfort food at its best, with such classics as soups, sandwiches, salads, burgers,

pasta, pizza and a few meat dishes such as steak, pork ribs and souvlaki. Consistent quality food and friendly service make Daddio's a local family favourite!

STEWART



Stewart is located on the Alaska–British Columbia border. Over the years, this former **mining town** has gradually been transformed into a charming tourist destination. The area offers a very good chance of seeing **grizzly bears** in their natural habitat. Wild bears spend the summer months fishing the salmon that are making their way upstream to spawn. Since you are so close to Alaska, why not drive the extra few minutes to the tiny American village of **Hyder**? And if you want to follow the time-honoured travellers' tradition, get «Hyderized» at the Glacier Inn by downing a shot of **95% Everclear**, an intense experience that will require a designated driver to get you back to Stewart!

GLACIER IN STEWART

WHAT TO DO

FISH CREEK ★★★

The best place for **bear-watching** is the Fish Creek Wildlife Observation Site in nearby Hyder (Alaska). The site features a raised viewing platform from which bears can be observed as they fish for chum and pink salmon in the clear shallow waters of Fish Creek. The best time to see grizzlies and black bears in action is in **July and August**.

SALMON GLACIER ★★

Just north of Stewart, on the Canadian side of the border, is a spectacular natural attraction: Salmon Glacier, one of the largest glaciers in Canada. You can drive above this spectacular glacier and admire the view and the sun glittering on the eternal ice and snow. You will feel like you are on top of the world!



SALMON FISHING IN FISH CREEK

© DollarPhotoClub, Stuckred



GRIZZLY BEAR IN FISH CREEK

© iStockPhoto, FishFetish

FESTIVAL

Stewart Park Festival

Dates : mid-July

Three days of free music and activities in the park for the whole family. Craft market, food kiosks, concerts, Sunday morning pancake breakfast, wine bar and more.

www.stewartparkfestival.com

WHERE TO EAT

1 TEMPTATION BAKERY (\$)

Looking for a nice bakery for breakfast? You won't be able to resist the homemade pastries and excellent coffee at Temptation Bakery.

2 SILVERADO CAFÉ & PIZZA PARLOR (\$\$)

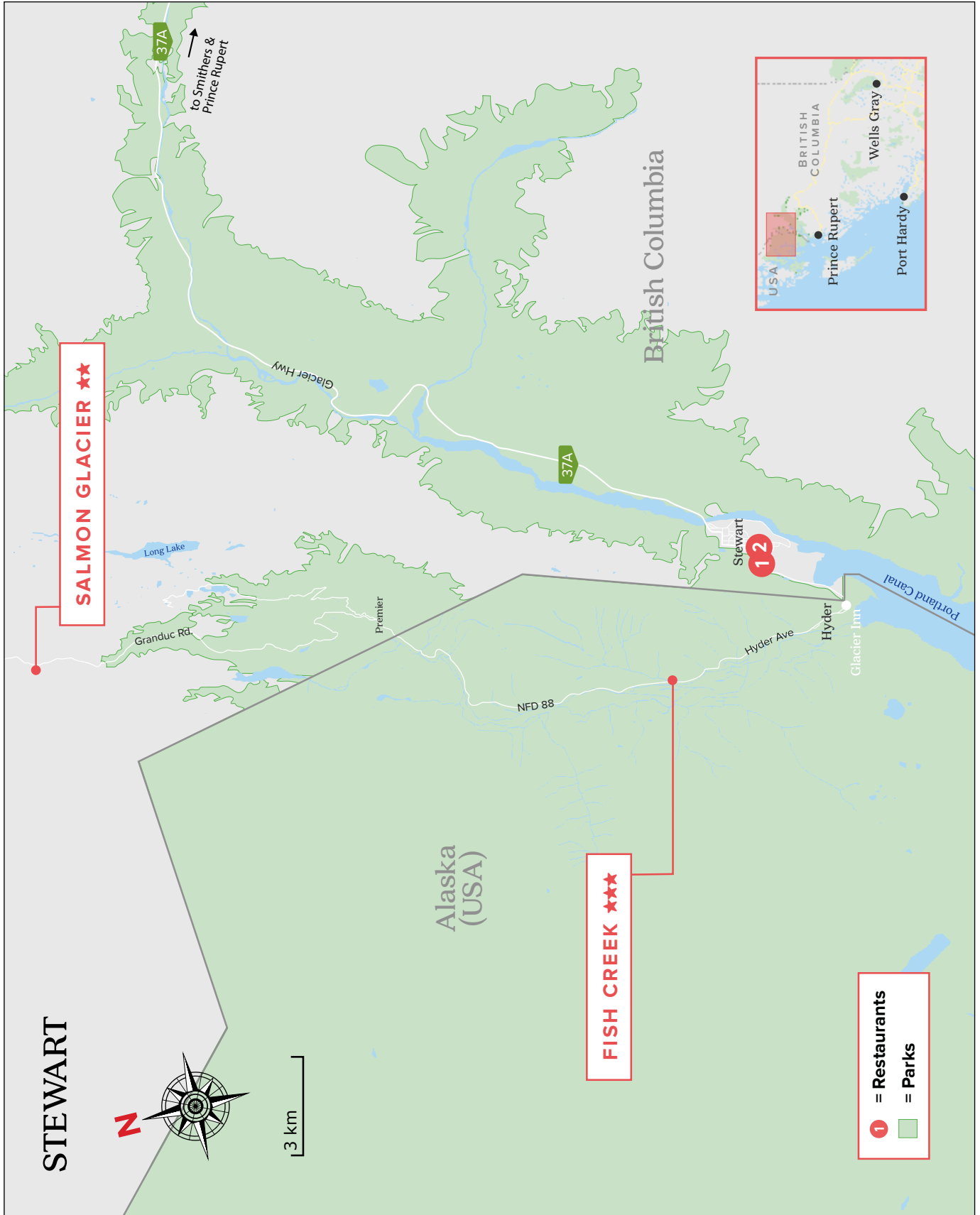
Known for its friendly atmosphere and fresh homemade food, Silverado Café is located in a typical small west coast house. The house specialty is authentic Italian pizza. The menu also includes burgers, pasta, sandwiches and fish & chips.



HYDER USA, ON THE WAY TO FISH CREEK



TOWN OF STEWART



SUNSHINE COAST



True to its name, the Sunshine Coast does enjoy a lot of sunshine! The Sunshine Coast is one of British Columbia's best-kept secrets, due to the fact that it is only accessible by BC Ferries, even though it is part of BC's mainland. Gibsons is a picturesque town of artists, colourful fishing boats, quirky waterfront shops and friendly people.

SUNSHINE COAST

WHAT TO DO

SMUGGLER COVE MARINE PROVINCIAL PARK ★

Just a 45-minute drive from Gibsons, **Smuggler Cove Marine Provincial Park** is well worth the detour, because it has so much to offer! A host of outdoor activities are available to visitors including hiking, swimming, diving, canoeing and fishing. WWW.ENV.GOV.BC.CA/BCPARKS/EXPLORE/PARKPGS/SMUGGLER

GALERIES D'ART ★

Be astonished by the swell of creativity on the Sunshine Coast. Take **guided tours of galleries and studios** and watch painters, potters, sculptors, woodworkers, glass blowers and Aboriginal artists at work. At **Coast Raven Studio and Gallery**, you can buy West Coast Native art directly from the artist! WWW.COASTRAVEN.COM

SKOOKUMCHUCK NARROWS PROVINCIAL PARK ★

This superb **provincial park** is about a 90-minute drive from Gibsons. If you are looking for a short and easy hike for the whole family, this is a great place to go. Skookumchuck is a **Chinook First Nation's** word meaning "strong water" or "**turbulent water**". The hiking/walking trail leads through the forest to a viewing area for the incredibly turbulent rapids of Skookumchuck Narrows.

WWW.ENV.GOV.BC.CA/BCPARKS/EXPLORE/PARKPGS/SKOOK_NARROWS



SKOOKUMCHUCK NARROWS PROVINCIAL PARK

© Wikimedia commons, Original photo



SMUGGLER COVE MARINE PROVINCIAL PARK

© Ken McMillan



MARINA OF GIBSONS

© Wikimedia Commons, Own Work

FESTIVALS

Gibsons Landing Jazz Festival

Dates : mid-June

The Festival weekend is preceded by "Jazz Week", a full week of live music in local restaurants and other venues to promote the talented musicians of the Sunshine Coast. Attend 2 days of outdoor concerts and activities, and be sure to put on your dancing shoes for the evening performances!

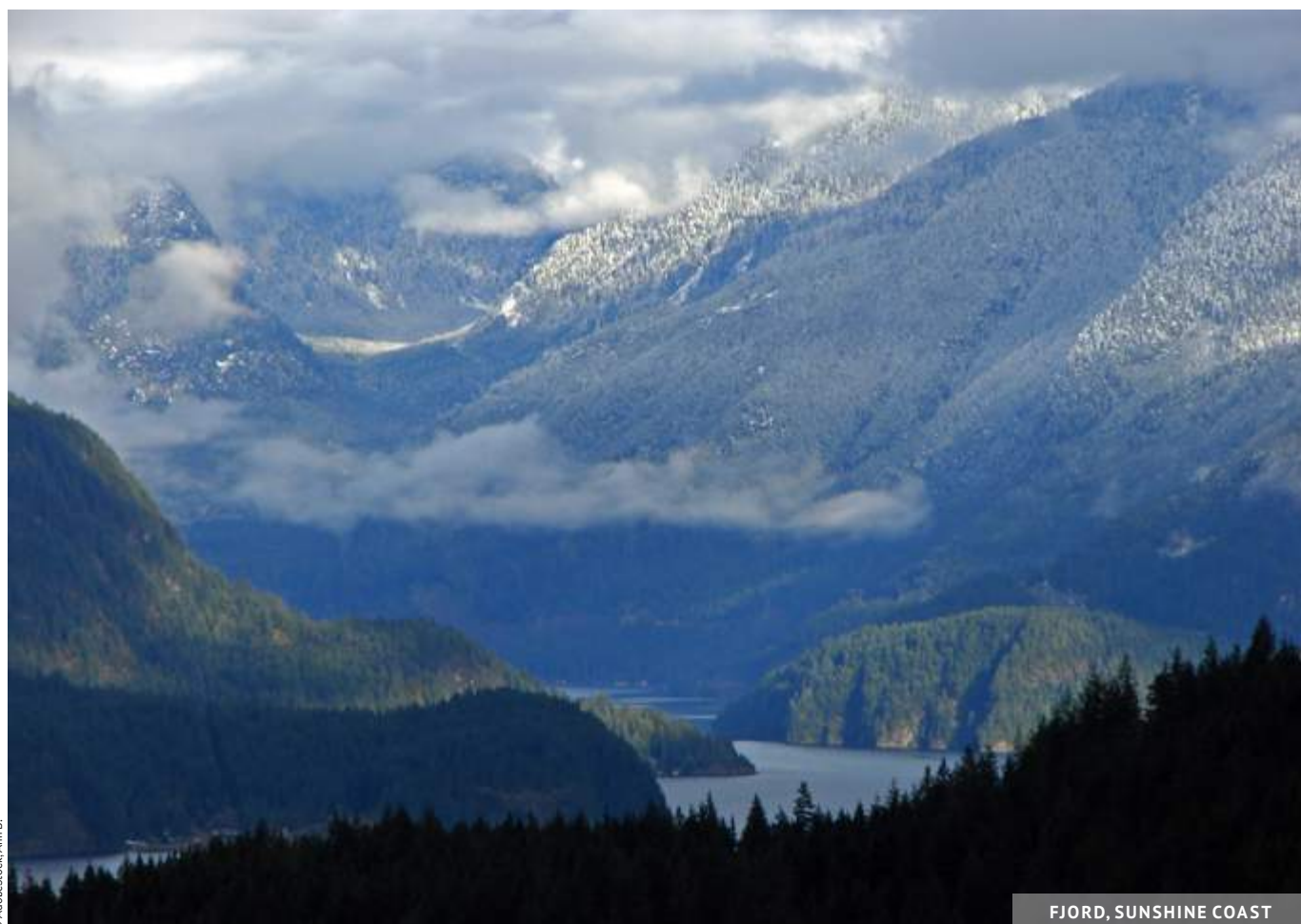
COASTJAZZ.COM

© Destination BC



FERRY CROSSING, SUNSHINE COAST

© AdobeStock, Ann B.



FJORD, SUNSHINE COAST

WHERE TO EAT

SUSHI BAR NAGOMI (\$)

When you're in the mood for sushi, the chef's creations are sure to satisfy! If you feel like being outdoors, why not order your sushi to go? A picnic is always a good idea, especially in

such beautiful surroundings!
WWW.SUSHIBARNAGOMI.COM

SMOKE ON THE WATER BBQ SHACK (\$\$)

You shouldn't have any trouble finding Smoke on the Water:

the succulent smell of smoked and barbecued meat and fish will lead you right to their door! The name is not just a nod to the famous song: the restaurant and its smokehouse are literally located right on the wharf, with

a patio overlooking the colourful harbour. This restaurant is a must during your stay in Gibsons!

SMOKEONTHEWATERBBQ.CA



© BC Parks Photo

SMUGGLER COVE PROVINCIAL PARK



© BC Parks Photo

SKOOKUMCHUCK NARROWS PROVINCIAL PARK



VANCOUVER



Nestled between the Pacific Ocean and the majestic Coast Mountain Range, Vancouver is a vibrant metropolis of unrivalled beauty. It is a cosmopolitan city perched on the edge of nature, with unlimited opportunities for outdoor recreation and a great cultural diversity with its European, Asian and First Nations heritages.

Vancouver has it all, for seasoned travellers and the less adventurous seeking a peaceful, reassuring destination. There is no need for a car in Vancouver. This is a city that is best explored on foot or by bike, at your own pace. For this reason, Vancouver is a perfect location to start or finish a Western Canada road trip.

CITY OF VANCOUVER

WHAT TO DO

STANLEY PARK ★★★

Stanley Park is such a vast natural environment that it is easy to forget that one is in the middle of the city. This lush jewel has so much to offer: the scenic **Seawall walking path**, **biking**, **beaches**, **swimming**, and much more. The park also offers a number of **activities for kids**, including pony rides, water games and a miniature train. Older visitors will want to tour the spectacular flower gardens. Stanley Park teems with an amazing variety of wildlife. At least 500 species are known to live in the park. Some of the must-see landmarks: **Lost Lagoon**, **Hollow Tree** and **Siwash Rock**.

VANCOUVER.CA/PARKS-RECREATION-CULTURE/STANLEY-PARK.ASPX

GASTOWN ★

This is the birthplace of Vancouver, with historic cobblestone streets and Victorian buildings. The epicenter of independent design, culture, food and fashion, Gastown delivers one-of-a-kind experiences to visitors and locals alike. In other words, Gastown is the **trendiest**



VANCOUVER AQUARIUM

© Shutterstock_487908566, Stores In Light

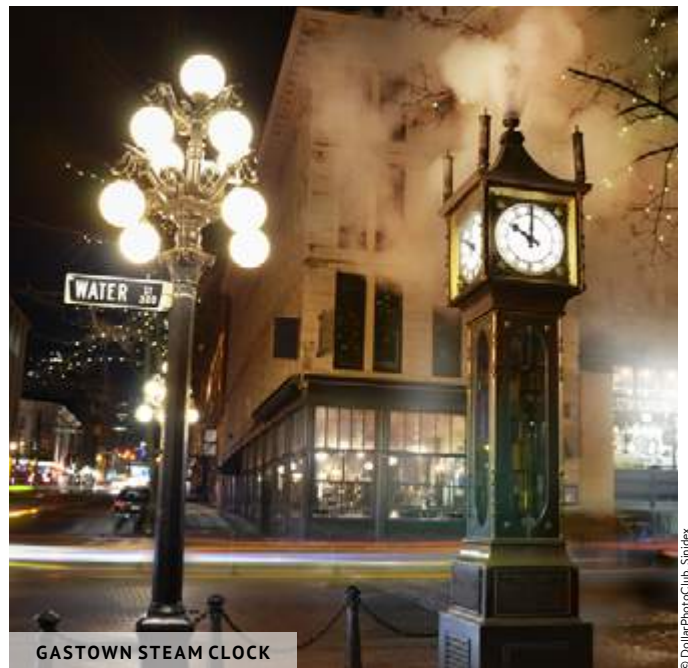
neighbourhood in Vancouver!

A must-see for art and culture lovers.

VANCOUVER AQUARIUM ★★★

The Vancouver Aquarium is not just an aquarium: it is a unique non-profit marine science centre dedicated to the conservation of aquatic life. It is **Canada's largest aquarium**, with many exhibits and galleries presenting different aquatic ecosystems. Adults and kids alike will love the entertaining and educational "encounters" program, which allows visitors to go behind the scenes and get up close and personal with the animals and the people who train them.

VANAQUA.ORG



GASTOWN STEAM CLOCK

© DollarPhotoClub, Sindex



STANLEY PARK AND VANCOUVER DOWNTOWN

© AdobeStock_JFL Photography

MUSEUM OF ANTHROPOLOGY ★

Widely considered to be one of Vancouver's finest museums, the UBC Museum of Anthropology houses a number of permanent and temporary exhibitions. The permanent collection features a magnificent collection of **First Nations** art and objects, including totem poles and

traditional houses. The cutting-edge temporary exhibitions focus on arts and **culture from around the world**. Allow at least two hours for a good look at everything on offer!

MOA.UBC.CA

GRANVILLE ISLAND ★★

Granville Island is not actually an island, but a **large peninsula** connected to the mainland by the magnificent metal spans of the Granville Island Bridge. Removed from the hustle and bustle of downtown, it is a great place to spend a quiet afternoon. Granville Island is

very lively on weekends, with its street performers and fish & chips vendors! The island boasts many restaurants, bars, theatres, artists' studios and craft boutiques. With its wide range of local produce and products, the **Granville Island Public Market** is the perfect place to prepare your picnic lunch! GRANVILLEISLAND.COM



ROBSON STREET AND BROADWAY AVENUE ★

In the mood for some **shopping**?

Robson Street, in the **West End**, and **Broadway Avenue**, in **Kitsilano**, are two shopping destinations that are popular with locals and tourists alike, offering fashion and more for everyone and every budget. In fact, two well-known Canadian brands originated in these areas of Vancouver a number of years ago: **Mountain Equipment Co-op (MEC)**, Canada's largest supplier of outdoor equipment, and **Aritzia**, an innovative women's fashion boutique.



SUNSET IN VANCOUVER

© Tourism Vancouver, Al Harvey

FLYOVER CANADA ★

Take an exhilarating 6,000-km journey across Canada, from east to west, discovering some of the country's most spectacular and iconic locations without ever leaving Vancouver! The film is projected on a **20-metre spherical screen**.

Special effects, including wind, mist and scents, combine with the ride's motion to create an unique experience. Projections every 15-20 minutes.

FLYOVERCANADA.COM



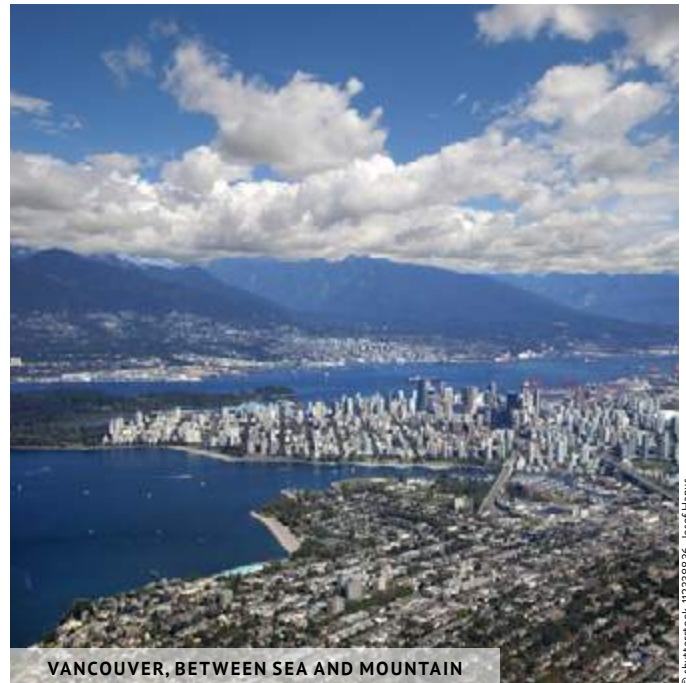
ROBSON STREET

© Shutterstock, 106725601, De i viewfinder



FLYOVER CANADA

© Shutterstock, 143677768, Mitch Hutchinson



VANCOUVER, BETWEEN SEA AND MOUNTAIN

© Shutterstock, 11238836, Josef Hanus

NEARBY

CAPILANO SUSPENSION BRIDGE ★★

Just outside of Vancouver floats the **Capilano Suspension Bridge**, built in 1889! The 137m long, 70m high bridge offers a stunning view of the oh-so-green forest of **Capilano River Regional Park**. Within this park, **Treetops Adventure** takes guests of all ages more than 30 feet above the forest floor on seven suspension bridges attached to old-growth Douglas fir trees!

CAPBRIDGE.COM

CAPILANO RIVER HATCHERY ★

Capilano River Hatchery, a **government-run fish farm**, is located a few minutes from the Capilano Suspension Bridge. Juvenile salmon are released into the river in the spring. Mature fish return in the fall to spawn, climbing the fish ladders by jumping from one pool to the next. From July to November, it is possible to **see adult coho, chinook or steelhead salmon**.

This free activity is educational and very popular with the kids. VANCOUVERSNORTHSHORE.COM/ATTRACTIONS/CAPILANO-SALMON-HATCHERY/

GROUSE MOUNTAIN ★

Located less than 15 minutes from North Vancouver, Grouse Mountain offers a **wide array of activities for visitors of all ages**: helicopter rides, paragliding, ascent to the top of a wind turbine, gondola rides, a lumberjack show, a demonstration of free-flying birds of prey and a tour of a wildlife refuge (home to bears, wolves, owls and other small animals). Not to mention the gruelling 2.9-kilometre **Grouse Grind Trail**, an invigorating workout for seasoned hikers!

GROUSEMOUNTAIN.COM



FESTIVALS

Dragon Boat Festival

Dates : late June

Dragon boating is quickly becoming a favourite pastime in Vancouver, a city that is a natural haven for water sports. The annual Dragon Boat Festival attracts over 100,000 people and close to 180 dragon boat teams from the area and around the globe.

www.vancouverdragonboatfestival.ca

Festival d'été francophone

Dates : mid-June

Founded in 1990, the Festival d'été francophone is one of the most important francophone cultural and musical events in Western Canada.

www.lecentreculturel.com/festival-d-ete

Festival international de jazz de Vancouver

Dates : late June

Vancouver comes alive to the sound of jazz music of all kinds during this internationally renowned music festival as the world's best jazz, funk, Latin, fusion, & world music artists perform at venues across

the city. There are many free outdoor concerts in addition to paying concerts.

www.coastaljazz.ca

Vancouver Folk Festival

Dates : mid-July

This annual three-day festival features folk music from around the globe, performed in a beautiful outdoor venue. One of Canada's most popular folk music festivals, it attracts some 30,000 folk music fans every year and features 30 to 40 concerts on eight outdoor stages.

www.thefestival.bc.ca

Celebration of Light Fireworks Festival

Dates : end of July

Celebration of Light is an international musical fireworks competition. Competing countries light up the sky with spectacular fireworks, carefully synchronized to music. Whether you watch it from the shore or from a boat out on the water, this festival is a delight for all ages.

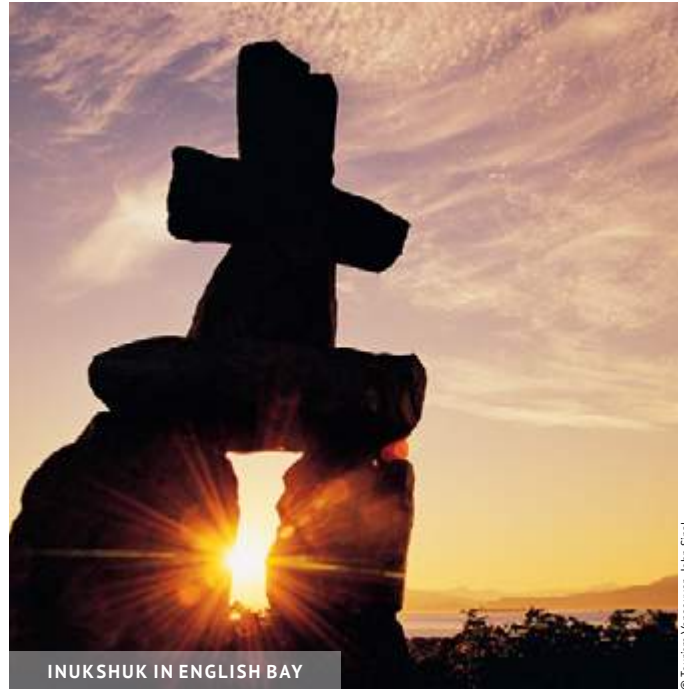
www.hondacelebrationoflight.com

Pride Vancouver

Dates : early August (Pride Parade)

Like Montreal, Toronto and many other big cities across the globe, Vancouver celebrates diversity. A week of festivities

culminates in a flamboyant parade stretching along two kilometres of city streets and attracting close to half a million spectators and participants.
vancouverpride.ca



INUKSHUK IN ENGLISH BAY

© Tourism Vancouver, John Sinal



AERIAL VIEW OF VANCOUVER AND STANLEY PARK

© Tourism Vancouver, AirPhoto '85



© DollarPhotoClub, MaxDigi

SUNSET IN STANLEY PARK

WHERE TO EAT

1 MAENAM (\$\$)

Maenam is one of Vancouver's best Thai restaurants, offering refined, beautifully-presented, authentic cuisine prepared using the best seasonal and local ingredients. The menu includes familiar classics like the sweet and sour tom kaa soup, curries and pad Thai. Wine, beer and cocktail menu is also available.
MAENAM.CA

2 SALMON N'BANNOCK (\$\$-\$\$\$)

British Columbia is known for its high quality wild salmon! This small restaurant showcases

Aboriginal cuisine with a range of menu items inspired by a variety of First Nations culinary tradition. The homemade bannock, or flatbread, is one of the house specialties!
SALMONANDBANNOCK.NET

3 BAO BEI (\$\$-\$\$\$)

This cozy, modern Chinese brasserie is a far cry from the Chinese restaurants of old. You will be charmed by the fresh ingredients, friendly staff, trendy atmosphere and the impeccable presentation. In a city that has long embraced Chinese cuisine as part of its culinary heritage,

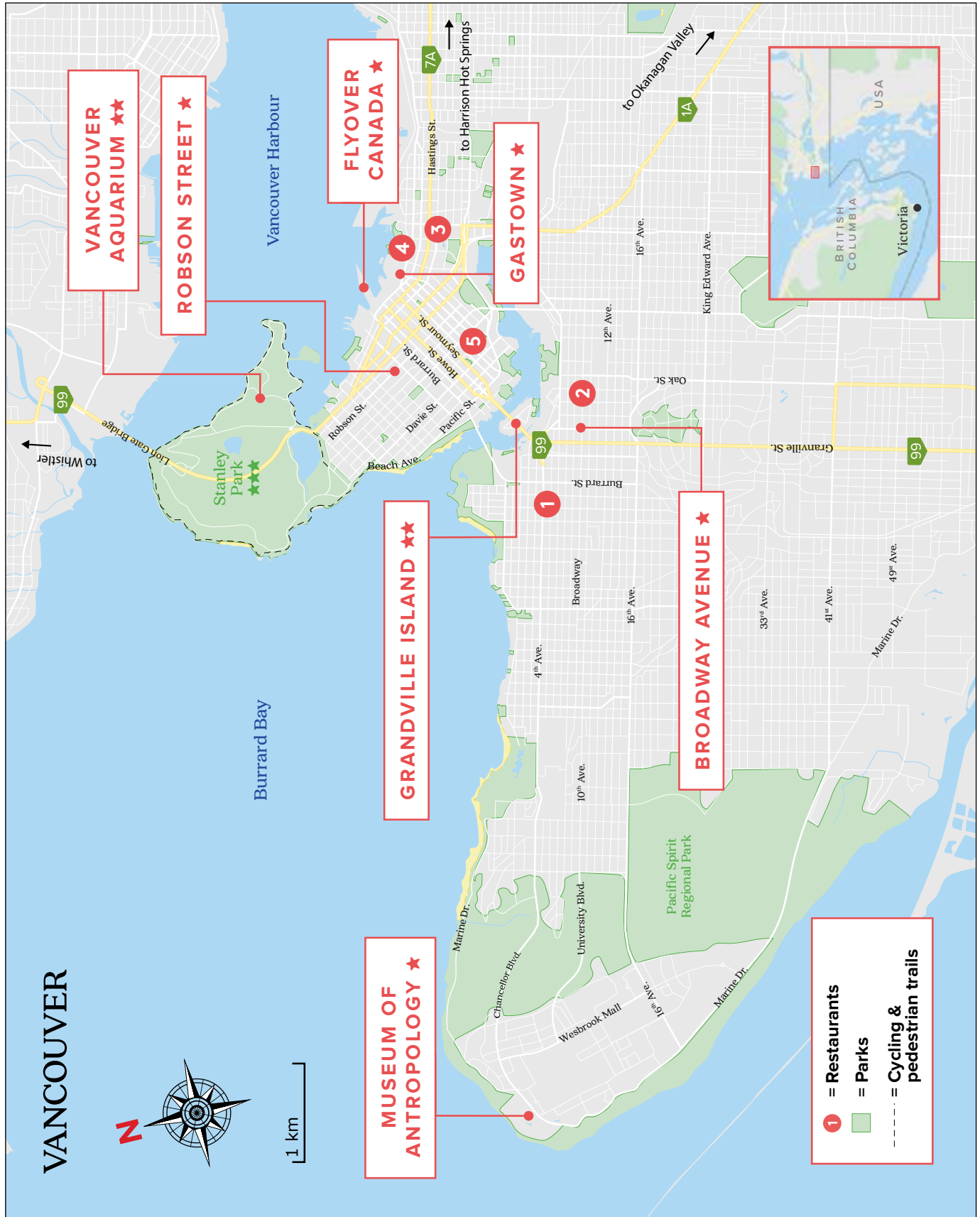
Bao Bei exemplifies the changing face of Chinatown.
BAO-BEI.CA

4 L'ABATTOIR RESTAURANT (\$\$\$)

The restaurant was built in the 19th century on the site of Vancouver's first jail. The French influenced West Coast fare is prepared and served with flare for a unique dining experience. A meat-lover's paradise!
LABATTOIR.CA

5 BLUE WATER CAFE & RAW BAR (\$\$\$\$)

Blue Water Cafe is the ultimate fine dining experience for lovers of fresh seafood. This warm and inviting restaurant offers impeccable service and an abundance of the freshest seafood, prepared in a multitude of ways: sushi, oysters, caviar, fish, and so much more. The menu also includes meat and vegetarian options. Wine-lovers take note, they carry over 1,000 labels and have a cellar of 14,000 bottles!
BLUEWATERCAFE.NET



VICTORIA



The capital of British Columbia, named after Queen Victoria, is a must-see destination for visitors to Western Canada. Victoria is a haven of peace with a proud British heritage, and a city of beautiful contrasts, where the elegance of history mingles with the panache of modern life. You will be charmed by the lovely gardens and the scenic walking route along the waterfront, offering dazzling views of the ocean.

PARLIAMENT OF VICTORIA

WHAT TO DO

INNER HARBOUR ★★

In many ways the Victoria Harbour is the **heart of the city**. Serving as the departure point for many tourist activities, it attracts thousands of visitors every year, in addition to being a working harbour and hub of economic activity. During the summer months, concerts, street performers, food trucks and artists provide enjoyment for visitors and locals alike.

WHALE-WATCHING SAFARI ★★

Take an unforgettable whale watching tour and learn all

about the fascinating orca. Don't forget your camera or video camera to capture the moment. The nutrient-rich waters of the Strait of Juan de Fuca are a fertile feeding ground for ocean wildlife. Three pods of resident **orcas** or "**killer whales**" make this area their summer home. Picture a 2-metre long dorsal fin breaking the surface close to your boat, as an 8-ton mammal comes up to the surface to breathe... It's a sight you will never forget!

BEACON HILL PARK ★

A beautifully landscaped park with **bridges, lakes and a petting zoo**, Beacon Hill Park is one of downtown Victoria's crown jewels. Officially founded in 1882, the park was named after a pair of masts strategically placed on a hill to act as a beacon and navigational aid to mariners approaching Victoria's inner harbour. Beacon Hill Park is a delightful quiet place to do some bird watching and the perfect spot for a summer picnic.

BEACONHILLPARK.COM

ROYAL BC MUSEUM ★★

The **Royal British Columbia Museum** is a history and nature museum that also houses the British Columbia Archives. Founded in 1886, the museum grew in size and importance over the decades and today houses two major collections: natural history and human history, in addition to the BC archives and many temporary exhibitions. Come and learn all about the history and culture of this fascinating province!

ROYALBCMUSEUM.BC.CA



INNER HARBOUR

© iStockPhoto, PhotoService



ROYAL BC MUSEUM

© iStock-54282636 SHAWSHANG61



WHALE WATCHING SAFARI

© iStock-17555265, BirdImages



BEACON HILL PARK

© iStock-828151600, kbeyphotography

AFTERNOON TEA IN VICTORIA

The time-honoured British tradition of “**afternoon tea**” is extremely popular in Victoria, a city whose English heritage is plain to be seen! “Afternoon tea” is taken during the afternoon, between lunch and dinner. The menu may vary from one place to the next, but it traditionally consists of scones with jam and, naturally, a cup of tea! **Q at the Empress Restaurant at the Fairmont Empress Hotel** offers an excellent Afternoon Tea menu, a tasty introduction to this beloved tradition. Open daily from noon. Reservations highly recommended.
TEAATTHEEMPRESS.COM

CHINATOWN★

Victoria’s Chinatown is the **oldest in Canada** and the second-oldest in North America after San Francisco. Characterized by narrow, winding streets and lots of little shops and restaurants,

Chinatown abounds with hidden corners and curiosities. Take a stroll down the historic **Fan Tan Alley**, the narrowest street in Canada, or **Dragon Alley**, where you are sure to discover unexpected treasures.

CRAIGDARROCH CASTLE★★

This historic **Victorian-era Scottish Baronial mansion** was built between **1887 and 1890** on a hill overlooking the City of Victoria. It reflects the wealth of its first owner, **Robert Dunsmuir**, a Scottish immigrant who made his fortune from Vancouver Island coal. He died in 1889 before construction on the castle was completed, leaving the estate to his wife Joan, who lived there until her death in 1908. You can tour the castle with its four floors of exquisite stained glass windows, intricate woodwork and fabulous Victorian-era furnishings.
THECASTLE.CA



THE FAIRMONT EMPRESS



CHINATOWN



CRAIGDARROCH CASTLE

NEARBY

BUTCHART GARDENS ★★

A 30-minute drive from Victoria, the Butchart Gardens features **22 hectares of wonderful floral display**. This world famous attraction and National Historic Site has delighted visitors for over 100 years, since the creation of the first garden in 1904. Made up of **five main theme gardens**, visitors enjoy lush views as they stroll along meandering paths and expansive lawns. Open year-round, the Butchart Gardens offer the chance to admire an astounding display of plants and flowers that change with the seasons. A must-see!

**800, BENVENUTO AVENUE,
BRENTWOOD BAY
250-652-4422
WWW.BUTCHARTGARDENS.COM**



BUTCHART GARDENS

© Destination BC

FESTIVALS

Swiftsure International Yacht Race

Dates : end of May
Organized by the Royal Victoria Yacht Club, this premier long-distance sailing race starting and ending in Victoria offers the colourful spectacle of 200 sailboats and their crews.
SWIFTSURE.ORG

Victoria Dragon Boat Festival

Dates : mid-August
Dragon boating is an extremely popular sport in British Columbia. The Victoria Dragon Boat Festival will provide you with another option if you missed the June event in Vancouver. Watch some 90 teams paddle across Victoria's Inner Harbour in an exciting, colourful 500-metre race.
VICTORIADAGONBOAT.COM



VICTORIA DRAGON BOAT FESTIVAL

© shutterstock 709046099, GTS Productions

WHERE TO EAT

1 BLUE FOX CAFE (\$-\$\$)

Victoria's first and foremost all-day breakfast. Not in the mood for breakfast? The menu also includes soups, sandwiches, burgers and quesadillas. Be warned, this is an extremely popular spot so you may be better off going outside of peak hours.

THEBLUEFOXCAFE.COM

2 FISHHOOK (\$-\$-\$\$\$)

This unique little restaurant specializes in fish and tartines packed with new and surprising

flavours. The menu also includes a variety of curries, salads, soups and share platters featuring sustainable, locally sourced and farm fresh ingredients. A local favourite!

FISHHOOKVIC.COM/FORT-STREET

3 STAGE WINE BAR (\$-\$-\$\$\$)

A cozy wine bar and upscale tapas restaurant. Located close to Belfry Theatre, just a few minutes from downtown Victoria, it's the perfect place to grab a bite to eat before a

concert! The menu changes daily. A welcoming atmosphere guaranteed, friendly service, and a wine list that will charm connoisseurs and novices alike.

STAGEWINEBAR.COM

4 IL TERRAZZO (\$-\$-\$\$\$)

One of the oldest restaurants in Victoria! Il Terrazzo features a large courtyard where gardens, brick walls and wood fireplaces combine to create a warm and welcoming atmosphere. The menu offers fine Italian cuisine accompanied by a vast selection

of wines, most of which can be ordered by the glass. The ideal place for an intimate candlelight dinner!

ILTERRAZZO.COM

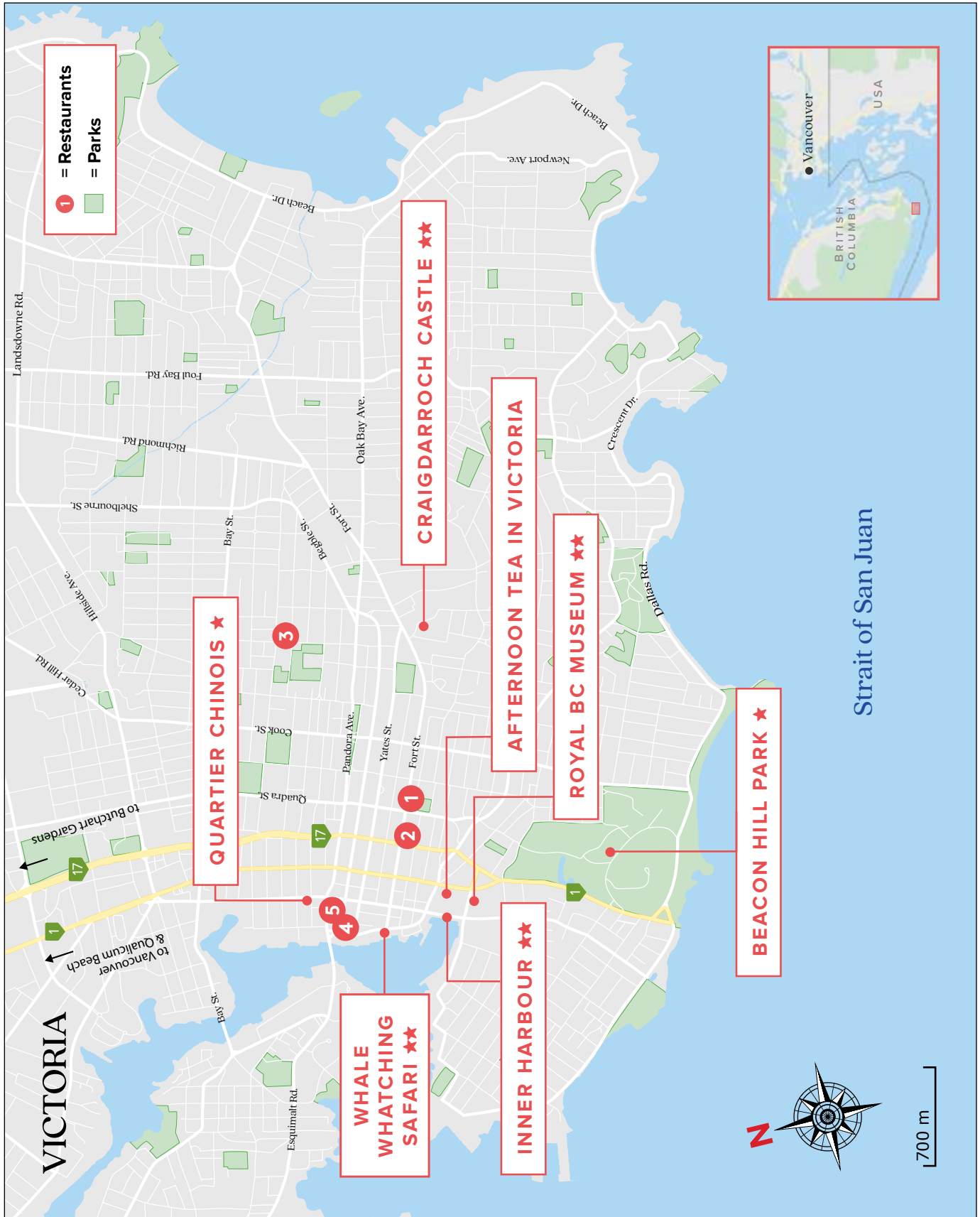
5 SWANS PUB (\$-\$-\$\$\$)

Open since 1989, Swans is a hotel, a microbrewery and a pub. It's a great place to enjoy a casual bistro-style meal. The warm, friendly ambiance will make you feel right at home as you sip your craft beer, glass of wine or cocktail.

SWANSBREWERY.COM



SUNSET IN THE PORT OF VICTORIA



WATERTON

The first International Peace Park in the world (in combination with Glacier National Park in Montana, USA), Waterton Lakes National Park★★ offers spectacular scenery and is a paradise for hikers. Waterton Lakes National Park is home to more than 1,000 plant and flower species including 175 species of wildflowers listed as rare in Alberta, 20 of which are only found in Waterton! The park also offers exceptional opportunities for wildlife watching, because wild animals are simply everywhere! There are even frequent bear sightings on the golf course! Keep that in mind if you are looking for a good (safe) spot from which to observe them.

WATERTON, ALBERTA

WHAT TO DO

CRYPT LAKE HIKE ★★★

Distance (round-trip): 17.2 km

Time (round-trip): 6 hours

Level: Difficult

Elevation gain: 700 m

Climbing 17.2 km to an elevation of 2,200 metres, this hiking trail in Waterton Lakes National Park is both challenging and rewarding, providing spectacular panoramas that are worth every ounce of effort. In addition to the views, highlights include a steel ladder bolted to the mountain and a 60-foot tunnel carved through the rock that leads to **magnificent Crypt Lake**. The hike takes about 6 hours.

CAMERON LAKE ★

Distance (round-trip): 3 km

Time (round-trip): 1 hour

Level: Easy

The road to this picturesque alpine lake in the heart of Waterton Lakes National Park is an unforgettable 16 kilometer drive that winds gently through the mountain scenery, revealing one breathtaking vista after another. Along the way, you can even pay a visit to a National Historic Site commemorating Western Canada's first oil well. Once you reach Cameron Lake, take a walk along the 1.6 km (3 km round-trip) **lakeside trail** along the lake's western shore and drink in the pristine beauty of your surroundings. **(Area affected by the Kenow wildfire).**

KENOW WILDFIRE

In September 2017, after an exceptionally hot, dry summer, a wildfire ravaged 19,303 hectares of the park, or about 40% of its area, transforming the landscape.

Wildfires occur naturally and fulfil critical ecosystem functions. It will take years for regrowth to occur.

WATERTON LAKES NATIONAL PARK ★★★

Season: Open year-round, 24 hours a day.

Park reception: Park information and passes available at the park gate on weekends and holidays.

Visitor Centre: A temporary Visitor Centre has been set up at 209, Fountain Avenue, in the town of Waterton (403-859-5133).

www.pc.gc.ca/fr/pn-np/ab/waterton



CRYPT LAKE HIKE



CAMERON LAKE

RED ROCK CANYON ★

The Red Rock Parkway weaves its way west through the rolling grasslands of **Blakiston Creek Valley** before climbing about 10 km to reach Red Rock Canyon, where the prairie meets the mountains. At the end of the road, a 2-km (4 km round-trip) self-guided loop trail allows visitors to explore the edge of this vibrant red rock canyon with its sparkling mountain stream. The wildflowers along the parkway are spectacular in

June, and wildlife sightings are common. **(Area affected by the Kenow wildfire)**

SCENIC LAKE CRUISE ★★

Join the Waterton Shoreline Cruise Co for a scenic cruise on **Waterton Lake, from Canada to the United States**. The cruise is accompanied by an informative and entertaining commentary given by experienced local tour guides. Enjoy some of the most spectacular mountain scenery the Rocky Mountains have to

offer! The cruise lasts 1 and ¼ hour. Don't forget your camera: in addition to the breathtaking scenery, you are sure to see plenty of wildlife! Cruises offered from early May through to the end of October. All departures are from Waterton Marina.

WATERTONCRUISE.COM

THE BEAR'S HUMP

Distance (round-trip): 2.8 km
Time (round-trip): 1 hour
Level: Intermediate
Elevation gain: 225 m

This short, moderately-difficult hike is a favourite with locals and visitors alike. From a distance, the mountain looks like the outline of a grizzly bear. Benches are located along the way, and a final set of steps leads you up to the flat top of the "hump". From here you will enjoy superb views of views of the mountain peaks down the valley and the prairies to the north.



RED ROCK CANYON



RED ROCK CANYON HIKE DURING SUNSET



SCENIC LAKE CRUISE



HEAD-SMASHED-IN BUFFALO JUMP

© Wikimedia Commons

NEARBY

HEAD-SMASHED-IN BUFFALO JUMP ★★

This open-air museum will teach you about the culture of the Blackfoot Nation. Long used for stampeding buffalo, the site is now a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** that bears witness

to the ecological, mythological, archaeological and technological heritage of the area. The site is 18 kilometres (15 minutes) north-west of Fort Macleod, on secondary Highway #785 (paved).

HEADSMASHEDIN.CA



BIG HORNS SHEEP

© iStock 804587790, Inger Eriksen

FESTIVALS

Waterton Wildflower Festival

Dates: mid-June

With over 1,000 species of plants, including more than 50 of Canada's rare flowers, Waterton Lakes National Park is the Wildflower Capital of Canada. The Waterton Wildflower Festival celebrates this diversity with events such as workshops on wildflower photography and art and guided wildflower identification hikes.

Waterton Wildlife Weekend

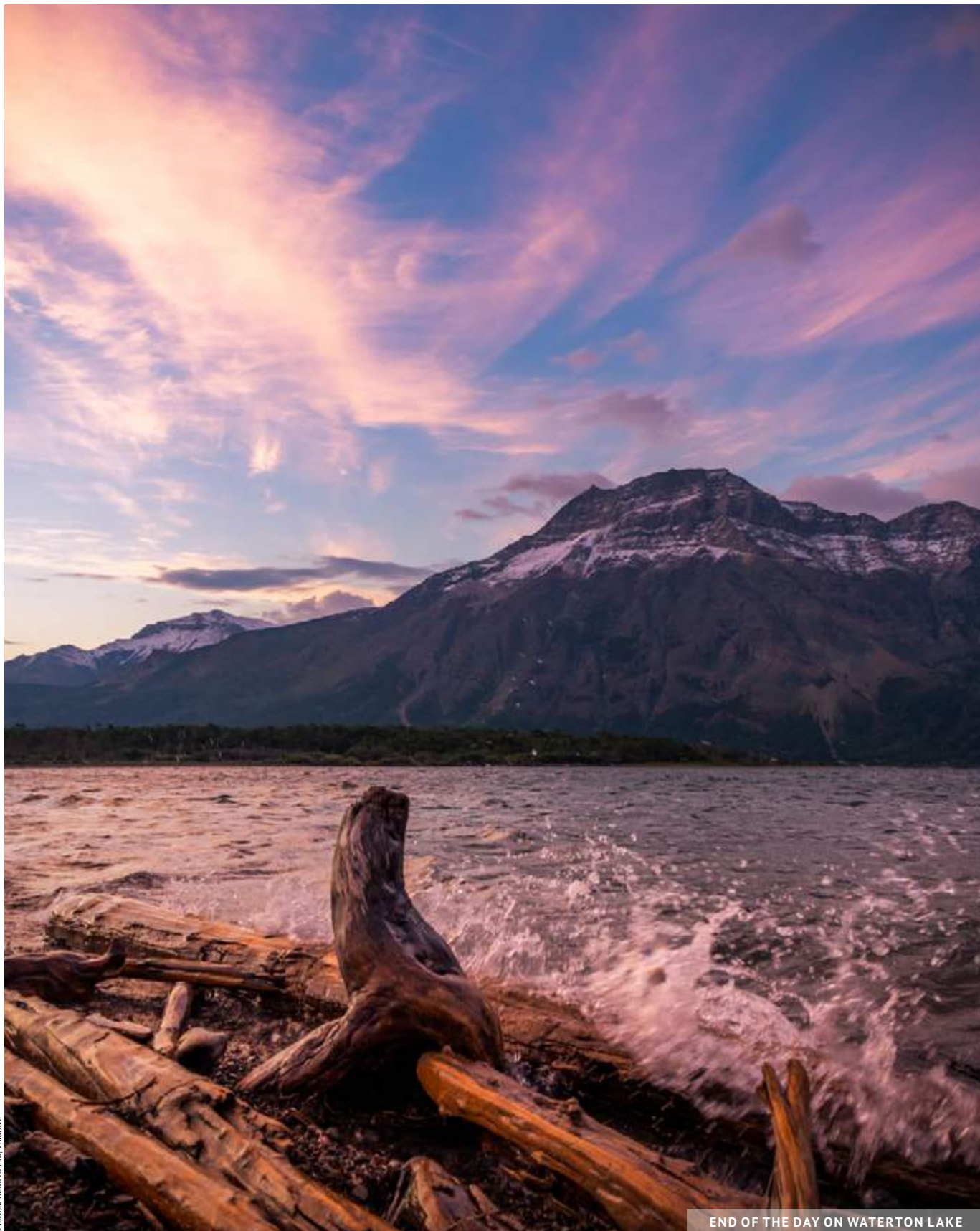
Dates: late September

Waterton Lakes National Park is home to a wide diversity of wildlife. Learn all about the region's animals during these 4 days of events and activities like dozens of different hikes and workshops.



WATERTON LAKES

© AdobeStock estovlini



END OF THE DAY ON WATERTON LAKE



© AdobeStock, Lucie

PRINCE OF WALES HOTEL, WATERTON PARK

WHERE TO EAT

WIENERS OF WATERTON (\$)

It has been said that the best hot dogs in the world can be found in Waterton! After a busy day of outdoor fun, stop off at Wieners of Waterton and enjoy a good quick meal by the outdoor fire

pit. The delicious gourmet hot dogs are served on homemade buns baked fresh every morning. WIENERSOFWATERTON.COM

BAYSHORE LAKESIDE CHOPHOUSE (\$\$)

A cross between a classic steakhouse and an upscale restaurant, the Lakeside Chophouse is without a doubt the best seat in the house when

it comes to enjoying the view of Waterton Lake. Also offers an interesting wine list with a good selection of Okanagan Valley wines.

LAKESIDECHOPHOUSE.COM

WELLS GRAY NATIONAL PARK



Wells Gray Park, often known as the Waterfall Park, is one of British Columbia's most spectacular **wilderness parks**. It is not one of the better-known parks, making it a good place to get away from the hordes of tourists. The park is home to a **large black bear population**, more frequently seen early in the morning or in the evening when they venture out in groups to feed. This is one of the best places in the Rockies for black bear watching.

CANOE TRIP ON CLEARWATER LAKE

WHAT TO DO

HELMCKEN FALLS ★★★

Many people consider this to be the **most spectacular waterfall in Western Canada**. The viewing platform is easily accessible from the road, making this a popular stop for visitors, who are always impressed by the awe-inspiring power and magnificent natural setting. The best time to appreciate the full splendour of the falls is in late afternoon, when the sun is near the top of the falls.

SPAHATS FALLS ★★★

Spahats Falls is a stunning waterfall. They plunge more than 60 meters (197 feet) into a deep canyon, and a short, easy trail leads you to breathtaking views, to the powerful sound of

rushing water. Surrounded by lush, refreshing forests, it's an ideal place to take photos and enjoy nature.

DAWSON FALLS ★★★

Driving along the Clearwater Valley Road in Wells Gray Provincial Park, you'll arrive at Dawson Falls. A short 10-minute stroll through old-growth forest brings you to this impressive terraced waterfall, where water cascades down 200,000-year-old lava beds. Stretching 90 metres (295 feet) across the Murtle River, the falls form a fascinating veil of shallow water. With two remarkable vantage points, you can get up close to the tumultuous river or admire a panoramic view downstream.

BAILEY'S CHUTE ★

In August and September, in early morning or evening, you can view **salmon jumping upstream** ★★ as they return to their spawning ground. Bailey's Chute is located in Clearwater Valley, about 60 kilometres from Wells Gray Park, and flows into the Clearwater River. The observation platform is near the parking lot.

CANOEING ON CLEARWATER LAKE ★★

Canoeing on Clearwater Lake is a chance to experience a quintessential Canadian pastime in an enchanting natural setting. You will find inner peace as you glide through pristine landscapes. Be sure to keep an **eye out for wildlife!** Canoes can

be rented at the boat launch on Clearwater Lake. Guided tours are also available.

MOUL FALLS ★★

Distance (round-trip): 5.5km
Time (round-trip): 2 hours
Level: Moderate
Elevation gain: 210 m

Although the route includes stairs on the most technical section, it is designed to be accessible to a wide range of hikers. One of the highlights of this hike is the opportunity to walk behind Moul Falls, a unique experience that often leaves visitors with lasting memories. As you approach the falls, you'll be enveloped by the soothing sound of the water and the surrounding natural beauty.



HELMCKEN FALLS

© iStock-123142332, Glowing Earth

TROPHY MOUNTAIN ★★

Go hiking through the **most beautiful sub-alpine meadows ★★** in the Rockies. The wildflower blooms are at their peak in July and August.

SHEILA LAKE ★★

Distance (round-trip): 6 km

Time (round-trip): 4 hours

Level: Moderate

Elevation gain: 200 m

This trail offers easy access to **beautiful sub-alpine meadows**. From the parking lot, a 1 km (45 minute) hike rises gently through forest and crosses small streams to reach the sub-alpine meadows. From there, an additional 1.5 km leads to **Sheila Lake**. Take a break and enjoy your surroundings before retracing your steps, or you can continue on to the panoramic views of **Skyline Ridge** (12 km round trip from the parking lot).



RAFTING ★★

Clearwater is renowned for whitewater rafting, and several companies offer this exciting adventure such as: **Interior Whitewater Expeditions**, **Liquid Lifestyles and Riverside Adventures**. For a unique perspective on the park, **Clearwater Lake Tours** offers a full-day excursion on the lake. Finally, for the young and adventurous, **X Sky Paragliding** operates from Birch Island.



SPA HATS CREEK

© shutterstock_1124064575

NEARBY**PHOTO SAFARI BY BOAT ★★**

Halfway between Mount Robson and Wells Gray Park, hop on a boat for an exciting bear safari! Explore the valley, travelling through pristine glacier-fed rivers and lakes. You're sure to see animal life on these shores. The guides will also show you glaciers and waterfalls plunging from the surrounding mountains. The River Safari is the most popular tour, but the company also offers other options. Departures every 30 or 60 minutes throughout the summer, starting in May. No reservation required.

RIVERSAFARI.COM



BLACK BEAR

© AdobeStock-134469362, winterbilder

OÙ MANGER ?

1 WILDFLOUR CAFE (\$)

Wildflour Cafe is a Clearwater treasure, renowned for its exceptional coffee and dishes prepared with fresh, quality ingredients. Everything here is homemade, from the meat broths in the soups to the ancient flours ground on site for the pastries. Their range of artisan drinks, accompanied by delicious pastries, makes every visit a gourmet experience.
WILDFLOURCAFE.CA

2 THE PAINTED TURTLE RESTAURANT (\$\$)

Located on Dutch Lake, this

restaurant offers good food, an open-air covered patio and a spectacular view of the lake. The menu focuses on local and regional products, seasonal produce and fresh ingredients. You can even observe the lake's Painted Turtles.

PTR.DUTCHLAKE.COM

3 HOP N' HOG TAP & SMOKEHOUSE (\$\$)

Open only since 2015, this restaurant has quickly become local favourite. Maybe it's the tasty organic coffee, or because they bake their own bread... They also smoke their own meat

and fish, and offer BBQ evenings with live music. Don't miss it!

HOPNHOG.CA

4 GATEWAY GRILL (\$)

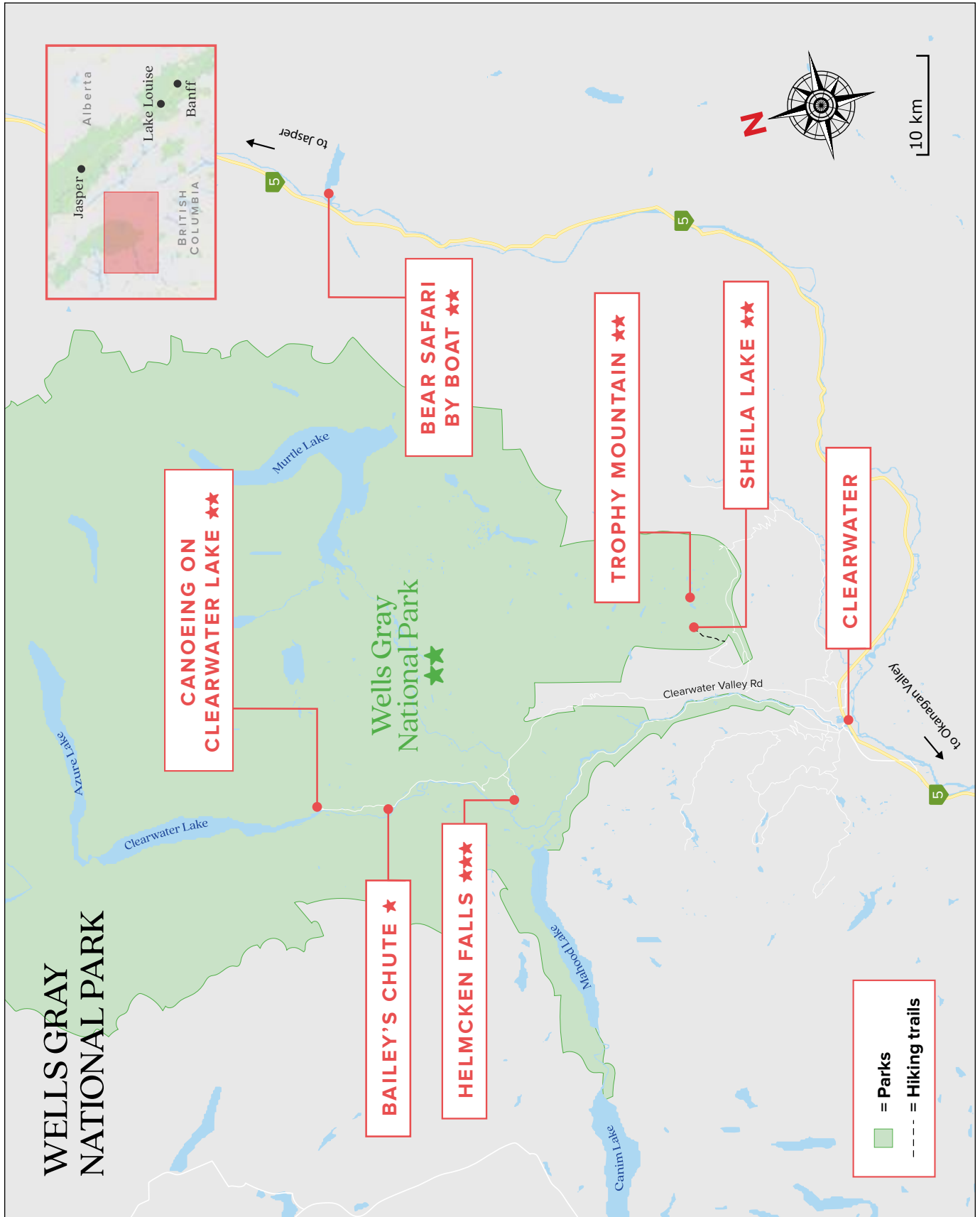
Gateway Grill is a friendly restaurant in Clearwater, ideal for meals with family and friends. With a varied menu featuring classic dishes and local specialties, this grill is renowned for its juicy burgers, crispy fries and tasty vegetarian options. The warm, relaxed atmosphere makes it the perfect place to unwind after a day of adventure.
GATEWAYGRILL.CA

5 BACKCOUNTRY BOWLS (\$)

Backcountry Bowls is a plant-based food truck, offering healthy, tasty take-out perfect for your adventures. Their menu, crafted with fresh ingredients from local producers, includes homemade bowls, smoothies and sweets. Committed to sustainability, they use compostable and recyclable containers to minimize their environmental impact.
BACKCOUNTRYBOWLS.CA



YELLOWHEAD HIGHWAY



WHISTLER



Whistler is a resort town about two hours from Vancouver. Nestled high in the southern Pacific Ranges of British Columbia's Coast Mountains, Whistler offers exhilarating outdoor adventures and activities year-round and is one of the most popular tourist destinations in Canada. Best known for its world-class ski slopes, Whistler also boasts golf courses, tennis courts and many hiking and biking trails with magnificent views of the surrounding mountains.

SEA TO SKY HIGHWAY

WHAT TO DO

WHISTLER VILLAGE ★★

Located at the base of Whistler and Blackcomb Mountains, Whistler Village is the central neighbourhood of the town of Whistler. There's always something to see and do, and the sights and sounds change with the seasons. With its magnificent scenery and panoply of outdoor activities of all kinds, the Village will be your gateway to adventure! Relax and enjoy the friendly Whistler atmosphere and unique mountain culture! To get to Whistler Village, you can take the free **Route 5 shuttle** from the **Gondola Transit Exchange** (Blackcomb Way, Whistler) to **Upper Village**. Otherwise, the village offers pay parking (Day Lots 1 to 5). **Whistler Village** and **Village North** are easily explored on foot.

PICNIC AT LOST LAKE PARK ★

Situated at tranquil Lost Lake, this secluded park offers a sandy beach, pristine swimming waters and more and is within walking distance from Whistler Village. It is a perfect spot to recharge your batteries or to enjoy a quiet picnic. After lunch, hike one of the many trails and drink in the spectacular mountain scenery. The free **Route 8 shuttle** will take you to **Lost Lake** in July and August, when there is no parking at the lake. The shuttle **leaves from the Gondola Transit Exchange** (Blackcomb Way, Whistler), where you can park in one of the nearby pay parking lots (Day Lots 1 to 5). **RV parking is available** in Day Lot 3.

SEAPLANE TOUR ★★

Enjoy a bird's eye view of breathtaking **Garibaldi Provincial Park**. This popular scenic flight will take you over majestic glaciers, dizzying mountain peaks, volcanic

formations and alpine meadows surrounding the turquoise waters of Lake Garibaldi. And if you watch carefully, you may spot a wandering black bear feeding on wild berries, or mountain goats looking for a salt marsh. This is sure to be a high point in your Western Canadian adventure! Open every day from May to October.

HARBOURAIR.COM/TOURS/WHISTLER



WHISTLER VILLAGE

© Destination BC



INUKSHUK ON WHISTLER MOUNTAIN

© iStockPhoto, imagineGolf



SEAPLANE TOUR

© AdobeStock Photo, schukzfoto

PEAK 2 PEAK GONDOLA ★

The Peak 2 Peak gondola, which links Whistler and Blackcomb Mountains in about 11 minutes, is not your average gondola ride. A feat of engineering, it boasts the longest unsupported lift span in the world (3.024 kilometres) and is the highest lift of its kind with an elevation of 436 metres. The special glass-bottom gondola is a thrilling experience that offers stunning 360-degree views of Whistler Village, mountain peaks, lakes, glaciers and forests. Open year-round.

The **Peak 2 Peak Gondola terminal can be reached via the Whistler Village Gondola** (4309 Skiers Plaza, Whistler). The gondola runs daily from late May to mid-September, and Saturday-Sunday only from mid-September to mid-October.

WHISTLERBLACKCOMB.COM

VALLEA LUMINA ★★

Legend tells of a hidden trail leading to a secret valley...

Moment Factory brings the forests of Whistler to life, enhancing the natural beauty of the landscape with a **multimedia light show** to create a magical world. Experience the wonder of this immersive **night walk** as a fascinating tale of mystery unfolds around you. Open every evening in summer and Thursday-Monday from November to April for a winter experience. Tickets can be purchased online. Shuttle service is provided from Gateway Bus Loop.

VALLEALUMINA.COM



© Crystal Lodge

PEAK 2 PEAK GONDOLA



© iStock-466971275, iStockphotoX

GARIBALDI LAKE



WINTER IN BLACKCOMB

© Tim Gillin

NEARBY

GARIBALDI PROVINCIAL PARK AND GARIBALDI LAKE ★★

Discover the **natural beauty** of this provincial park, which is named after its towering 2,678 metre peak, **Mount Garibaldi**. With more than **90 km of trails**, the park is known for its stunning scenery and its endless hiking opportunities. Garibaldi Park is open year-round, but some services are limited in winter. Five park access points are located along HWY 99 (the Sea to Sky Highway) between Squamish and Pemberton.

ENV.GOV.BC.CA/BCPARKS/EXPLORE/PARKPGS/GARIBALDI/

JOFFRE LAKES ★★

This provincial park is known for the **turquoise blue waters** of its three lakes: **Lower, Middle** and **Upper Joffre Lakes**. Their striking, saturated blue colour is caused by “rockflour” – or glacial silt – that is suspended in

the water and reflects green and blue wavelengths of sunlight. The snow-capped peaks behind Lower Joffre Lake are visible from an easily accessible viewpoint 500 metres from the parking lot. If you continue towards Middle Lake and Upper

Joffre Lake, the trail becomes steeper and more challenging. The full hike is a 7.7 km round trip. Bookings mandatory.

ENV.GOV.BC.CA/BCPARKS/EXPLORE/PARKPGS/JOFFRE_LKS



NORTHERN LIGHTS IN WHISTLER

© iStock-452381913, Jimmy/LW



© iStock-693138680, LeonU

SEA TO SKY GONDOLA ★★★

British Columbia's «Newest Attraction», the Sea to Sky gondola lives up to its name, transporting visitors high above the coast for a **thrilling adventure and stunning vistas**. Your adventure begins with a 10-minute gondola ride to 885 metres above sea level. The

ride up to the summit provides **sweeping views ★★★** of Howe Sound, the majestic coastal forest and surrounding mountains. Once at the top, many other adventures for all ages await. You will have access to a wide array of outdoor experiences including the spectacular Sky Pilot Suspension Bridge, picnicking, a café

terrace, rock climbing and many hiking trails. Discount with online purchase.

SEATOSKYGONDOLA.COM

BRANDYWINE FALLS ★

Twenty minute from Whistler along Highway 99 you will find Brandywine Falls, a spectacular 70 metre waterfall, is located

within Brandywine Falls Provincial Park. The waterfall is best seen from the viewing platform, which also presents some marvelous views of Daisy Lake and the surrounding mountains. The 30-minute round trip hike to the viewpoint is easy and well worth the effort! BCPARKS.CA/EXPLORE/PARKPGS/BRANDYWINE_FALLS/



SEA TO SKY GONDOLA



BRANDYWINE FALLS



© Destination BC

WHISTLER AREA



CAMP FIRE AT THE END OF THE DAY

© © Destination BC, Randy Lincks

FESTIVALS

Crankworx Whistler Mountain Bike Festival

Dates : end of July - beginning of August

Annual celebration of downhill mountain biking with world-class competitions, demonstrations, extreme events and more. Huge crowds of spectators gather to watch the many events in each year's line-up: youth races, men's and women's events, professional enduro races, and more.

WHISTLER.COM/EVENTS/CRANKWORX/

World Ski and Snowboard Festival

Dates : mid-April

This annual celebration of Whistler's unique mountain culture combines music, art and snow sports for 10 memorable days of non-stop events and action on and off the slopes.

WSSF.COM

GO Fest Whistler's Great Outdoors Festival

Dates : end of May

Celebrate Whistler's great outdoors with 4 days of events and activities. From music and art to educational activities and sports, there is something for everyone to enjoy.

GREATOUTDOORSFEST.COM

Whistler Village Beer Festival

Dates : mid-September

Whistler Village Beer Festival is 7 days of fun and good beer. The main event is held at Whistler Olympic Plaza and features 60 craft breweries with more than 120 beers and ciders.

GIBBONSWHISTLER.COM/FESTIVALS-EVENTS/WHISTLER-VILLAGE-BEER-FESTIVAL



WHERE TO EAT

1 LA CANTINA URBAN TACO BAR (\$)

La Cantina is the place to go for the best tacos in a variety of forms, as well as delicious burritos, soups and salads. Also offers gluten-free, vegan and vegetarian options. A must for lovers of Mexican food!
TACOSLACANTINA.CA

2 SUSHI VILLAGE JAPANESE CUISINE (\$\$)

This local favourite offers a range of Japanese cuisine including soups, salads, sushi, Teriyaki dinners and hot pots.

There's something for everyone! *Reservations are recommended.*
SUSHIVILLAGE.COM

3 CREEKBREAD (\$\$)

Creekbread specializes in gourmet organic pizza cooked in a wood-fired stone oven. With its delicious food and friendly atmosphere, it will be a favourite for the whole family.
CREEKBREAD.COM

4 ARAXI RESTAURANT & BAR (\$\$\$)

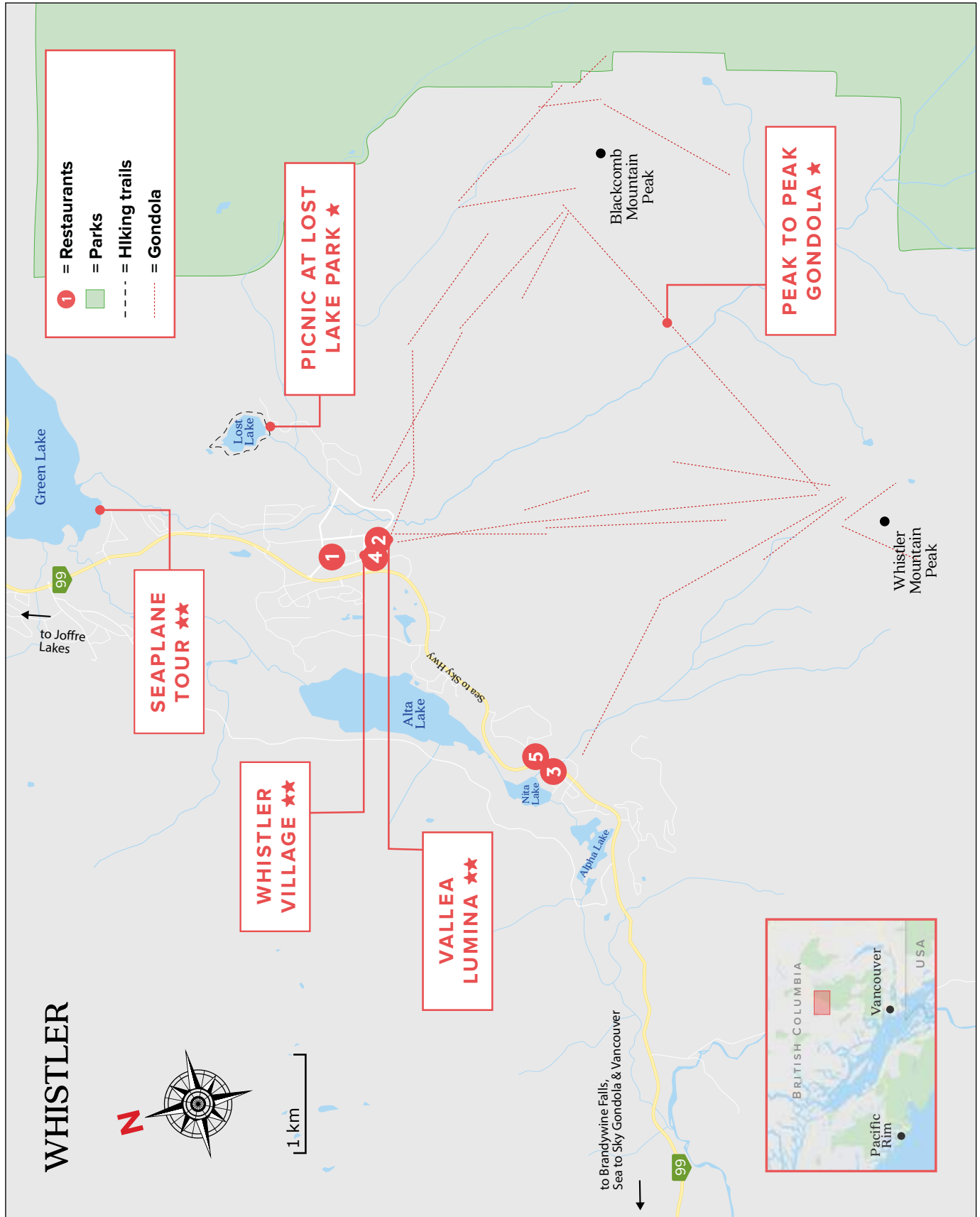
Voted the best restaurant in Whistler, dinner at Araxi is a

gourmet pleasure every visitor should experience! With its menu entirely built around regionally-sourced ingredients (right down to the fish and seafood) and a very extensive wine cellar, Araxi is a favourite with locals and visitors alike!
ARAXI.COM

5 RIMROCK CAFE & OYSTER BAR (\$\$\$-\$\$\$\$)

Consistently ranked among the top restaurants in Whistler, the Rimrock Café is a Whistler icon. Its chef and owner Rolf Gunther has clearly found a winning

formula, offering a unique fine dining experience in a rustic elegant atmosphere typical of mountain resort towns. The menu features Pacific Northwest cuisine with seafood, fresh fish and game.
RIMROCKCAFE.COM



PRACTICAL INFORMATION



FRENCH IN CANADA

Canada is officially bilingual, with English and French as its official languages. The majority language is English everywhere except Quebec, where the official language is French.

EASTERN CANADA

Québec

(Quebec City, Montreal, etc.)

French: 81.8%

English: 10.6%

Other: 7.6%

Ontario

(Toronto, Niagara, Ottawa, etc.)

French: 2.5%

English: 81.4%

Other: 16.1%

New Brunswick

French: 29.7%

English: 69.0%

Other: 1.3%

WESTERN CANADA

Alberta

(Calgary, Rockies, etc.)

French: 2.0%

English: 72.6%

Other: 25.4%

British Columbia

(Vancouver, Whistler, etc.)

French: 1.5%

English: 68.3%

Other: 30.2%

PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

Canadian public holidays 2024

- New Year's Day: January 1
- Good Friday : March 29
- Easter Monday: April 1st
- Victoria Day: May 20
- Quebec National Holiday: June 24 (Quebec only)
- Canada Day: July 1
- British Columbia Day : August 5 (BC only)

- Heritage Day - Alberta: August 5 (Alberta only)
- Labour Day: September 2
- Thanksgiving: October 14
- Remembrance Day: November 11
- Christmas: December 25

OTHER HOLIDAYS

While many tourist attractions stay open on public holidays, it is best to check before planning your visit. Students in Canada generally have a week off in November and another in March. The dates may vary between regions. In addition, nearly 25% of Quebec workers are on holiday during the last two weeks of July (known as the Construction Holiday). As many tourist attractions can be extremely busy at this time, you might want to take this into consideration when planning your trip.



TAXES

Welcome to the land of mental arithmetic! Unless otherwise indicated, prices shown in Canada do not include taxes (or tip). A 5% federal goods and services tax (GST) is applicable to all transactions in Canada, with the exception of basic food items. In addition, most provinces apply a provincial

sales tax. This provincial tax varies between provinces. Here is a list of **2024 total sales tax rates** by province:

- Québec : 15%
- Ontario : 13%
- New Brunswick : 15%
- Nova Scotia : 15%
- Alberta : 5%
- British Columbia : 12%
- Yukon : 5%

NB - Provincial sales tax may vary depending on the product or service. During your Canadian vacation, to know how much something costs you will need to mentally add the sales tax, which is not included in the price displayed. In Quebec, for example, sales tax is about 15% (5% federal GST + 10% provincial tax). A \$100 item will therefore cost you around \$115 (\$100 + 15%).

TIPPING

Prices indicated in restaurants do not include taxes or tip. It is customary to leave a tip equivalent to **15% of the bill** (before taxes) for the wait staff. You can give the tip directly to your waiter/waitress or, more commonly, simply leave it on the table. Not leaving a tip is frowned upon and may earn you some unfriendly looks. Tipping is not common in fast food restaurants (such as McDonalds). Here is a list of other services for which it is customary to leave a tip:

- Pizza (or other) delivery driver: 10%
- Barman: \$1 per drink
- Bellhop: \$1 per bag
- Chambermaid: \$2 per night
- Valet parking: \$2 per vehicle
- Hairdresser: 10%
- Taxi : 10%
- Gas station attendant: \$2
- Coat check: \$1 per coat
- Guide: \$2 to \$5 per person per day.



CANADA FACT SHEET

Area

Total : 10 000 000 km²

Rank : 2nd largest country in the world after Russia

Population

Total : 38 000 000

inhabitants

Rank : 38th

GENERAL INFORMATION

Capital : Ottawa
(Ontario)

Official languages:

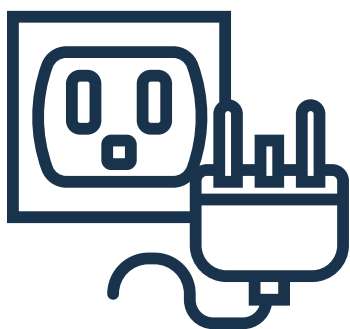
English and French. French is spoken mainly in Quebec (where it is the official language) and New Brunswick. In the rest of Canada, the majority language is English, but small French-speaking communities can be found across the country.

Head of government:

Justin Trudeau
(Prime Minister)

Political institutions:

Constitutional monarchy (Canada is a member of the British Commonwealth). Federal state, made up of 10 provinces and 3 territories.



ELECTRIC CURRENT

Like everywhere else in North America, the standard voltage in Canada is 110 volts (60 cycles) rather than the 220 volts used in Europe. European plugs are not compatible with Canadian electrical sockets. In order to plug in your electric appliances, you will need a plug adapter or converter. Otherwise, you will not be able to use your electric appliances during your Canadian vacation (phone charger, camera charger, hairdryer, etc.).

Adapter

In general, an adapter is all you need for non-motorized appliances. Examples include camera chargers, phone chargers, laptops, etc.

Converter

A converter is necessary if you intend to use appliances with a motor, such as a hairdryer or an electric razor. Note that a converter can also be used as an adapter; there is no need to buy both. A converter is more expensive than an adapter. You can purchase adapters and converters at the airport or in large department stores such as Canadian Tire, Rona, Reno Depot, Home Depot, Walmart, etc.

TELEPHONE

Public pay phones charge a minimum of \$0.50 to place a local call, unless you are calling a "toll-free" number. In Canada there are "toll-free" numbers: these are phone numbers beginning with 1-8XX-XXX-XXXX (such as Authentik Canada's toll-free number: 1-855-294-1555). Toll-free numbers make it possible to call the service provider in question (B&B, activity, hotel, etc.) **FREE OF CHARGE.**

Note: these numbers are only free when called from a pay phone or a private Canadian telephone... not when called from a hotel room phone or a European mobile phone! Note that, unlike in Europe, it is **NOT POSSIBLE** to receive calls on a Canadian pay phone. **To call Europe from Canada,** dial 0 followed by 11 and the country code (33 for France - 32 for Belgium - 41 for Switzerland) followed by the local phone number without the leading 0. **To call Canada from Europe,** dial 001 followed by the local phone number including the 3-digit area code.

INTERNET AND PHONE PLANS

First of all, it is good to know that you can use your own mobile phone here in Canada, as

long as it is a tri- or quad-band GSM phone. Most recent mobile phones will work overseas. The best thing to do is to check with your carrier to see whether your particular telephone will work at your destination. Most of the time, the answer is yes.

– Activate the "international" option:

If you have a relatively recent phone contract, international calling is usually activated automatically. If your contract is more than four years old, you will need to contact your carrier to activate this free feature (usually 48 hours prior to departure)

– Roaming:

"Roaming" refers to international agreements between different carriers that allow customers to connect to a local cellular network when travelling outside the geographical coverage area of their home network.

– **Upon your arrival in Canada,** you will receive an SMS from your carrier offering you a travel package which may include unlimited Internet data access and voice calls. However, these packages are not necessarily the best option available (see SIM CARD below). You must be careful when travelling because you will be **charged for both incoming and outgoing phone calls.**

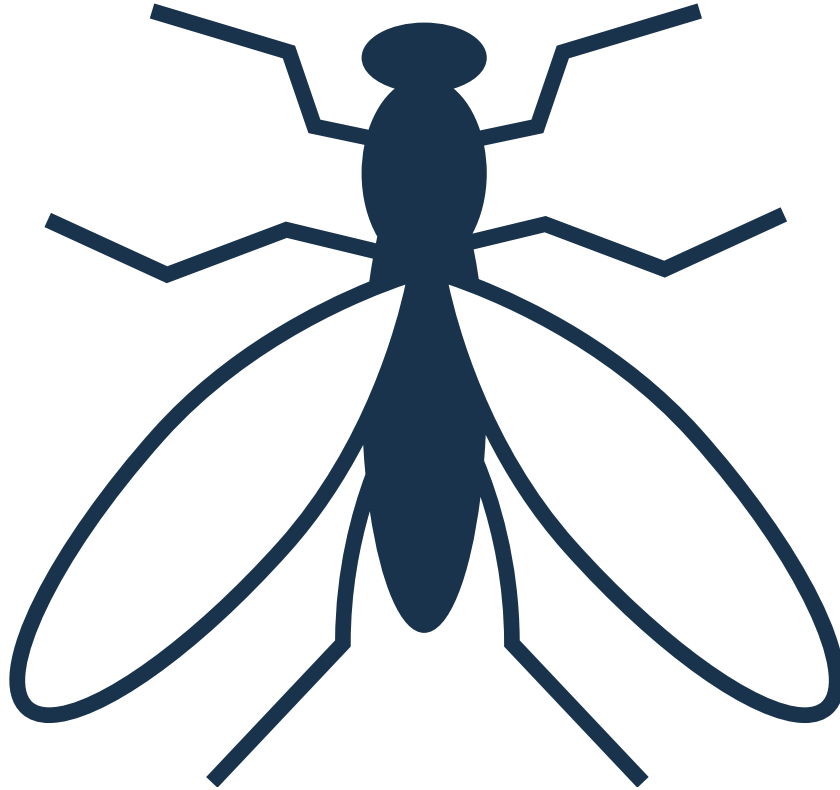
SIM CARD

A more cost-effective way (most of the time) to connect to a local network is to purchase a prepaid SIM card once you have arrived in Canada. Simply insert the card into your telephone.

You will need to ensure that your telephone is unlocked (ask your carrier in Europe). These cards are currently only available for telephones (not tablets) and can be purchased in most pharmacies (Jean Coutu, Uniprix, Pharmaprix, Brunet, etc.), grocery stores (IGA, Metro, Loblaws, Maxi, etc.) and major cell phone stores such as Bell, Rogers, Virgin Mobile and Fido.

Compare the different prepaid offers because some are paid by the day, while others are paid by data volume. Take the time to choose the right package, as some may have a time limit, a date limit, or both. It is also a good idea to check the carrier's **network coverage** in Canada. You can usually do this on the company's website. Bell has some of the best network coverage in Canada. Finally, you will need to know how to insert a SIM card. For example, for an iPhone, you will need a SIM removal tool (provided with the SIM card) in order to eject the SIM tray and change the card. For other types of devices, you need to turn off the phone and remove the back cover and the battery in order to change the SIM card.





PROTECTING YOURSELF FROM MOSQUITOES

Mosquitoes can make your life miserable if you are not prepared to deal with them. Follow the advice below, use a good insect repellent, and you will be able to fully enjoy your experience in our great outdoors.

OUR 7 PRACTICAL TIPS

- 1 In Canada, peak mosquito season is in the month of June. They will be present throughout the summer, but their numbers gradually diminish as the weather heats up.
- 2 Mosquitoes lay their eggs in calm water. You will therefore find more of them near wetlands, ponds and streams.
- 3 Mosquitoes are much more active at dawn and at dusk than the rest of the day. Avoid walks in the forest at these times.
- 4 Long-sleeved shirts and pants and light-coloured clothing are recommended.
- 5 Use a **DEET-based mosquito repellent**. **Watkins** is the most popular brand with Canadians, and the most effective. Note that mosquito repellent creams and sprays have an expiration date. Most of them are only good for one year. You can buy mosquito repellent in any good pharmacy and even some grocery stores.
- 6 When enjoying outdoors activities, **avoid wearing perfume** or other sweet-smelling products which may attract mosquitoes.
- 7 Treat your clothing with a special insect repellent. The active ingredient absorbed into the fibres of the fabric evaporates very slowly, providing a more long-term protection. This option is convenient, cost-effective and safe.

WEATHER

To check the weather forecast for the day or days ahead, we recommend visiting www.meteomedia.com. Search for the city closest to your destination.



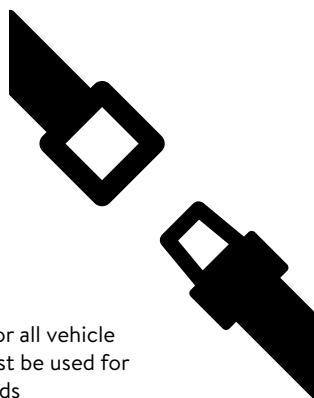
DRIVING IN CANADA

01 DRIVER'S LICENCE

For stays of less than 3 months, a valid driver's license from your home country is all you need to rent and drive a car in Canada. However, we recommend getting an International Driving Permit (IDP), especially if your license is not in French or English. An IDP will give you a translation of your licence into French and English (and must be presented **ALONG WITH** your original license). That way, if you are stopped in a French-speaking province, you can be sure that the officer will be able to understand your legal document. However, an IDP is **not obligatory**.

Note that when you pick up your rental car, you will need to provide a **credit card in the same name as the license of the principal driver** (a security deposit will be pre-authorized on the card in case of damage to the vehicle).

02 BUCKLE YOUR SEATBELT



The use of seat belts is **mandatory** for all vehicle passengers and a child's car seat must be used for children weighing less than 40 pounds

03 PEDESTRIAN CROSSINGS

When you come to a pedestrian crossing, you must slow down and, if necessary, stop the vehicle and yield the right of way to pedestrians. Fines for pedestrian crossing offences can be as high as \$200 in some provinces.

04 SPEED LIMITS

Speed limits vary between 30 km/h and 100 km/h, depending whether you are in town or on the highway. Speed limit signs are posted on all roads indicating the maximum speed permitted. The minimum speed on the highway is 60 km/h and the **maximum is 100 km/h**

05 TURNING RIGHT ON A RED LIGHT



It is generally permitted to turn right when facing a red light everywhere in Canada, **EXCEPT on the Island of Montreal** and at intersections where it is expressly prohibited by the sign above. When you want to turn right on a red light, you must proceed with extra caution because you have a responsibility towards pedestrians. Before turning right on a red light, bring your vehicle to a complete stop!!! **A complete stop is mandatory**. Immobilize your vehicle before the stop line or before the pedestrian crossing zone. **Pedestrians always have the right-of-way if their pedestrian crossing light allows them to cross**. In the absence of a pedestrian crossing light, pedestrians have the right-of-way on a green light. Turning right on a red light is not an obligation; it is a privilege. If you decide to turn, you must wait until the way is clear. Respect the decision of a driver who does not turn right on a red light; do not honk your horn to make him/her advance. Courtesy towards others on the road is always the order of the day!

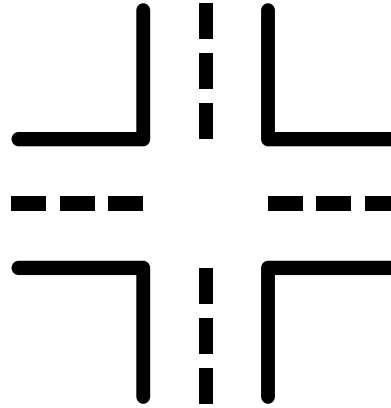
06 GREEN LIGHT VERSUS FLASHING GREEN

In Canada, there are 2 types of green light: the green light, and the flashing green. A green light means the same thing as in Europe. But when you are facing a flashing green light, it means that **you have the right-of-way to make a left turn**.

07

4-WAY STOP

At an intersection with four stop signs, the first to stop is the first to go. If you arrive at the same time as another vehicle, make visual contact with the other driver and signal with your hand (or your lights if it is dark) if you wish to let them go first.



08

REQUIRED RIGHT TURN, LEFT TURN, ETC.

Take a look at this road sign (left). These signs are important, especially for city driving. This sign indicates that you must turn right. You are not allowed to turn left or continue straight under any circumstances. There are signs like this for every situation: left turn or straight ahead, straight ahead through the intersection (i.e. you can neither turn left nor right), etc.

09

ONE-WAY

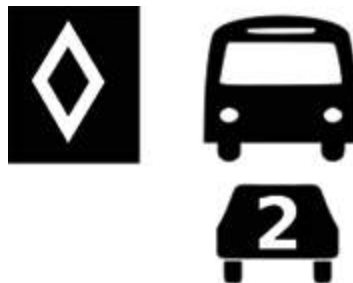
Canadian cities have many one-way streets. These are identified by signs with a large arrow indicating the direction of traffic flow (image on the right). The red sign on the right is a “No Entry” sign, indicating that it is prohibited to turn into the street.



10

DEDICATED LANES

In the city, you must give the right-of-way to city buses that want to merge into moving traffic after leaving a bus stop, when there is a yield sign on the back of the bus (red triangle). In addition, some cities use dedicated lanes for public transit (image on the right). You cannot drive in these lanes during the hours indicated on the road sign.



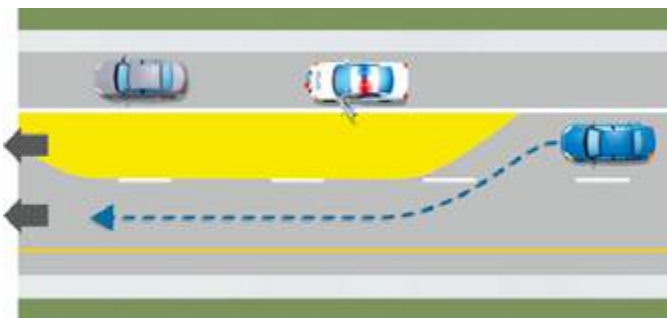
11

PASSING A SCHOOL BUS

Children's safety is the rule, at all times. When a school bus (yellow bus) is stopped and its lights are flashing, you must use caution and **bring your vehicle to a complete stop more than 5 metres from the bus** (whether you are traveling in the same or the opposite direction as the bus).

Before resuming your course, make sure that the flashing lights have been turned off and that the bus is advancing. Failure to comply with this law could earn you 12 demerit points on your driving record in addition to a **heavy fine**.

12 MOVE-OVER LAW



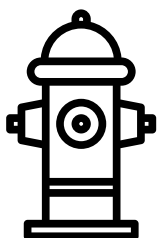
Now in effect in most Canadian provinces, the Move-Over Law ensures the safety of first responders. When an emergency vehicle, a tow truck or a surveillance vehicle is stopped by the side of the road and its rotating or flashing lights are activated, you must slow down and move over to leave as much space as possible between you and the stopped vehicle, but only once you have made sure you can do so safely.

HOW TO OBEY THE MOVE-OVER LAW:

- 1- Slow down.
- 2- If there is another lane going in the same direction you are travelling in, move over into that lane so as to leave a lane between you and the stopped vehicle, but only after making sure that you can do so safely.
- 3- If you cannot change lanes, move over as far as you can—while remaining in the same lane—so as to leave as much space as possible between you and the stopped vehicle.

13 FIRE HYDRANTS

It is **forbidden to stop or park your vehicle within 5 metres of a fire hydrant** or a fire station entrance.



14 PARKING

Be warned that parking can be tricky, especially in large cities like Vancouver. You must carefully read all parking signs (which can be very complicated) to avoid getting a parking ticket.

HERE ARE SOME QUICK TIPS:

- It is forbidden to park against the direction of traffic.
- The days and times when you can park in a given spot may vary.



15 HIGHWAY EXIT SIGNS

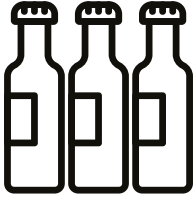
Exit numbers are always written on the highway exit sign (EXIT 173 in the image above). Note that these numbers correspond to the distance in kilometres along the highway. So for example if your destination is Exit 183, when you reach Exit 173 you know that you have 10 more kilometres to drive before reaching your exit. In Canada and the United States, highway signs indicate the highway number (99 North/South, 1 East/West, etc.), and destination (Vancouver, Whistler, etc.).

16 MOBILE PHONES AND SMOKING WHILE DRIVING

It is illegal to use a hand-held mobile device at any time while driving. In most provinces, including British Columbia, smoking is not permitted in vehicles that carry minors aged 16 and under. Otherwise, smoking while driving is still permitted, although a bill has been proposed to ban cigarettes at the wheel.



18 DRINKING AND DRIVING



In Canada, the maximum legal blood alcohol level is quite low, at 80 milligrams of alcohol per 100 millilitres of blood (0.08). This is the equivalent of about one or two drinks, depending on your height and weight. Driving while impaired carries stiff penalties.

In addition, you are putting the lives of others in danger. If you are pulled over or caught driving over the legal alcohol limit during a routine road check you will face **criminal charges**.

During the holiday season (Christmas and New Year's), you can use Opération Nez Rouge. This driving escort service is offered by volunteers who drive you and your car to your place of residence. Only available in Québec.

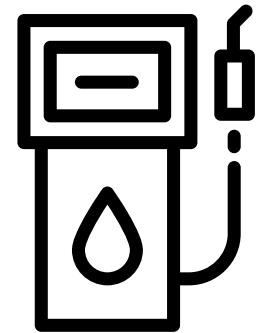


20 IN THE EVENT OF A PROBLEM

Should you have a problem with your rental car (accident, mechanical trouble, lost keys, etc.), please contact **emergency roadside assistance**. The number will be indicated on your keychain or in the glove compartment.

19 IN THE EVENT OF ACCIDENT/INCIDENT

If you are unlucky enough to be involved in an accident or collision, **it is essential to file a police report**. This report could save you from many headaches and extended negotiations with your rental company. Without a police report, the insurance company could deny your claim.



21 REGISTRATION AND INSURANCE

The vehicle registration and insurance papers will be in the glove compartment. In rare cases, you will find them under the sun visor on the driver's side. Always leave these documents in the vehicle. Do not bring them into the rental office with you when you return the vehicle.

22 TYPE OF FUEL

The vast majority of cars rented by our service providers run on **regular unleaded gas** (in French-speaking areas: "ordinaire"). Never fill up with diesel, unless otherwise indicated. If in doubt, contact your rental company. Note that the use of incorrect fuel will be seen as negligence and the rental company will have the right to charge you for all necessary repairs to the vehicle.

23 PLAN YOUR MOVEMENTS EFFICIENTLY

Canadian roads are not always as well maintained as those in Europe. This can increase driving times significantly, as you are forced to drive more slowly in certain places. In addition, every summer there are many sections of road that are under construction, creating traffic and slowing down your movements. Before setting out, it may be a good idea to consult the Ministry of Transport of the province you are visiting for more information about roadworks in progress. In this way you can plan ahead and choose a different route if possible. For example, visit the Transport Québec website for more information about the state of the roads and construction in progress in Québec (www.Quebec511.info).

DRIVING WITH AN AUTOMATIC TRANSMISSION

All vehicles provided by our Canadian rental partners have an automatic transmission.

Although the acceleration is less powerful, driving a vehicle with an automatic transmission is easier than driving a vehicle with a manual transmission. It just takes a little getting used to. The gear shift is simpler and there is no clutch pedal, as an automatic transmission automatically changes gear ratios as the vehicle moves. That means that **you NEVER use your left foot** when driving an automatic car.

AUTOMATIC TRANSMISSION GEAR SHIFT POSITIONS

- P : Park (equivalent to a hand brake)**
- R : Reverse**
- N : Neutral**
- D : Drive**
- 2 : Locks the transmission in second gear**
- 1 : Locks the transmission in first gear**

To start the car, do not apply the brake pedal. As long as the vehicle is in Park, it will not move. It is important to ensure that the vehicle is in Park before starting the engine.

To turn off the engine, bring the car to a complete stop, then move the gear shift into Park before turning off the engine (otherwise you won't be able to remove the key from the ignition).

To advance, apply the brake pedal and **move the gear shift into [D]**. As soon as you release the brake, the car will move forward. Press on the accelerator to gain speed, or on the brake to slow down. And that's it!

You won't need to touch the gear shift again until you want to stop. **The gears will be change automatically.** To stop at a red light, simply put your foot on the brake. Release the brake to get going again.

To reverse, apply the brakes to immobilize the vehicle and then **move the gear shift into [R]**. As soon as you release the brake, the vehicle will move backward.

Gear shift positions 1 and 2 are rarely used. They can be used to downshift on steep downhill slopes to avoid overusing the brakes. In this case, you can shift from position [D] to [2] (and then [1]) directly, without applying the brakes.



CRUISE CONTROL

All full-size or larger vehicles come equipped with cruise control. This option allows the vehicle to maintain a steady cruising speed without requiring the driver to keep his or her foot on the gas pedal.

In most cases, you will find the cruise control buttons on the steering wheel. To turn on cruise control, **press the [on] or [cruise] button.**

Then accelerate or slow down to the desired speed and press the **[set] button**. Take your foot off the accelerator, and the car should maintain its current cruising speed.

To turn off cruise control, simply **apply the brake pedal** gently or press the [on], [cruise] or [cancel] button.

The [+] and [-] buttons can be used to adjust the cruising speed when cruise control is in use.

The **[RES] button** will return the vehicle to the prior set cruising speed after braking.



TRAVELLING BY MOTORHOME

Exploring Canada by motorhome is the perfect way to enjoy our great outdoors. To ensure that your trip goes as smoothly as possible, here is a summary of what you need to know before embarking on your adventure.

© StockPhoto-Jason.V

CITY PARKING

Before setting out to explore Canada by motorhome, it is important to understand that you are not always allowed to park your vehicle wherever you please.

In Quebec, **Montreal** is the only city that has adopted a restrictive policy. Of course, you can drive your motorhome in the city, but you are not allowed to park it in the street. It is also prohibited to park a motorhome in a commercial parking lot (with the exception of Walmart). If you want to visit Montreal, we suggest that you park in Longueuil or Laval, close to a Metro station, and use Montreal's efficient public transit system to get around. You won't need to worry about parking and will have greater freedom to roam the city as you wish.

When visiting **Quebec City**, we strongly recommend that you park your motorhome in the **Indigo - Bassin Louise parking lot** at the Port of Quebec (320 Rue Abraham-Martin). You can then set out on foot to explore Old Québec at your leisure. The parking fee is \$50/6 hours or less or \$70/24 hours. You can also use the free parking at the former Quebec City Zoo (Halte VR de Quebec, 9300, rue de la Faune), which is a 1-hour direct bus ride from Old Quebec (open from the end of June to the end of August).

In Ontario, motorhome parking is restricted only in the nation's capital, **Ottawa**. Once again, it is prohibited to park in the street or in commercial parking lots. Tip: you can park your vehicle in Ottawa's neighbour city of Hull, just on the other side of the bridge across the Ottawa River and a 10-minute walk from downtown Ottawa. Leave your RV at Centre Robert-Guertin (pay parking) and set out with your mind at ease to discover Canada's Capital.

If you want to visit downtown **Toronto**, we suggest parking in the CN Tower pay parking lot. You will then be free to explore the city on foot.

In British Columbia and Alberta, you are allowed to drive in the major cities such as **Vancouver, Victoria and Calgary**. However, we strongly recommend that you leave your vehicle in pay parking lot and use public transit to get around.

REST STOPS

Rest stops are situated along major highways. You can recognise them with the help of clearly identified brown highway signs. **It is prohibited to spend the whole night at a rest stop.** Parking is permitted for a maximum of 4 hours. If you decide to take a chance, it is highly likely that you will be woken up in the middle of the night and forced to move on. Your best option is to spend the night at a campground.

CAMPGROUND CLASSIFICATION

Campgrounds in Canada are classified according to the number of services, as follows:

- 1 service = electricity or water
- 2 services = electricity and water
- 3 services = electricity, water and sewer facilities

HAVE A GOOD TRIP, AND DRIVE CAREFULLY!



SOUVENIRS TO BRING HOME

While the best souvenirs to bring back from Canada are the intangible kind, here are some suggestions for items that will remind you of your trip when you're back at home.

SPECIALTY FOODS/DRINKS

Maple syrup

If Canada had to choose one product to represent the entire country, it would be maple syrup and all of its delicious derivatives: maple sugar (candy), maple butter (for spreading), maple lollipops, maple taffy, maple cones, maple leaf cookies,...

Ice Cider

After maple syrup, ice cider is a favourite among locals... and for good reason. The cider equivalent of ice wine, ice cider is a complex signature drink made from frozen apples. Simply delicious... Available in SAQ (Société des Alcools du Québec) stores and Liquor Stores.

Le Sortilège

Le Sortilège is an enchanting blend of Canadian whisky and pure Quebec maple syrup (30% alcohol). Available in SAQ stores and Liquor Stores, like all other alcoholic beverages.

Coueurs des Bois

If you're not a whisky fan, try this authentic Quebec cream liqueur (think Baileys) made with maple syrup. In coffee, it's simply divine!

Caribou

At the time of New France, when life was hard, settlers drank a mixture of caribou (reindeer) blood and hard liquor to help them stave off the cold of winter. Rest assured, today this legendary Quebec beverage is made from wine (or Porto) and spirits.

Chicoutai

Fruit liqueur made from cloudberry (25% alcohol). Or, in the same family, Minaki, a blueberry liqueur. Particularly popular with women. Serve very cold.

Trappist monks chocolate-dipped blueberries

Made in Lac St-Jean during the blueberry harvest (about 6 weeks starting at the end of July), these freshly hand-picked blueberries dipped in quality dark chocolate are available in many grocery stores and souvenir shops across Quebec.

Cranberries

The cranberry is a small red berry with an incomparable tart flavour and many health benefits. Dried cranberries, which can be found in grocery stores everywhere, are delicious in baked goods, cereals, pancakes, etc. Cranberry preserves are a fine accompaniment to cheeses and savory dishes. You will also find cranberries dipped in chocolate, cranberry juice, cranberry syrups and salad dressings, and much more.

Montreal Smoked Meat

Smoked meat is traditionally served between two slices of rye with sweet mustard and pickles. The famous smoked meat from Montreal's legendary Schwartz's deli is now available in vacuum-sealed pouches in most grocery stores.

Poutine sauce

Packaged or canned poutine sauce or gravy can be purchased in grocery stores across Quebec. You can then have fun preparing this iconic Quebec dish for your guests at home.

If you visit Montreal, note that the Jean-Talon Market is one of the best places in Quebec to find a wide range of Quebec specialty foods.

In Quebec City, your best bet is Marché du Vieux-Port. Otherwise, you can always order some of these products online at www.Kanata.fr once you get home.

Finally, note that if you are bringing back alcohol (or other regulated products), we recommend checking with your country's customs office to find out how much you are allowed. Otherwise you may have to pay a fee (customs duties or taxes) on any excess items.

You must also consider your maximum baggage allowance, as you may have to pay excess baggage fees at the airport.



CLOTHING

Lumberjack shirt

The traditional lumberjack shirt is made of red and black plaid fleece. For a truly Canadian look ;-)

Ceinture fléchée

A ceinture fléchée (arrow sash) is a traditional piece of French Canadian clothing, associated with the fur trade. It is a hand-woven wool sash about 15 to 25 cm wide and up to 2 metres long.

Cowboy Hat

If you visit Western Canada, you simply must buy a cowboy hat! You will find the best selection in Calgary.

Hockey jerseys

Whether it is the famous red jersey of the Montreal Canadiens or one from a different Canadian team (Vancouver, Calgary, Edmonton, Winnipeg, Toronto, Ottawa or even the former Quebec Nordiques), you will create quite a stir when you wear your hockey jersey in Europe.

T-shirts

Souvenir shops offer a vast array of T-shirts (and tank tops). From the classic "I Love Canada" to T-shirts with local expressions or artwork, you will find something for everyone on your gift list.

Baseball caps: like T-shirts, you will find a wide range of caps to suit all tastes.

Trapper's hat

Iconic fur hat with a raccoon tail (think Davy Crockett or Daniel Boone).

Note that clothing is generally much less expensive in Canada than in Europe, especially for Levi's jeans and winter clothing (Canada Goose, Kanuk, Chlorophylle, etc.). Don't miss this opportunity to get some good deals!

ACCESSORIES

License plate

The ultimate souvenir to add a touch of Quebec to your home. Souvenir shops often carry them, but be aware that the genuine article is made of metal rather than plastic.

Road signs and traffic signs

If you are here on a road trip, why not bring home a sign that is particularly meaningful to you? You can often find them in souvenir shops. You will also find road signs featuring local animals.

School bus

Souvenir shops often carry miniature yellow school buses.

Wooden spoons

This traditional percussion instrument is often used in sugar shacks (and other venues) to play traditional folk music.



© Dya Eldin



Flag

Canadian and Quebec flags are among the most popular souvenir items. You will also find flags in the form of stickers, lapel pins, badges, decks of cards, etc.

Various

You will also find vast quantities of keychains, cups, calendars, stuffed animals, postcards, etc.

ART

Indigenous handicrafts

Most souvenir and gift shops include a section of Indigenous handicrafts. These may include dream catchers, traditional rawhide snowshoes, wolf or bear claw necklaces, drums and moccasins. Be sure to choose items made in Canada. Ideally, try to buy these souvenirs directly from the Indigenous

communities you encounter during your trip.

Inuit art

Inuit art is highly regarded throughout the fine art world. We are not talking about handicrafts, but about fine original works of art. Every Inuit sculpture comes with a certificate of authenticity with the artist's name and origin. Usually carved out of animal materials (bone, antlers, ivory) or soapstone, the magnificent sculptures represent the traditional lifestyle and activities of Inuit communities such as hunting and fishing.

Paintings

Many places offer paintings and artwork by local artists. Buying a painting is a lovely way to encourage the local community and bring a piece of Canadian culture back home. Rue du Trésor in Quebec City and Rue St-Amable in Montreal are open-air goldmines where you may well find your special painting.



MUSIC

Music is truly the soul of a country. Here are a few suggestions of Quebec and Canadian albums to add to your playlist:

English

Neil Young - Harvest
Leonard Cohen - I'm your man
Arcade Fire - Funeral
Bryan Adams - So Far So Good
Sarah McLachlan - MirrorBall
Shania Twain - Come On Over
Tragically Hip - Fully Completely
Alanis Morissette - Jagged Little Pill
Daniel Lanois - Acadie
Our Lady Peace - Clumsy
Simple Plan - Still Not Getting Any
Corey Hart - First Offense

French

Les Cowboys Fringants - Break Syndical (or La Grand-Messe)
Félix Leclerc - Le P'tit Bonheur
Paul Piché - À qui appartient l'beau temps ?
La Bottine Souriante - Je voudrais changer d'chapeau
Jean Leloup - L'Amour est sans pitié
Richard Desjardins - Tu m'aimes-tu ? (or Les Derniers Humains)
Daniel Bélanger - Les Insomniaques s'amuse (or Rêver Mieux)
Les Colocs - Les Colocs
Céline Dion - D'Eux
Daniel Boucher - Dix Mille Matins
Gilles Vigneault - Mets donc tes plus belles chansons ensemble
Robert Charlebois - Charlebois Volume I (or Volume II)
Jean Pierre Ferland - Jaune
Beau Dommage - Beau Dommage
Kevin Parent - Grand Parleur, Petit Faiseur
Fred Pellerin - Silence



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© Michel Julien

CANADA'S WILDLIFE

If you could see the Earth from space, you would have a perfect view of the boreal forest, a wide green belt circling the top of the northern hemisphere, covering Russia, Sweden, Finland, Alaska and about half of Canada.

But there is a lot more than just trees in this forest, as you will discover during your trip to Canada.

There are many things that can't be seen from space: the wetlands that filter millions of litres of water each day; the dense layers of moss, peat and soil that store vast amounts of carbon, essential for all living things; and a wide variety of wildlife.

Here are the main animal species that you are likely to see during your trip to Canada:

THE BEAVER

- is an superb engineer: builds impressive lodges, canals and dams;
- can see just as well under water as on land;
- is slow and clumsy on land, but gracious and agile in the water;
- has influenced the history of Canada more than any other animal.

THE WHITE-TAILED DEER

- is the most common and most widely distributed of North America's large mammals;
- sometimes leaves her fawn unattended for hours at a time;
- may have difficulty surviving the winter, particularly if there is overpopulation or if the snow is deep;
- occasionally gets its antlers hopelessly entangled with those of another male during a mating season battle, resulting in the slow death of both animals.

THE CARIBOU

- is the only member of the deer family in which both females and males carry antlers;
- has been known to run for kilometres in the summer to escape from hordes of pesky flying insects;
- uses lichens as a primary winter food, which enables it to survive on harsh northern rangeland. Its name probably comes from the Mi'kmaq word "xalibu", which means "the one who paws for its food".

THE MOOSE

- is a powerful swimmer within days of birth;
- can dive more than 5.5 m for plants at the bottom of a lake;
- has very poor eyesight;
- as a calf, gains weight faster than any other big game animals;
- is the largest member of the deer family, weighing up to 800 kg.



© Erik Mandre - Fotolia



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© Gilles Douaire

THE BLACK BEAR

- has flexible lips and a long, agile tongue that help it to gather tiny food items such as blueberries and ants;
- has been known to return to a site after it has been captured and moved more than 200 km;
- may wake up from winter hibernation and wander around for short periods;
- is tiny when born, weighing slightly more than 225 g (0.225 kg), compared to its mother's weight of 70 kg;
- appears heavy and awkward but has been clocked at speeds of up to 55 km/hour.

THE GRIZZLY BEAR

- is a solitary animal whose home range may be as large as 1,800 km² for males;
- is a true wilderness creature that can survive only in relatively undisturbed areas;
- is considered a carnivore, but eats mostly vegetation;
- is very small at birth, weighing about 400 g and measuring less than 22.5 cm.

THE EASTERN GREY SQUIRREL

- can be reddish, grey or black;
- can lose part of its tail to escape a predator's grasp if necessary;
- can reach speeds of up to 25 km per hour on the ground;
- leaves tracks in the snow that often look like two exclamation marks (!!);
- is found in both urban and rural settings.

THE WOLVERINE

- generally prefers remote areas, far away from humans and development;
- can travel up to 40 km during its daily hunting activities;
- is known by a variety of descriptive names, including glutton (because of its voracious appetite) and skunk bear, because it marks its food and its territory with urine and musk;
- has one of the most striking furs of Canadian mammals;
- despite its small size, is one of the fiercest animals on the planet.

THE WOLF

- has a highly organized hierarchical social structure centering on a dominant male and a breeding female;
- has been exterminated in many parts of North America;
- works hard for its food—a pack kills only about one large mammal for every 10 it chases;
- howls as a form of communication among packs.

THE RACCOON

- conserves energy during winter through inactivity, not hibernation;
- gets its English name from the Algonquian word "arakun", meaning "he who scratches with his hand";
- develops its familiar facial mask by about 10 days of age, usually before its eyes are open;
- is one of the few creatures that appear capable of making the adjustment from family pet back to wild animal.



VANCOUVER ISLAND FERRIES

© AdobeStock, Jenny Thompson

To get from one place to another along Canada's West Coast, it is sometimes necessary to take a ferry. In British Columbia, ferries serve more than 43 ports of call and all belong to the same company, BC Ferries. Here is a look at BC's main ferry services, to help you plan your next visit to Vancouver Island. Attention, prices are for information only and are subject to change without notice!

VANCOUVER - VICTORIA (TSAWWASSEN – SWARTZ BAY)

Crossing time: 1:35

Cost per passenger (one-way):

- Child aged 4 and under: Free
- Child aged 5 to 11: \$8.80
- Ages 12 to 64: \$17.60
- Seniors, Monday-Thursday: Free

Cost per vehicle (one-way):

- Up to 20 feet: \$59.50
- More than 20 feet: \$6.75 / additional foot

Reservations can be made online on the BC Ferries website (reservation fees: 7 days or more before departure: \$10
Less than 7 days before departure: \$17)

You must arrive 30 to 60 minutes prior to departure. If you are not checked in 30 minutes prior to departure, your reservation will no longer be valid. Without a reservation, the boarding order is based on your arrival time.



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**VANCOUVER – NANAIMO
(TSAWWASSEN – DUKE POINT)**

Crossing time: 2 hrs.
Cost per passenger (one-way):
- Child aged 4 and under: Free
- Child aged 5 to 11: \$8.80
- Ages 12 to 64: \$17.20
- Seniors, Monday-Thursday: Free
Cost per vehicle (one-way):
- Up to 20 feet: \$59.50
- More than 20 feet: \$6.75 / additional foot

Reservations can be made online on the BC Ferries website (reservation fees: 7 days or more before departure: \$10 Less than 7 days before departure: \$17). You must arrive 30 to 60 minutes prior to departure. If you are not checked in 30 minutes prior to departure, your reservation will no longer be valid. Without a reservation, the boarding order is based on your arrival time.

**WEST VANCOUVER – NANAIMO
(HORSESHOE BAY - DEPARTURE BAY)**

Crossing time: 1:40
Cost per passenger (one-way):
- Child aged 4 and under: Free
- Child aged 5 to 11: \$8.80
- Ages 12 to 64: \$17.60
- Seniors, Monday-Thursday: Free
- Up to 20 feet: \$59.50
- More than 20 feet: \$6.75 / additional foot

Reservations can be made online on the BC Ferries website (reservation fees: 7 days or more before departure: \$10 Less than 7 days before departure: \$17). You must arrive 30 to 60 minutes prior to departure. If you are not checked in 30 minutes prior to departure, your reservation will no longer be valid. Without a reservation, the boarding order is based on your arrival time.

**WEST VANCOUVER – SUNSHINE COAST
(HORSESHOE BAY - LANGDALE)**

Crossing time: 40 mins.
Cost per passenger (round trip):
- Child aged 4 and under: Free
- Child aged 5 to 11: \$7
- Ages 12 to 64: \$14
- Seniors, Monday-Thursday, excluding Statutory Holidays: Free
Cost per vehicle (round trip):
- Up to 20 feet: \$47
- More than 20 feet: \$6.10 / additional foot
In service: year-round

Reservations can be made online on the BC Ferries website (reservation fees: 7 days or more before departure: \$10 and less than 7 days before departure: \$17). You must arrive 30 to 60 minutes prior to departure. If you are not checked in 30 minutes prior to departure, your reservation will no longer be valid. Without a reservation, the boarding order is based on your arrival time.

**SECHELT PENINSULA – POWELL RIVER
(EARLS COVE – SALTERTY BAY)**

Crossing time: 50 mins.

Cost per passenger (round trip):

- Child aged 4 and under: Free
 - Child aged 5 to 11: \$6.90
 - Ages 12 to 64: \$13.75
 - Seniors, Monday-Thursday, excluding Statutory Holidays: Free
- Cost per vehicle (round trip):
- Up to 20 feet: \$45.75
 - More than 20 feet: \$5.95 / additional foot

No reservation possible. Boarding order is based on your time arrival. The ticket office closes 5 minutes before departure.

**POWELL RIVER – COMOX
(WESTVIEW – LITTLE RIVER)**

Crossing time: 1:30

Cost per passenger (one-way):

- Child aged 4 and under: Free
- Child aged 5 to 11: \$6.90
- Ages 12 to 64: \$13.80
- Seniors, Monday-Thursday, excluding Statutory Holidays: Free

Cost per vehicle (one-way):

- Up to 20 feet: \$43.15
- More than 20 feet: \$4.45 / additional foot

Reservations can be made online on the BC Ferries website (reservation fees: 7 days or more before departure: \$10 Less than 7 days before departure: \$17) . You must arrive 30 to 60 minutes prior to departure. If you are not checked in 30 minutes prior to departure, your reservation will no longer be valid. Without a reservation, the boarding order is based on your arrival time.

**CAMPBELL RIVER – QUADRA ISLAND
(VANCOUVER ISLAND – QUATHIASKI COVE)**

Crossing time: 10 mins.

Price per passenger (round trip):

- Child aged 4 and under: Free
 - Child aged 5 to 11: \$4.55
 - Ages 12 to 64: \$9.10
 - Seniors, Monday-Thursday, excluding Statutory Holidays: Free
- Cost per vehicle (round trip):
- Up to 20 feet: \$21.10
 - More than 20 feet: \$2.60 / additional foot

No reservation possible. Boarding order is based on your time arrival. The ticket office closes 3 minutes before departure.

**QUADRA ISLAND – CORTES ISLAND
(HERIOT BAY – WHALETOWN)**

Crossing time: 45 mins.

Price per passenger (round trip):

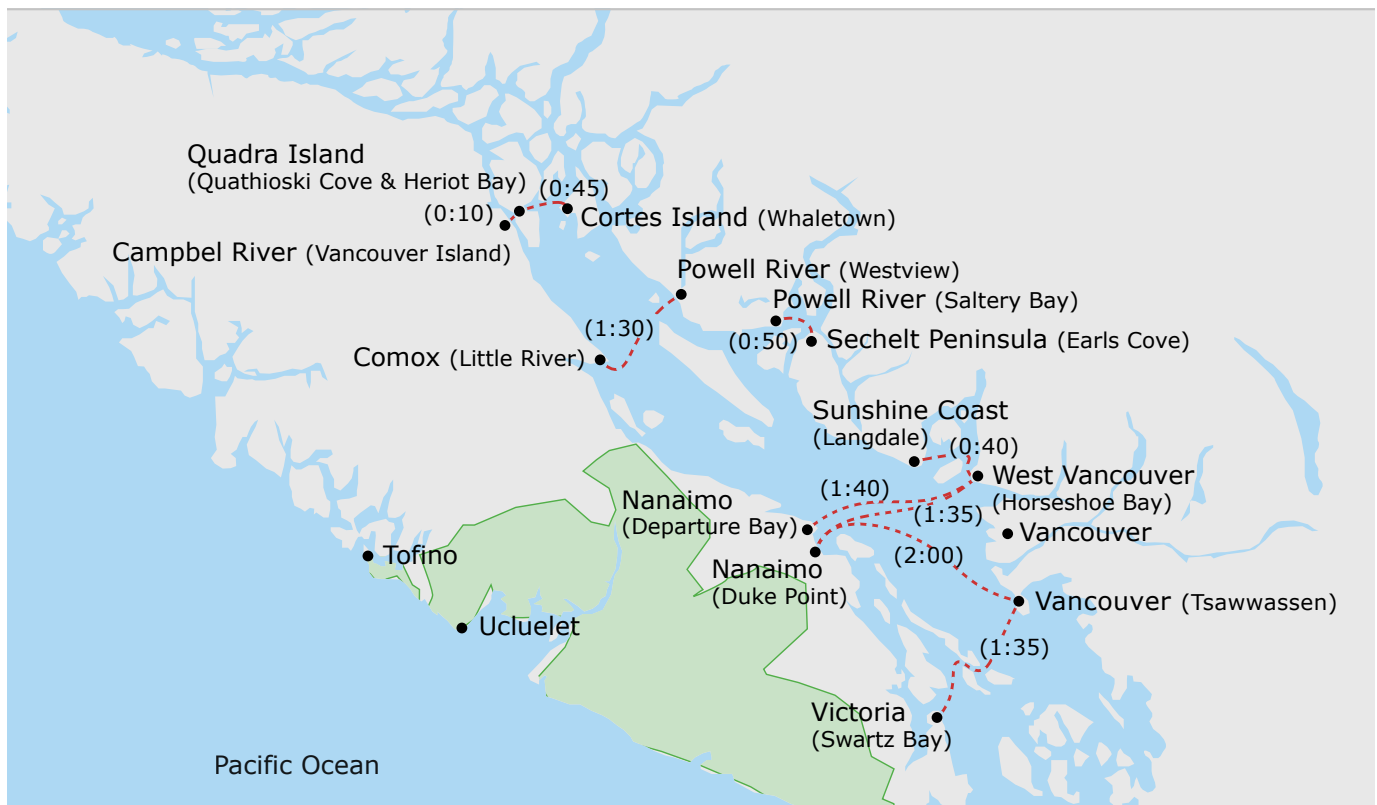
- Child aged 4 and under: Free
 - Child aged 5 to 11: \$5.35
 - Ages 12 to 64: \$10.70
 - Seniors, Monday-Thursday, excluding Statutory Holidays: Free
- Cost per vehicle (round trip):
- Up to 20 feet: \$24.65
 - More than 20 feet: \$3.90 / additional foot

No reservation possible. Boarding order is based on your time arrival. The ticket office closes 3 minutes before departure.

For more information, call :

1-888-223-3779

Website: www.bcferries.com



MAJOR WEST COAST RETAILERS

Large retail chains are not the same everywhere in Canada. Here is a list of those that you will commonly find in Alberta and British Columbia.

SUPERMARKETS

The main grocery chains in Western Canada are **Real Canadian Superstore**, **Safeway**, **Loblaws**, **IGA MarketPlace** et **Sobeys**.



You will also find smaller regional chains such as **Calgary CO-OP**, **T & T Supermarket** et **Fresh St. Market**.



Not to mention **Walmart Supercenters**, which include a full grocery store within their walls.



If you visit Jasper, be sure to stop at **Robinsons**, a lovely family-run grocery store that has been serving the Jasper community since 1923.



BEER, WINE AND SPIRITS

In British Columbia, alcohol can be purchased at government run **BC Liquor Stores** or private wine shops. In Alberta, beer, wine and spirits are sold in independently owned stores.

Shop around or ask a local for advice, because prices can vary greatly from one store to another. Note that beer prices in Alberta are extremely high compared with other Canadian provinces. For example, a case of 24 cans selling for \$27 in Quebec or \$34 in British Columbia could cost as much as \$50 in Alberta.

BC LIQUORSTORES

CONVENIENCE STORES

Western Canada has many small convenience stores. These sell milk and beverages of all kinds, bread, chips and candy, cigarettes, batteries, newspapers and magazines, coffee to go, etc. The most popular chains are **Mac's** and **7 Eleven**.



PHARMACIES

In Western Canada, the main pharmacy chains are **Shoppers**, **London Drugs** and **Rexall**. These offer over-the-counter and prescription drugs as well as health and beauty products, cleaning products, household items, food, etc.



There are also many small independently owned drug stores or pharmacies offering over-the-counter and prescription drugs.

GAS STATIONS

The principal gas stations are **Esso**, **Husky**, **Petro Canada**, **Canadian Tire**, **Shell** and **CO-OP**. Most gas stations are also convenience stores.



HARDWARE STORES

The leading hardware stores are **Rona**, **Home & Garden**, **Home Hardware** and **The Home Depot**.



There is also the very practical **Canadian Tire**, where you will find everything you need for your home and car.

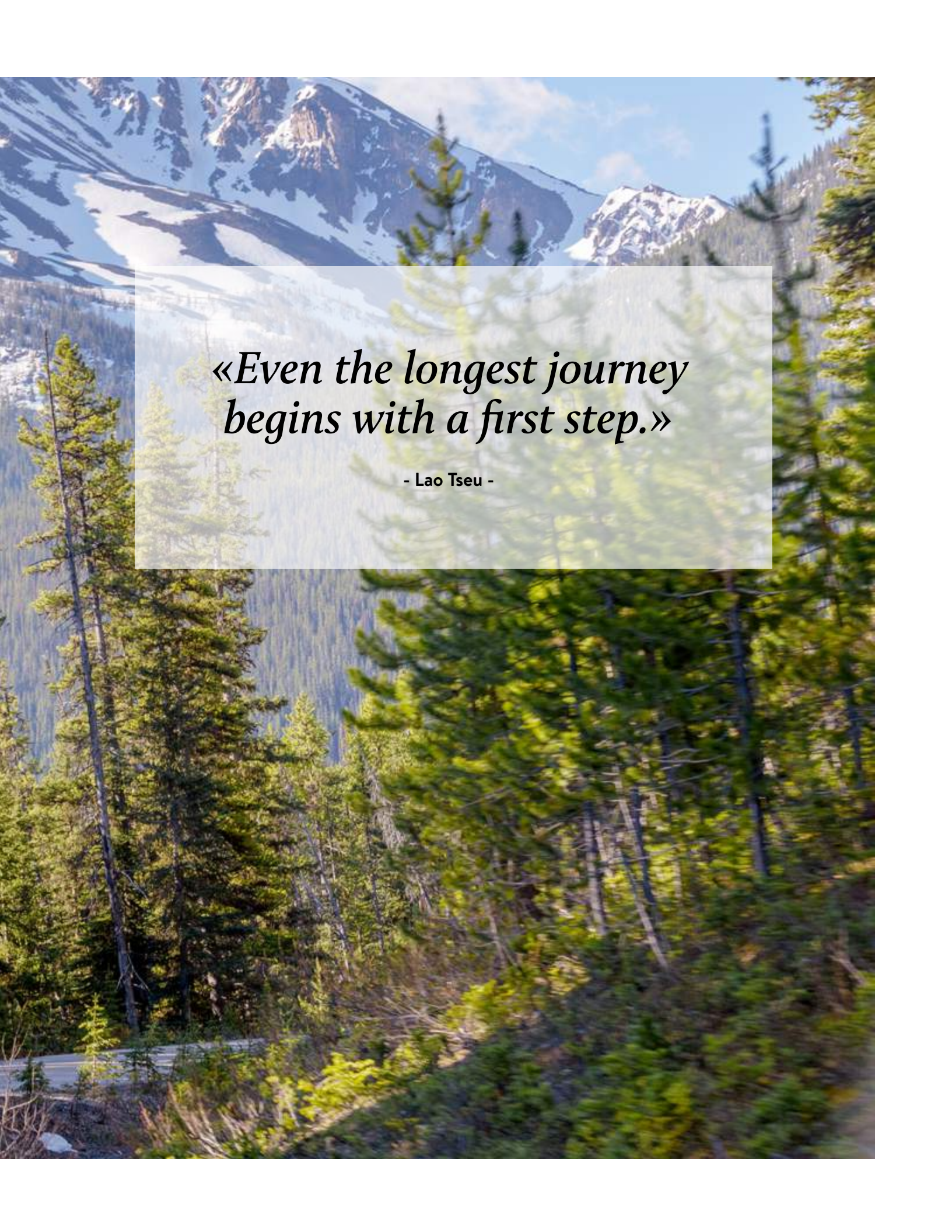


CAMPING AND OUTDOORS

For your outdoors equipment needs, pay a visit to **MEC** or **Atmosphere**.







*«Even the longest journey
begins with a first step.»*

- Lao Tseu -

